BOOK III.

THE REIGN OF SOLOMON.

CHAPTER I.

SOLOMON ANOINTED KING.

1 *Kings* i. 32-40.

SOLOMON commenced his reign under peculiar circumstances. Had there been no disturbing element in the house or the kingdom of David, when he slept with his fathers, Solomon his son would have peacefully ascended the vacant throne. But the Divine judgment, which David had brought upon himself, "The sword shall never depart from thine house," followed the king even to his dying-bed, and embittered his latest hours. Adonijah, the eldest son, knowing his younger brother had been chosen as his father's successor, anticipated the time of Solomon's accession, and had himself proclaimed king. It was to defeat this usurpation and crush the rising rebellion that by David's command Solomon was hastily raised to the dignity of the regal office. "Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, and the Cherethites, and the Pelethites, went down, and caused Solomon to ride upon king David's mule, and brought him to Gihon. And Zadok the priest took an horn of oil out of the tabernacle, and anointed Solomon. And they blew the trumpet; and all the people said, God save king Solomon."

This sudden and unexpected counterplot, as it may be called, carried consternation into the whole body of the conspirators, and the conspiracy at once collapsed. Adonijah had slain sheep and oxen and fat cattle, and had invited all his brethren the king's sons, and all the men of Judah the king's servants; but Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah, and the mighty men, and Solomon his brother, he called not. They had not yet risen from the feast when the music and the shouts of the people who followed the new king in his progress broke upon their ears. For as Solomon rode upon the king's mule, "all the people came up after him, and the people piped with pipes, and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth rent with the sound of them. And Adonijah and all the guests that were with him heard it as they had made an end of eating." When these sounds found an

interpreter in Jonathan the son of Abiathar the priest, who came in and told Adonijah that king David had made Solomon king; "all the guests that were with Adonijah were afraid, and rose up, and went every man his way;" and Adonijah himself, fearing Solomon, "arose, and went, and caught hold on the horns of the altar." Thus ended an attempt to subvert the kingdom, aided by so astute and brave a general as Joab and supported by the priest Abiathar.

These events we are to regard as having a higher import than that of mere history.

It is a circumstance deserving remark, and not without a higher meaning, that, as David was anointed king before the death of Saul, so Solomon was anointed king before the death of David. Thus the natural, the spiritual, and the celestial, while perfectly distinct, run into each other, like the different colours of the rainbow. For each produces, by its connection with the other, a middle principle that partakes of the nature of both; and this middle principle forms the uniting medium between them. For it is a universal law, that no two things which are discretely distinct can be united but by means of a third that partakes of the nature of both. This is true of the three degrees of the human mind, of the three heavens, and of the three senses of the Word.

Those circumstances which, like the usurpation of Adonijah, form no part of, but are, on the contrary, opposed to the established order of things, are not to be regarded as merely accidental, but as arising out of the disorder which underlies the existing order. The kingdom itself in Israel arose out of disorder. The demand of the Israelites to have a king involved the rejection of the Lord as their King. Their demand was complied with as a lesser evil to prevent a greater. For the evil that produced the cry was that also which required the remedy. The evil that gave rise to their demand manifested itself also in the kings and the kingdom they had chosen. So that the untoward events that happen are to be regarded as outbirths of the state which existed amongst them. Yet as the manifestations of evil are, as far as possible, overruled for good, by that Providence which sees the end from the beginning, so in the present case was the usurpation of Adonijah made to contribute to the stability of Solomon's throne. This it helped to do in two ways. It brought into open manifestation the character of the disloyal who would have weakened the kingdom, and evoked the good feelings of the loyal who maintained it. If it hastened the time of Solomon's accession to the throne, this was but one of the effects produced by the general cause out of which the usurpation of Adonijah arose. And all these are shadows of states and events in the history of our Lord Himself, as the antitype both of David and Solomon, and against whose government all opposing

elements were permitted to come into ultimate manifestation, that they might be overcome, and removed out of the way, so that His kingdom, as represented by that of Solomon, the peaceable, might be one of settled peace.

When David gave the command that Solomon should be made king, he commissioned Zadok the priest, and Nathan the prophet, and Benaiah the son of Jehoiada, to take the leading part in the ceremonial. These represented the celestial, spiritual, and natural principles into which, as well as by which, he was to be inaugurated.

They were first to cause Solomon to ride upon king David's own mule, which itself was a sign of the transference of the kingdom from the father to the son. But this was not a mere transference, but an exaltation. The rational, which had been subject to the spiritual, was now to be made subject to the celestial.

They were next to take him down to Gihon, and there anoint and proclaim him king. Regarded in its historical sense, it is considered that this was a precautionary measure. Gihon was near Jerusalem, and is supposed to have been on the opposite side of the city to that in which Adonijah had been proclaimed, and where he and his party were assembled. The spiritual reason is to be sought in the representative character of the place itself. Gihon derived its name from the "breaking forth" of a stream; which is not mentioned again, except in the Second Book of Chronicles, where it is said that Hezekiah stopped the upper watercourse of Gihon, and brought it straight down to the west side of the city of David (xxxii. 30); and that he built a wall without the city of David, on the west side of Gihon, in the valley (xxxiii. 14). But besides its name and these indications of its character, we have a guide to its spiritual meaning in the circumstance that Gihon is the name of one of the four heads into which the river was parted that went out from Eden to water the garden (Gen. ii. 13). These four branches of the river of the water of life signify the finite streams into which the ever-flowing river of Divine Wisdom is parted, when it enters the domain of finite intelligence, in heaven and the Church, and comes to the apprehension of angels and men. The first river is goodness and truth, and the second is the knowledge of all that relates to goodness and truth; and these two belong to the internal man: the third river is reason, and the fourth is knowledge; and these belong to the external man. Gihon was the second river, and therefore signifies the knowledge of goodness and truth, as it is in the internal man. And when we know that Eden signified the celestial man, whose state is described by Eden and all that belonged to it, we can see the reason why Solomon, the peaceful and the wise, the celestial man among the kings of Israel, should go to Gihon to be anointed king.

There is also a speciality mentioned respecting the oil with which he was anointed. The priest took a horn of oil out of the tabernacle and anointed Solomon. In the two previous anointings there is nothing said about the oil being taken from the tabernacle. The mention of it here connects the holy oil with the holy place, and thus connects it with the sanctuary, where the Divine Presence dwelt. The tabernacle also represented the celestial Church, and the worship of the Lord from the holy principle of love.

When they had anointed Solomon they blew the trumpet. The trumpet was used among the Jews, as amongst other nations, to give forth the sound of alarm or of triumph. It was employed in their religious as well as in their state ceremonials, and is associated with the supernatural as well as with natural agencies and events of Scripture. The first time we read of the trumpet in the Bible is on mount Sinai at the giving of the law, when "there were thunders, and lightnings, and a thick cloud upon the mount, and the voice of the trumpet exceeding loud" (Exod. xix. 16). As at the beginning of the Mosaic, so at the end of the first Christian dispensation. In the end of the world, or consummation of the age, the Son of Man "shall send His angels with a great sound of a trumpet, and they shall gather together His elect from the four winds" (Matt. xxiv. 31). The voice of the trumpet, in these instances, is evidently a sign or symbol of Divine truth, the promulgation of which makes both an end and a beginning, but more especially a beginning, by gathering together from the old the elements that are to form the commencement of the new. The trumpet was used in the Israelitish Church more particularly for calling their holy assemblies. In the general sense, these represented the united consent of the members of the Church to the teaching of Divine truth, and their united action in the worship or service of the Lord: in the individual sense, they represented the united consent of all the thoughts and affections of the mind to the teaching of the Word, and their united action in words of truth and works of righteousness.

The sound of the trumpet after the anointing, as the voice of truth after the influence of love, was the signal for the people to shout, Let king Solomon live, translated into our popular cry of God save the king. The simultaneous cry of the people is the consent of all the common affections and thoughts to the government of the truth which Solomon represented, the truth of wisdom. This is higher than the truth of intelligence, which was represented by David. The truth which David represented is that which teacheth the hands to war and the fingers to fight, and which carries on the warfare against the yet unsubdued evils of the corrupt selfhood. The truth represented by Solomon is that which speaks comfortably to Jerusalem, and cries unto her that her warfare is accomplished, and through which the Lord

speaks peace to His people and to His saints; for mercy and truth are met together, and righteousness and peace have kissed each other.

Not only did the multitude acknowledge Solomon as their king, but "all the people came up after him" on his way to Jerusalem, and no doubt in his triumphal entry into it. This following, like the disciples and the multitude following Jesus, represented following practically the teaching and example set before them, which the people have in the Lord, of whom Solomon was the type. The people who followed Solomon piped with pipes and rejoiced with great joy, so that the earth rent with the sound of them. Pipes, like all wind instruments, are symbols of celestial affections, as stringed instruments are of spiritual affections. In wind instruments, such as these pipes, the human voice itself speaks, so that there is more of life in the sounds produced by them, than in those produced by simply mechanical means. There is also a distinction between joy and gladness similar to that between wind and string instruments, joy being expressive of celestial, and gladness of spiritual, affection. To rejoice with great joy is to feel and express the delight of life which springs from the highest affections of the heart, which are the affections of love to God. So powerful were the demonstrations of joy that the earth rent with the sound of them. This is considered to be a figurative expression, but as all the figures of Scripture are correspondences, the rending of the earth has more than a figurative meaning. The earth is the natural mind, as heaven is the spiritual mind. When the prophet says, "Hear, O heavens, and give ear, O earth," he calls not only heaven and earth, or angels and men, to bear witness to the truth of the words he is about to utter, but he calls upon every member of the Church to hearken, both spiritually and naturally, from all temporal and eternal considerations, to the words of Divine truth. The rending of the earth is not expressed by the same word as the rending of the garments, nor does it express the same idea. It means cleft, laid open, sometimes for the purpose of destruction, as when the earth *clave* asunder, and swallowed up Korah and his company (Num. xvi. 31); but also for the coming forth of life, as in the promise, "Then shall thy light *break forth* as the morning" (Isa. lviii. 8). The rending of the earth was a happy event, being an effect of the people's rejoicing; and signifies, therefore, the responsive opening of the natural mind to receive and reciprocate the inward spiritual joy which the beginning of the reign of love awakens in the heart. In the case of Korah we have an awful image of the state of man, when all celestial and spiritual affections sink down into the natural mind, which greedily opens its mouth to receive them, and which swallows them up and destroys them; while in the case of Solomon, we have the opposite state expressed, though not literally represented, of the natural mind opening, as it actually

does, to admit the heavenly influences that descend into it whenever it yields a willing submission to the laws of love and truth.

When Solomon was seated on the throne of the kingdom, the king's servants came to bless their lord, king David, saying, "God make the name of Solomon better than thy name, and make his throne greater than thy throne. And the king bowed himself upon the bed." The name and the throne of Solomon were greater than those of David, as the celestial is greater than the spiritual, as love to God is greater than love to man, although the less is like unto the greater. When his servants told him, David bowed himself on his bed. A similar act is recorded of Jacob, when Joseph had sworn to carry out his father's desire to bury him, not in Egypt, but in Canaan. Jacob is said to have bowed himself upon the head of his bed; David upon the bed. David speaks of his bed in an evidently mystical sense where he says, "I will not come into the tabernacle of my house, nor go up into the couch of my bed, until I find out a place for the Lord, an habitation for the mighty God of Jacob" (Ps. cxxx. 3, 5). The tabernacle of his house is the holy principle of love, and the couch of his bed is the truth which is from that love in the natural mind, into which men could not enter or ascend until the coming of the Lord, and which no one can now enter or ascend until the Lord has found a place in the heart, and the Mighty One of Jacob a habitation in the mind. When, therefore, David bowed himself upon his bed, he gave an outward symbólic sign of the consent of the mind to the supremacy of the principle of goodness in the heart, as the throne where the Lord sits, and whence He exercises His dominion, in those who acknowledge and worship Him as love itself and wisdom itself. In the three instances we have here mentioned the bed is expressed by three different terms, as expressive of the natural mind in its three different states, when it is the support of natural, of spiritual, or of celestial truth and goodness. Jacob's bed answers to the first of these, and David's to the second; the bed into which David resolved not to go up answers to the third; for this resolve was not accomplished in David but in Solomon, who found a place for the Lord when he built the temple, at the dedication of which he quotes this psalm, as having then received its accomplishment.

Besides bowing himself upon his bed, David said, "Blessed be the Lord God of Israel, which hath given one to sit on my throne this day, mine eyes even seeing it." Not only with the affection of his will, but with the perception of his understanding did David acknowledge the blessing which the Lord God of Israel had bestowed upon the kingdom by the elevation of Solomon to the throne. To bless the Lord is to acknowledge Him as the Author of our blessings. And the blessing which is the ground of David's thanksgiving is the establishment of

that order of the religious life, when we see with the eye of faith the exaltation of the grace of love, and our heart is raised in gratitude to the Divine Giver of all good for having brought it to pass in His own time and in His own way. This day includes the state of things represented by all the circumstances existing at the time in the kingdom of Israel. A state of exaltation may arise out of a state of humiliation, a state of safety out of a state of danger, a state of peace out of a state of tribulation. Such was the condition of things when Solomon was raised to the throne of David, giving us the promise that "all things work together for good to them that love God, to them who are the called according to His purpose."

The first act of Solomon, as the king of Israel, was one worthy of his kingly character. Adonijah clung to the horns of the altar until Solomon, whom he now acknowledged to be king, should swear that he would not slay him with the sword. Solomon said, "If he will show himself a worthy man, there shall not an hair of him fall to the earth: but if wickedness shall be found in him, he shall die. So king Solomon sent, and they brought him down from the altar. And he came and bowed himself to king Solomon: and Solomon said unto him, Go to thine house." Divine pardon is not unconditional, and clemency is not exercised without regard to character and conduct. Worthiness secures life, wickedness brings condemnation and death. The Lord delighteth in mercy; and these acts of clemency which His creatures perform are but the shadow of those which He is continually doing to the penitents, however grievously they have sinned against Him.

CHAPTER II.

DAVID'S DYING CHARGE TO SOLOMON, AND HIS DEATH.

1 *Kings* ii. 5-10.

IF anything were required to convince us that the Old Testament worthies were not all saints, though they were all representatives of saints, the deathbed scene of David would be sufficient for that purpose. We need not point out wherein his dying charge to Solomon differed in spirit as well as in act from what that of a dying Christian would be, were it given under similar circumstances. Much less need we contrast it with the spirit which was manifested by the Lord when He prayed on the cross for His enemies. To die as well as to live in charity with all men is a requirement of Christianity. David was not a Christian, though an eminent type of Christ, and we are

not to expect, or at least we are not to require, of him Christian perfection. He is not to be judged by a Christian standard. It is not necessary, indeed it is not lawful, for us to judge him as to his essential spiritual state at all. But it is highly necessary to be guarded against the opinion, that because David is called a man after God's own heart, everything he did without Divine reproof may be reconciled with the character of a holy Christian man.

Grateful may we be for the light which the coming of the Son of Man in His glory has shed upon the sacred page, especially where it records such instances of human frailty. Precious would that light be were it only for the discrimination which it enables us to make between the type and the antitype, and, generally, between the letter and the spirit of the Scriptures, so far as to preserve us from both of those grievous errors—the justification of wrong because done by some who are called the people of God, and the rejection of the Bible because it seems to sanction it. But far more precious is that light seen to be when, besides giving us this discriminating light, it discovers to us, as objects of spiritual discernment, interior truths that reveal the nature of our own inner life, and display the wisdom of God in the process of our regeneration. To such high and holy subjects does every part of the Sacred Scriptures relate. The deathbed scene of David, and the execution of his sanguinary will by Solomon, when that light from heaven falls upon them, dissolve away, and are succeeded by scenes in which life and immortality take the place of death and destruction. For death and destruction in regard to the spiritual life, in an advancing state of regeneration, are but the removal of old things that have served their purpose and completed their use, in a previous and inferior stage of spiritual progression, that new and higher things may take their place. This, it may appear, is the general truth representatively taught in the rather singular circumstances of Abiathar the priest and Joab the captain of the host—the two highest officers, one in the sacred and the other in military affairs of the kingdom—being retained in office during the whole of the reign of David, notwithstanding the hereditary judgment that rested on the one and the personal criminality that rested on the other.

Abiathar was one of the descendants of Eli, against whose house it had been declared, that its iniquity should not be purged with sacrifice nor offering for ever. The sentence of extirpation on the house of Eli may be considered as having been carried out to a great extent in the time of Saul, though not completely till the time of Solomon. Ahimelech, of the house of Eli, who was priest in the time of Saul, was slain, among fourscore and five persons that wore a linen ephod, because he had supplied David with bread and the sword of Goliath out of the sanctuary, when he fled from the persecuting wrath of his

father-in-law. On that occasion a circumstance occurred too frequently mentioned in the Scriptures to be considered accidental or without a meaning. Abiathar, one of the sons of Ahimelech, escaped the slaughter of the priests of Nob, and, as the only remnant of the house of Eli, fled after David, by whom he was received with affection, and afterwards made high priest. And this office he continued to hold till he joined Adonijah in his attempt to obtain the throne, for which he was thrust out by Solomon.

Viewing the rejection of Abiathar from the priesthood as the remote consequence of a judgment which the conduct of Eli had brought upon his whole house, we are to understand it as teaching an important lesson respecting the course of evil as a principle in ourselves. In those who have entered on the regenerate life, judgment comes to be pronounced upon their evils; and if they continue to progress in that life, those evils will, in accordance with that judgment, assuredly die out or cease to rule. As this is the spiritual meaning involved in these Divine judgments and their fulfilment, we must see that they are judgments of mercy, and that the execution of these judgments is a work of mercy. When, therefore, we read in the Scriptures of the Divine Being pronouncing judgment of rejection or extinction, which is only to be consummated in future times and generations, let us think, not of a Divine decree that punishes the sins of the fathers upon the children, or that entails a curse upon all the descendants of one offender, but of that wise and merciful economy by which it is provided that, with the faithful, evils that are seen and condemned by the light of Divine truth will gradually be exhausted and consumed, till not one remains or exercises any rule in the heart and mind.

But there is another phase of the subject respecting Abiathar, when the thrusting out of that descendant of the house of Eli from the priesthood is considered in connection with the installation of Zadok in his place. Abiathar was a descendant of Aaron, the first high priest of the Jews, through his younger son Ithamar, and Zadok was a descendant of Aaron through his eldest son Eleazar. And we have only to call to remembrance the significant history of Jacob and Esau to perceive the meaning of the elder for a time serving the younger, or being subordinate or inferior to him, till the elder, in the course of events, breaks the yoke of the younger from off his neck. For while the regenerate man acts from the understanding rather than from the will—from truth rather than from good—the younger has the first place; but when he comes to act from the will and from goodness, the firstborn, who represents the principle of goodness, acquires the ascendant as his own true right. The ascendancy of truth during man's reformation is, however, as providential and necessary as the ascendancy of good when he is regenerated. Truth is the sword that combats,

good is the sceptre that rules. During the warlike reign of David a younger branch of the house of Aaron rules in sacerdotal affairs; when Solomon begins his peaceful reign the eldest is invested with the robes of office as high priest of the Church.

The case of Joab is one of still more particular interest. The son of Zeruiah, the sister of David, we see in him a representative of rational truth in relation to that which is spiritual, or of relative truth, as compared and connected with absolute truth. The inner man is perfected through mediums, and acts through instruments. Essential principles in the inner man act through secondary principles in the outer man. In regard to David and Joab, as standing in this relation to each other, David represents Divine truth such as it is in the spiritual sense of the Word, and in the spiritual mind of man. Joab represents Divine truth such as it is in the literal sense of the Word, and in the rational mind of man, which is natural truth rationally apprehended. We have already spoken of Joab as representing the rational mind, and therefore also the rational man. But when we speak of the rational man within the Church, we speak of him in relation to the principles of the Church, and therefore in relation to the Word, from which the principles of the Church are derived. Those who apprehend the Word naturally are those who believe it in simplicity, without reasoning on its teaching, being like children who have not yet learned comparison and judgment. Such as these never pervert the Scriptures, because they do not enter intellectually into their teaching. It is the rational man, who is not at the same time a spiritual man, that alone can be guilty of this serious evil. The rational man who is also spiritual, reasons on spiritual subjects from spiritual light; but the rational man who is not spiritual, reasons on them from natural light. The rational faculty, like the letter of the Word, is a sword that turns every way, and may be used either to support or assail the cause of genuine truth, according as it acts under the influence of the spiritual mind, which is in the order of heaven, or of the natural mind, while it is yet under the yoke of self-love and the love of the world.

That Joab should sustain a representative character in which the truths of the written Word can have any share, when his crimes, especially that of deceitfully slaying a man more righteous than himself, were such as to cause David to utter the heaviest judgment against him and his house, is not more surprising than that David should represent the Lord as the Divine truth itself. Judas, as one of the Lord's disciples, had his share in representing what the disciples collectively represented, all the goods and truths of His Word. And yet Judas betrayed the Lord, and betrayed Him with a kiss. Nor was he even then acting out of his representative character. The Lord

cannot be betrayed out of the Church, nor where His Word is not known. It is only those who know Him that can betray Him, nor can they betray Him but by that very knowledge of which He is the Author and the Object. The Lord is betrayed when the truths of His Word are turned against Him; and they are turned against Him when they are made to serve the ends of avarice, injustice, revenge. These are the enemies of God as well as of men; and when they triumph by the perversion of truth, the Lord of truth and love is betrayed into the hands of sinners. When this is done deceitfully, the Lord is betrayed with a kiss. This is no doubt the consummation of all wickedness, and was permitted to be done to the Saviour to represent that He endured the greatest evil which fallen human nature could or ever can oppose to the purposes and operations of His saving mercy. The death of Judas and of Joab did not represent the extinction of that truth of which they were the types. Persons who are actually guilty of these evils destroy indeed all truth in themselves; for, of all evils, that of holding the truth in unrighteousness, and using it deceitfully, enters most deeply into the human mind, and roots out most completely the germs of all that is good and true. The holiest truths and goods of the Church and of the Word cannot then avail to secure or preserve spiritual life; as Joab was slain in the sanctuary, clinging to the horns of the altar. It was one of the laws delivered to Moses, "If a man come presumptuously upon his neighbour to slay him with guile, thou shalt take him from Mine altar, that he may die." And when the good of charity or the truth of faith is destroyed deceitfully, the holiest things of worship cannot save from spiritual death.

Considered as representing principles, the death of Joab represented the separation from holy truth of the profane principle which adhered to it from the corrupt mind of man. And in these and other cases where another takes the office, the new occupant represents a new principle—one more in accordance with the truth, and more capable of manifesting its nature and uses.

If the case of Joab is impressive, still more so is that of Shimei. It will be recollected that when David was fleeing from Absalom, who had rebelled against his father, Shimei, of the family of the house of Saul, "came forth, and cursed still as he came. And he cast stones at David, and at all the servants of David: and he said, Come out, thou bloody man, and thou man of Belial: the Lord hath returned upon thee all the blood of the house of Saul, in whose stead thou hast reigned." When urged by Abishai to allow him to take off his head, David rebuked him, and said, "So let him curse, because the Lord hath said unto him, Curse David." When, after the death of Absalom, the king was returning from the place of his retreat, Shimei came with the men of Judah to welcome and receive him: and confessing his

sin and craving forgiveness, David sware unto him that his life should be spared. In this pardon there were no conditions, there was no reservation. But in the solemn moments of a deathbed, ten years later, David charged Solomon to do what the oath alone, it would seem, prevented David himself from doing—to bring the hoar head of Shimei with blood to the grave. Naturally considered, all this might be perfectly consistent with Jewish notions of right and justice. Yet we cannot regard it as a part of the inspired Word of God without being satisfied that something is intended to be conveyed by it to the mind of the spiritual man that does not appear from the literal history.

Considered as a part of the history of man's regeneration, it is easy to perceive the general truth it was intended to convey. Shimei must represent a principle in the mind which rises up and assails it in states of trial and temptation, but which submits itself to the authority of the truth in times of prosperity; and which, though evil, cannot be removed till regeneration has attained a certain stage in its progress towards a state of perfection. The human mind, as the little world within, is like the great world without, in this as in all things else, that there are within it, in its imperfect state, those thoughts and feelings that are friends in prosperity and enemies in adversity, or that are obedient subjects when authority is established, but rebellious and insolent when that authority is shaken. If these ruling powers were to be overturned, or even brought into jeopardy, how many obedient and orderly citizens would break out into acts of contempt or violence. Even when these powers are in full operation, there be some that curse them in their hearts, and only want the outward occasion to curse them with their lips and in their lives—to cast at them the stones of violence and the dust of contumely.

In the spiritual affairs of the soul there is some considerable resemblance to this. In the earlier stage of the spiritual life there are thoughts and feelings that yield to the pressure of authority exerted by the truth which we have acknowledged as the law of life, but which show insubordination and violence when that pressure is removed. When we suffer we are often disposed to murmur, and are sometimes even tempted to break out into complaints against the wisdom and goodness of Providence.

Circumstances do not create these rebellious principles or increase their malignity, but they afford occasion or opportunity for their coming into open rebellion. Most conscientious persons have learned by experience that circumstances, especially those of trial and temptation, bring dispositions into activity which they hardly knew or could believe they possessed. Such circumstances as make us thus practically acquainted with ourselves are no doubt among the permissions of

an all-wise and good Providence, whose dispensations are not all present peace, but which permit the sword to pierce through the very soul. In the wars of this world how are the passions of men let loose! in the day of adversity how cruelly does the enemy triumph! In the wars of the spiritual life—those of the world within—there are not less startling revelations of the enormity of the evils that slumber in the human heart—evils that either never have been excited so as to be seen in their real malignity, or that rise up anew after they have been brought into some degree of subjection. It is a merciful as it is a wise provision in the economy of our Divine Saviour, that evils are not allowed to pass the bounds of possible restraint and final subjugation; and that they are only permitted to come into activity when we have the power to overcome them. "As thy day, so shall thy strength be." "God is faithful, who will not suffer you to be tempted above that ye are able; but will with the temptation also make a way to escape, that ye may be able to bear it." Evil, however effectually subdued, is never annihilated, but is removed from its central and commanding position in the mind to an outward and subordinate place. It is always, therefore, possible, while we live in this world, for evil to return to the place from which it has been cast out; and no doubt there is in every subdued evil an inherent inclination to throw off the yoke. The actual return of any evil to its original central place and to its original authority in the mind, would be to the individual a kind of second fall that would leave him far more wicked and degraded than the first. It would be his return, after the evil spirit had gone out of him, with seven other spirits more wicked than himself. This is a state of things that is to the utmost mercifully provided against. One of the means by which Divine wisdom and goodness secure the earnest mind against this calamity is, that no particular evil that has been completely overcome is ever likely to rise up and acquire dominion again. But evils are connected together like tribes and houses and families; and though one may be subdued, another may renew the assault. Saul, the bitter enemy of David, may be dead, but a Shimei, of the house and family of Saul, may come forth, and, in the hour of adversity and trial, manifest the same spirit of bitterness and hostility. This is one of the circumstances incident to the regenerate life. The natural man can go on acting daily from the same evil principle and gratifying the same evil concupiscence, with little difference but that of increased intensity. The Christian looks into his own heart; and, as he discovers the evils of his nature, he humbles himself on account of them, and looks for Divine aid to enable him to remove them. The manifestation of the evils of the heart leads, therefore, to two distinct states. It shows us what we are in and of ourselves. The curse, deep and bitter as it is, which brings evil to our view, produces a conviction in the mind that

it is deserved, and that the accusation is of Divine permission, to humble us under a sense of our corruption. We are prepared, therefore, to say with the humbled king, "Let him curse, because the Lord hath said unto him, Curse David." In this state of humility, in which the cursed nature of sin is seen, there is also a looking to the Lord that He may turn away the curse and give a blessing in its stead. The afflicted soul is ready to express the hope of David: "It may be that the Lord will look on mine affliction, and that the Lord will requite me good for His cursing this day." This patient submission to the worst that an accusing conscience or accusing spirits can do, lays in the mind the foundation of a better state; for every state of real upward progress is laid in the sincere acknowledgment that in ourselves we are nothing but evil, and that all good comes from God as its true and only possible source. In ourselves are only the evil and curse; in the Lord only have we goodness and the blessing.

When this foundation is once laid deep in the mind, the ultimate removal of the evil of the heart will be accomplished. But that removal can only be effected when its opposite good obtains such an ascendancy in the mind as to give us the necessary power to effect it. The beginning of Solomon's reign was the period when Shimei and the other eminent delinquents during David's reign were punished; for this represented a new state, and one in which that higher good—the good of love to the Lord—begins to obtain practical ascendancy in the regenerate mind.

But the question arises, Why did Solomon, instead of executing immediately the will of his father to put Shimei to death, lay upon him a personal restraint which there was a reasonable probability of his submitting to, and so defeating the object of David?

Jerusalem means the Church, and in a particular sense the doctrine of the Church. Shimei was required to build himself a house in Jerusalem, and not to go forth any whither, and was warned that on crossing the brook Kidron he should surely be put to death. Jerusalem represented the Church, and in particular the Church in regard to its doctrines. To build a house in Jerusalem is to build up the mind in conformity with the doctrines of the Church, and not to go out of Jerusalem is to live within the bounds or according to the teaching of the doctrines of truth and goodness. The lesson we are taught in the circumstance, that, so long as Shimei remained in Jerusalem, his life would be spared, is this, that so long as evil is restrained by the truths or doctrines of the Church, and a man lives in conformity with them, his spiritual life is preserved, but that whenever he throws off the restraints of doctrine and allows his evil to go forth into actual life, it brings certain death upon him. It is not by merely refraining from the act that spiritual life is preserved; for when there is the intention

to do evil, the act exists potentially in it, and, unless sincerely repented of, will come forth into actual existence also when occasion offers. So long as evil has not entered so deeply into the will and thence into act as to have become a fixed principle and a confirmed habit, the state is not a hopeless one. In a general way, too, so long as evil is confined to the mind, it does not bring its ultimate results upon the soul; since it is a law of Divine as it is of human justice that evil is never actually punished except when it comes into act. So that even in the future state men are not actually punished for the evils they have committed here, but for the evils they commit there. They carry with them the evil principles from which they have acted in this life; and as often as these bring them into states of actual opposition to goodness and truth, they fall under punishment as the means of correction and restraint.

But while the general condition was laid upon Shimei that he should not go beyond the city of Jerusalem, there was a particular line marked out as the boundary which he was not to pass. "For it shall be, that on the day thou goest out, and passest over the brook Kidron, thou shalt know for certain that thou shalt surely die."

Why should the command be given not to pass over the brook Kidron? That stream and the deep and dark ravine in which it flowed formed the boundary of hardly two sides of the high ground on which Jerusalem stood. It lay on the north and east of Jerusalem, and on the opposite side stood the mount of Olives, at the foot of which was the garden of Gethsemane. There was no doubt a reason for Solomon's specific limitation: and the Word itself will enable us to see what that reason was.

Kidron has been already mentioned in connection with the very events in David's history which brought Shimei's hostility into action. When David fled from Absalom, in leaving Jerusalem, it is recorded that, in the mournful procession, "all the country wept with a loud voice, and all the people passed over: the king also himself passed over the brook Kidron, and all the people passed over, toward the way of the wilderness." In the Gospel also this brook is mentioned in connection with an event in the Lord's life which still more strikingly marks the character of its signification. When the Divine Saviour had finished the Holy Supper, and had ended that prayer to the Father, in which He expresses the depth of His love for His people, and the ardency of His desire for union with the Father and conjunction with them, it is said in the 18th of John that "when Jesus had spoken these words, He went forth with His disciples over the brook Cedron, where was a garden, into the which He entered, and His disciples. And Judas also, which betrayed Him, knew the place."

Kidron, the dark and turbid, is thus, as it were, the boundary-line between the Church and the world, where peace and security end and tribulation and danger begin, with those, at least, who are passing through the trials of the spiritual life. Shimei had remained three years in Jerusalem, when two of his servants "ran away unto Achish, son of Maacah king of Gath. And they told Shimei, saying, Behold, thy servants be in Gath. And Shimei arose, and saddled his ass, and went to Gath to Achish to seek his servants: and Shimei went, and brought his servants from Gath." It is more than likely that in his eagerness to recover his runaway servants, Shimei had for the moment lost all recollection of the bond under which he held his life. In this Shimei was but the type of those who hold their spiritual life on the same conditions. When religion is to us a law but not a principle, and thus controls the outward actions but does not affect the inward life, the bond, though it has been solemnly consented to, is easily forgotten, and likely to be broken under any circumstances that strongly excite our self-interest or self-love. Time, also, which strengthens inward principles, tends to weaken the sense of outward obligations. The three years that Shimei remained in Jerusalem would have been to a spiritual man a full state of confirmation in the principles of religion, but proved in his case the complete forgetfulness or neglect of its duties. But Shimei, while he violated the law under which he himself lived, forgot the rights of his servants. The law of Moses says, "Thou shalt not deliver unto his master the servant which is escaped from his master unto thee" (Deut. xxiii. 15). This seems, indeed, to relate to the servants of foreign masters, but it is understood to have awarded to Israelitish servants the protection to which others were entitled. Shimei was like the servant in the parable whose lord forgave him a large debt only because he asked forgiveness, but who, when he went out from his master's presence, seized a fellow-servant by the throat who owed him a very small sum, and refused to listen to his entreaties for mercy. Servants are types of things that serve, as of truths that serve goodness. But truths may be made to serve evil, and then they become slaves, not by consent but by compulsion.

When they assert their freedom and are forced back into slavery, they are deprived of the rights which belong to them, and are doubly oppressed. Everything connected with religion partakes of the freedom which religion confers, and which it breathes. Even the laws of Moses were founded on this principle, provision being made for the emancipation of those who, from any cause, had been reduced to servitude, and no one could be retained beyond the time of his release but by his own consent. Shimei, although he consented to the restriction laid upon his own movements, no doubt felt uneasy under the restraint, and asserted his freedom to bring his servants into bonds.

But his unlawful freedom cost him his life. So with those who deeply sin against the truth. If they continue within the limits which it assigns to them, they will save themselves alive, but if they transgress, the sword of truth will cut them in sunder, and appoint them their portion with the hypocrites.

Shimei was the last who fell under the sword of Benaiah of those who had transgressed in the time of David. And it is added, as the result of the removal of these discordant elements, that the kingdom was established in the hand of Solomon. In delivering the parable of the wheat and the tares, which relates to the time and the process of judgment, the Lord says of the angels, "They shall gather out of His kingdom all things that offend, and them which do iniquity. Then shall the righteous shine forth as the sun in the kingdom of their Father" (Matt. xiii. 41, 43). Divine judgment is designed to remove all things that offend against the laws of truth, and that sin against the laws of goodness, that righteousness may shine forth as the sun of love and truth in the kingdom of the Father, which is the kingdom of love that rules by wisdom. This is the kingdom represented by that of Solomon.

CHAPTER III.

SOLOMON'S CHOICE.

1 *Kings* iii. 1-14.

THE reign of Solomon is one of the most splendid in the annals of the world. Still more celebrated for his wisdom than for his magnificence, he raised the fame of the kingdom of which he was the temporal head to a degree so eminent as to make his reign the admiration, not only of his own but of every succeeding age. The foundation of his outward grandeur and prosperity had indeed been laid by the power and energy of his father David, who had subdued his enemies on every side, and done much to prepare the way for the pursuit of national wealth in the path of peaceful industry. But, like similar advantages, these would have availed but little had not the son of David followed up the work that had been so energetically begun. Hereditary advantages, unless wisely seized upon and employed, may prove a curse instead of a blessing; but cannot be greatly improved without the virtues necessary to advancement.

The reign of Solomon is not, however, to be regarded by us simply as a temporal sovereignty of great wisdom and grandeur. Solomon was an eminent type of Him who said of Himself, "Behold a greater

than Solomon is here." The history of Solomon is therefore one in which we have not merely an historical, but a spiritual and personal interest. It leads us to look through Solomon to that King who not only is wise, but in whom all wisdom dwells—who is wisdom itself, infinite and eternal; who by His wisdom stretched out the heavens and laid the foundations of the earth; who sitteth upon the flood and reigneth a King for ever. The kingdom over which this King reigneth consists not only of the material but of the spiritual universe. Wide and magnificent is this kingdom. The whole starry heaven with its countless myriads of planetary worlds is the material seat of His empire. These vast and glorious dominions He rules with such wisdom that all is preserved in perfect order, so as to result in one grand harmony, ever showing forth the praises of the Lord. "The heavens declare the glory of God, and the firmament showeth His handywork."

If this part of His dominions is vast and glorious, what must be the extent and glory of that where angels and spirits dwell! There are congregated the spirits of those who have peopled the planets of the starry heaven for thousands of ages; and who inhabit a universe spiritual but substantial, one as far exceeding in magnificence the material universe as mind exceeds matter, and the glories of which "eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, neither hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive."

But He whose dominion extends over the wide universe has His kingdom no less truly in every sincere lowly mind and humble heart. For the High and Lofty One that inhabiteth eternity itself dwells also with him that is of a contrite and humble spirit. Here is that kingdom in which our immediate interest centres. The kingdom of God within us is that in which we are most immediately and deeply interested, since it is this which gives us admission to the general kingdom of the Lord, as it exists in the Church on earth and in heaven. To the kingdom of God as it is in the human mind we are individually directed, when contemplating under a spiritual view the representative kingdom of Israel; and that kingdom in its highest state is presented before us when the kingdom under Solomon is the subject of our reflections.

The reign of Solomon, as distinguished from the reigns of Saul and David, is descriptive of the reign of truth in its highest condition, or in the highest region of the mind. Divine truth is first received in the memory, next in the understanding, and lastly in the will. It is first known, then understood, then loved. In the memory it is knowledge, in the understanding it is intelligence, in the will it is wisdom. These are the three degrees of the reception of truth, and the quality of the truth is determined by reception. And these degrees, and the different

kinds of government which exist under them, are described representatively by the successive reigns of these three kings of Israel.

In our reflections on the history of the kingdom of Israel, we have passed through the troubled reigns of Saul and of David, which place in a striking manner before us the tribulations and conflicts incident to the Christian, while wielding the truth as a sword against the corruptions of his own heart. We now come to the contemplation of a state in which these corruptions are so far removed as to admit of a more peaceful condition of mind, one in which the good rather than the truth, the love rather than the light of religion rules in the heart and understanding. It is under the rule of love that peace prevails, that justice triumphs, that prosperity advances, and that the temple of the Lord is erected in the human mind.

When the history is applied in this particular way to the mind of the regenerating Christian, Solomon is to be understood as representing the Lord, not only as He is in Himself, but as He is in man—in those who are of a contrite and humble spirit. It is the Lord in us that inspires us with every good desire, as well as with every true thought, and that leads us to every wise choice. The choice of Solomon is the choice to which the Lord guides every one who sincerely desires to be led of Him, as the only wise God our Saviour. This subject we now come to consider; and we trust it may be the means of both inclining and leading us to the attainment of the best gift of heaven—the wisdom of being led by the Lord and not by self.

The series of the history leads us first to consider that state of mind which disposes us to ask and prepares us to receive the wisdom that cometh from above. When God appeared to Solomon in a dream, and desired him to ask what He should give him, the first feeling that was excited in the mind of the young king was a sense of his deficiencies. "Thou hast made Thy servant king instead of David my father: and I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in." The first step to true wisdom is a sense of our own ignorance. This sense does not imply a state of ignorance. Ignorance does not see itself. Knowledge reveals it; and some advancement in knowledge is necessary before ignorance can be truly discovered. A sense of our own ignorance can only exist when we have made such an advancement in knowledge as to see that what we know is as nothing in comparison with what we do not know. That which Solomon confessed was not absolute but relative ignorance. He saw himself at the head of a great people that could not be numbered nor counted for multitude; and he was oppressed with a consciousness of his inability adequately to perform the duties of a judge and ruler amongst them. He was better able to discharge the duties of his high office than if, with the same amount of knowledge and discernment,

he had been entirely satisfied with himself. But he never would have reached the excellence to which he attained had he not been wise enough to see how much there was to acquire that he did not possess, and had he not been humble enough to acknowledge his deficiencies, as compared with the demands that would be made upon him. These are the conditions of the understanding and the heart that give the promise of true wisdom. But to be wise in our own eyes, and to be puffed up with notions of our own superior wisdom, closes the mind against the admission of that high gift, and leaves us only full of ourselves.

Each of us, like Solomon, has a kingdom, to govern which judgment and discernment are necessary. We are required to govern in our own minds and in our own affairs. In the mind are innumerable affections and thoughts; and an understanding heart is required, more than in anything else, to enable us to discern between the good and the bad, the true and the false. The affections are good or bad, as they grow out of the love of God or the love of self; and the thoughts are true or false as they favour those affections, by reasons grounded in the truth of God or by reasonings drawn from our own carnal wisdom. We cannot discern between these, so as to judge of their real character, from any light of our own. Evil does not feel itself to be evil, falsity does not see itself to be false. So far as we judge of ourselves from our own will and wisdom, we judge unrighteous judgment; and rather reverse than confirm the judgment of heaven. For we are all alike naturally disposed to call good evil and evil good, and to put darkness for light and light for darkness. No one in an earthly court and in worldly affairs is qualified to be the judge of his own cause. How much less in matters of eternity; in the court of our own mind, if we are our own witness, and our own judge to acquit or condemn. Every spiritual and eternal matter must be brought to God, by being submitted to the law and to the testimony, which He has given for deciding every controversy, not only between man and man, but between man and God—between the cause of God and that of self in the court of the human conscience. There it is that judgment is to be pronounced by every one of us. And if we would have a conscience void of offence towards God and man we must be conscious of our own inability to pronounce from day to day a judgment that is just in the sight of heaven, and must desire above all things to receive the necessary wisdom from the Lord. To receive this wisdom we must become little children, not only in intellect but in heart—conscious not only of how little we know, but how little we are, so little that we know not how to go out or to come in. These words are peculiarly appropriate from the lips of Solomon; for they have relation, not to the leading of the people out to war and into peace after victory, but

are expressive of the guiding of a flock by their shepherd. In this way it is applied by Moses to the leader of the congregation who should be appointed after his death, and is afterwards used in the New Testament in reference to the people of whom the Lord is the shepherd. Moses says, "Let the Lord, the God of the spirits of all flesh, set a man over the congregation, which may go out before them, and which may lead them out, and which may bring them in; that the congregation of the Lord be not as sheep which have no shepherd" (Num. xxvii. 16, 17). The Lord says, "I am the door: by Me if any man enter in, he shall be saved, and shall go in and out, and find pasture. I am the good shepherd" (John x. 9, 11). These alternate acts of going out and coming in are those by which the mind is continually perfected, and by which the Christian is enabled to follow the Lord in doing His will. We go out when we engage in the affairs of the world and in the business of life, and we go in when we turn our attention inwards or retire within ourselves. We retire within ourselves for self-examination and for the cultivation of those graces that should enrich the mind, and we go out into the world in the performance of our duties, in which we practise the virtues that should adorn the life.

If we have now been enabled more clearly to see and more powerfully to feel the necessity for and the value of that gift for which Solomon prayed, we may turn our attention to the gift itself which he desired. "Give Thy servant an understanding heart to judge Thy people, that I may discern between good and bad. And God said, Behold, I have given thee a wise and an understanding heart."

An understanding, a hearing, a discerning heart was the gift, of all others, that Solomon desired; and the Lord gave him a heart both to be wise and to understand. This double portion of the Divine Spirit gives the power of discerning between good and evil, and between the true and the false. The higher gift, which always implies, when it does not express, the presence of the other, is that to which we shall advert; by pointing out the origin and distinctive character of true wisdom.

Wisdom has its origin in God, as has everything good and true. But every gift of God is to be obtained by something else than simply asking for it. There must be a preparation to receive it. And that preparation is made by a constant view to the end or use which it is designed to serve, and by the employment of the means for securing it. Wisdom is not knowledge, nor is it even intelligence, although it cannot exist without them. The greatest amount of knowledge, the highest degree of intelligence, cannot constitute wisdom. They differ, not in extent only, but in kind. Intelligence is more of the head, wisdom is more of the heart. The distinguishing characteristic of wisdom is, that it is not of the understanding chiefly, but of the will;

that it is not truth only, but truth united to goodness ; that it is not faith only, but faith united to love ; that it is not speculative but practical. Wisdom is knowledge and intelligence applied to life. It does not consist in knowing many things, but in using those which are known, whether they be few or many, to the glory of God, the welfare of the neighbour, and the good of our own souls, which make up the perfection of human life.

When Solomon had set his heart upon wisdom, as that which was above all other things calculated to adorn his kingly office and exalt and bless the kingdom to which Providence had called him, he not only received that largeness of heart which he desired, but he obtained along with it the things which he thought undeserving of so solemn a prayer, but which so many in all situations of life, and especially in his, are disposed to regard as the chief good. The choice was given him by One who was able to give him what he thought good to ask : "Ask what I shall give thee," said the Disposer of all things. Is not this choice still offered to the children of men ? And if men were unselfish enough to covet the best gifts, the less precious would be given, at least in such measure as would be consistent with the preservation and ascendancy of the first. "Because," said the Lord, "thou hast asked this thing, and hast not asked for thyself long life ; neither hast thou asked riches for thyself, nor hast asked the life of thine enemies ; I have done according to thy words : and I have also given thee that which thou hast not asked, both riches, and honour : and if thou wilt walk in My ways, and keep My statutes and My commandments, then I will lengthen thy days." Riches and honour, in the spiritual sense, are the riches of knowledge and the exaltation connected with it, and long life, or many days, are the states of the spiritual life, both in time and eternity, that result from obedience to the will of God. But even these lesser gifts, when given to those who desire and receive wisdom, assume a different character, because they occupy a different place in the affections of the heart. Being regarded not as ends but as means, they are subservient to the aims and efforts of wisdom, and are the ministers in its works of judgment and justice. The knowledge which leads to wisdom, or the truth which leads to goodness, is different from that which follows wisdom. The knowledge which precedes wisdom is more of our own acquisition, that which follows wisdom is more the gift of God, and has more of God in it and less of self : it is bestowed of the Divine bounty upon those who have the greater possession.

In the New Testament this result of the better choice is declared plainly and emphatically : "Seek ye first the kingdom of God, and His righteousness ; and all these things shall be added unto you." Wisdom is the principal thing. It is the one thing needful ; and he who

chooses that good part will not only secure it, but will obtain with it, and indeed in it, all things necessary for life eternal.

As true wisdom comes from heaven, it is known by its heavenly character, as distinguished from that which is earth-born. Wisdom is justified of all her children, whether they be children of light or children of darkness. "Who is a wise man," says James, "and endued with knowledge among you? let him show out of a good conversation his works with meekness of wisdom. But if ye have bitter envying and strife in your hearts, glory not, and lie not against the truth. This wisdom descendeth not from above, but is earthly, sensual, devilish. But the wisdom that is from above is first pure, then peaceable, gentle, and easy to be intreated, full of mercy and good fruits, without partiality, and without hypocrisy" (iii. 13-17). Be this wisdom the object of our choice; let its fruits be manifested in our lives; and then indeed will its benign influences diffuse around us, as it will establish within us, the spirit of all that is lovely and blessed.

CHAPTER IV.

SOLOMON'S FIRST AND WISE JUDGMENT.

1 *Kings* iii. 27.

THE first judgment of Solomon is the finest instance of extemporaneous judicature that is to be found in the records of any age or country. The wisdom of that judgment has been so highly and widely appreciated, that with a difference of personal attribution, it has found a place in the traditions or the literature of several other nations.

When we take into view all the circumstances of the case, we must be convinced that the judgment of Solomon is altogether worthy of the high fame which has attended it.

In Oriental nations, legal machinery was much more simple, and legal proceedings much more summary, than in the nations of the West, and particularly than in those of modern Europe. But this simplicity often rendered judicial cases much more difficult and onerous for the judge. The sovereign, who was the supreme judge, when he exercised the judicial part of his office, generally united in himself the various functions which, with us, are divided between the counsel, the jury, and the chief justice. There was no long array of witnesses to accuse and to exculpate: no professional counsel using their utmost efforts, on the one hand to criminate, and on the other to exonerate; to examine and cross-examine witnesses, to analyze and sift the evidence, and to employ all their legal knowledge and rhetorical powers

to place the case in its best or in its worst light, according to their opposite aims. There was no jury to deliberate and decide upon the guilt or innocence of the accused party; leaving the judge to preside over the whole proceedings, and pronounce sentence according to the law. All this, to whatever extent it was done, was done by the judge himself, and by the sovereign when he acted in that capacity. Besides this difference in the forms of procedure, the trial often followed immediately upon the commission or discovery of the crime, without any previous knowledge of the case on the part of the judge. This comparatively simple mode of judicial proceeding, in which so much depended on the talents or even the temper of the judge, frequently made it necessary for him to have recourse to ingenious expedients with a view to discover the truth and enable him to pronounce a just decision. And it appears to be the genius of the Oriental mind to be more ingenious than profound, more quick to penetrate than patient to investigate.

The case in which Solomon, then only about twenty years of age, was first called upon to adjudicate, might well have put to a severe test the wisdom of an older man and a more experienced judge. Two women appeared before the king. "The one woman said, O my lord, I and this woman dwell in one house; and I was delivered of a child with her in the house. And it came to pass the third day after that I was delivered, that this woman was delivered also: and we were together; there was no stranger with us in the house, save we two in the house. And this woman's child died in the night; because she overlaid it. And she arose at midnight, and took my son from beside me, while thine handmaid slept, and laid it in her bosom, and laid her dead child in my bosom."

The difficulty of this case is well stated by the king himself. "The one saith, This is my son that liveth, and thy son is the dead: and the other saith, Nay; but thy son is the dead, and my son is the living." How was such a case to be decided? The women themselves are the only witnesses, and one seems to be as much entitled to credit as the other. Their testimony is opposed; there seems no way to discover the truth. The spectators no doubt felt the difficulty which the king expressed. Some may have believed that the youthful judge was as much perplexed as they themselves were; and they may be supposed to have been keenly anxious to see how he would extricate himself from so difficult a position. Others perhaps remembered that God had appeared to him in a dream, and promised him the precious gift which he had asked, the gift of wisdom; and they expected to see his wisdom exemplified in the judgment he was about to pronounce. What then must have been their disappointment and even their horror when, after commanding a sword to be brought, they

heard the king utter the sentence, "Divide the living child in two, and give half to the one, and half to the other." In this feigned judgment, which those who heard it must have regarded as the result of weakness or of cruelty, lay the secret of the judge's power. Besides the varied knowledge of the king, who "spake of trees, from the cedar-tree that is in Lebanon, even unto the hyssop that springeth out of the wall; who spake also of beasts, and of fowls, and of creeping things and of fishes," he possessed that higher knowledge which is more entitled to the name of wisdom, the knowledge of the human heart. Unable to discover the truth from the statements of the women themselves, though he no doubt suspected it, he had resolved to make an appeal to their maternal instincts, their motherly nature. He judged that the impending fate of the child would bring out the feelings of the mother's heart, and enable him to distinguish, by an infallible sign, between the real and the pretended parent. In this he was not mistaken. Solomon's expectation was fully realized. When the infant's life was in danger, "then spake the woman whose the living child was unto the king, for her bowels yearned upon her son, and she said, O my lord, give her the living child, and in no wise slay it. But the other said, Let it be neither mine nor thine, but divide it." How must the horror of the spectators have been turned into admiration, if not melted into tenderness, when the king pronounced his real and final judgment: "Give HER the living child, and in no wise slay it: SHE is the mother thereof."

Admiration of this decision was not confined to the king's court. His fame extended far beyond it. "All Israel heard of the judgment which the king had judged; and they feared the king: for they saw that the wisdom of God was in him, to do judgment."

In the record of this judgment every one will acknowledge, not only the wisdom of Solomon, but the faithfulness of the description, as true to nature, of the exhibition of feeling by the mother of the living child. She loved the child as her son, and ardently desired that it might be restored to her. But much as she loved it as her offspring, she loved it still more for its own sake; and she was willing to resign it into the hands of her adversary to save it from destruction. Not so the mother of the dead child, she was willing not only to lose it but to see it die. There may seem indeed something of inconsistency in the represented conduct of this woman. Why should she, who had stolen the child of another, and had borne false witness to prove it her own, yet prefer to see it slain rather than it should be restored to its real mother?

With Hebrew women the desire for children was a passion. But this passion sprang not always from the love of the innocents themselves, but from the love of that honour which the possession of chil-

dren conferred. The love of their children might therefore be nothing but the love of themselves. And indeed all really evil parents do not love their children for their children's sake, but for their own: they love themselves in their children. The consequence is, that they do not love, but inwardly hate, all other children but their own: and so intense is this hatred, that, according to the testimony of Swedenborg, in the other life, where the inward disposition comes into full and undisguised manifestation, wicked mothers desire to tear in pieces all other children than those whom they believe to be their own. If this testimony is true, the conduct of this woman is a correct representation of the character of such a one as she may reasonably be supposed to have been.

But the judgment of Solomon, interesting and instructive as it is as a subject of sacred history, viewed only in its literal sense, is still more interesting and instructive when regarded as representative of a subject intimately connected with the spiritual interests of mankind, and significative of spiritual states and circumstances in the regenerating process, by which we are born anew.

Solomon was one of the most distinguished representatives of the Lord Jesus Christ, as the Ruler of the kingdom established in righteousness and peace.

In Scripture, women, in their general typical character, represent the Church. And the first judgment of Solomon has reference to the state of the Church. The careless and unnatural woman who overlay her child, laying her dead infant in her neighbour's bosom, and taking and claiming the living child of her companion as her own, yet willing to see that innocent destroyed, represented the Jewish Church; while the woman whose the living child was, and who was willing to relinquish it living rather than see it put to death, represented the Gentile Church.

These women, it is true, are called harlots. But this does not render the representation the less but the more true and striking. For both the Jews and the Gentiles are described as having turned away from God, and become worshippers of idols; and as the Lord is the Husband of His Church, as well as the Father of His people, all idolatry is described in the Old Testament as spiritual fornication and adultery. In Hosea the Lord, addressing the children of His people, says, "Plead with your mother, plead: for she is not my wife, neither am I her husband; for their mother hath played the harlot: she that conceived them hath done shamefully" (ii. 2, 5). The Jewish Church is not only accused of having departed from the Lord as her true Husband, but as having in her skirts the blood of the souls of poor innocents (Jer. ii. 34), by which the Jewish people are accused of having done violence to innocence itself. For innocence is the inmost

life of true religion, of love to God and love to man; and where there is no innocence there is no spiritual life in the Church.

The Jewish Church, represented by the woman with the dead child, had destroyed in herself every principle of spiritual innocence; a destruction which was represented also by the massacre, by Herod, of the infants in Bethlehem, with the view of destroying the Infant Jesus, who was innocence itself; and by whose preservation that of the human race was effected through redemption.

The Gentiles, represented by the woman whose the living child was, though addicted to the sin of idolatry, were yet in a much less corrupt state and less debased condition than the Jews who despised them, and who regarded them as sinners, while they considered themselves as alone righteous. Not only had the Jews destroyed all innocence and all truth in themselves, but they had taken from the heathen, with whom they had been mingled, many of the principles which formed their religion, and appropriated them as their own; till the Lord came into the world, when the judgment which He performed disclosed their true nature, and deprived them of their assumed character and possessions.

But there was another and a still higher antitype to this circumstance in the spiritual world, where judgment has its cause and its beginning, and which is the scene of every general judgment.

It is there more especially that the tares and the wheat grow up together until the harvest. And these tares, we may observe, were sown while men slept, as the woman laid her dead child in her neighbour's bosom while she was asleep, in the silence and darkness of the night. It is also in that world more especially that the tares and the wheat, the good and the evil, the true and the false, are finally separated from each other; that from him that hath not is taken away that which he seemeth to have—that the good and truth which he has assumed, but which is not his own, is taken from him and given to him that hath, that he may have abundance. It is there, indeed, that a just and final judgment assigns to each that which is his own.

Even in this world something of this takes place, as its correlative. In every case of human degeneracy, the line which marks the separation between good and evil, between the true and the false, becomes less and less distinct, until, in some things at least, the boundary-line is obliterated, and the perception of the real difference between them is lost. And every act of Divine judgment is for this, among other purposes, to restore the knowledge, which had been taken away, of the difference between the clean and the unclean, that a separation may be effected between them. This effect of human degeneracy has been too fully realized in the past history of the Christian Church itself. But we cannot look around us without being convinced that the line of distinction which

men had obliterated is again appearing—that the distinction between the true and the false, the good and the evil, is again beginning to be seen more clearly; that the dead and the living child are being assigned to their rightful owners; that truth and innocence are being more appropriated to the good, and the evil are being left more fully to their own natural destitution. And indeed it is one of the effects of such judgments that the yearning heart shall find the object of its desires and affections—that a good head and heart shall understand truth, and feel the satisfaction of goodness. For the days are come in which the kingdom of righteousness is restored, and justice and judgment reign.

There is a still more particular sense and a more pointed application of this interesting relation to be noticed.

In the woman who was the mother of the dead child, we may see the character of those who, by a careless or abandoned life, entirely destroy innocence in themselves; who make no scruple to rob others of their innocence; and who would, without compunction, destroy the innocence and peace of their neighbour, even when they themselves can reap no advantage from their neighbour's loss. It is the very nature and constant effort of the wicked to lay their own dead principles in the bosoms of others, and to assume a life which is not their own. Such persons desire happiness as ardently as others, and wish to be admitted into heaven, if they have any belief in heaven, because they believe that happiness is there to be found. They can appear at the marriage without the wedding garment; or can ask from others, their companions, the oil of goodness, which they have neglected to procure for themselves, or having procured have lost, that they may revive their dying lamps, to light them on their way to an abode for which they are not prepared. But the door is shut against them.

In the woman who was the mother of the living child we see the character of those who, though erring, are yet in the love of innocence and truth for their own sake; and who, though subject to trials from the machinations of the selfish and impure, will be delivered by the final interposition of a protective and overruling Providence.

We may briefly trace the analogy of this subject still further, and point out its application to the individual mind. The two women in one house are emblems of two affections in one mind—one genuine and the other spurious, one true and the other false. And in Solomon's judgment we have a type of the highest and best means of discerning between the genuine and the spurious, the true and the false, in regard to the principle of goodness in ourselves. In judging, we form our decisions either from outward evidence or from inward discernment, or from both together. Our judgments for the most part rest on their united testimony. But there are cases in which outward evidence

may be insufficient, or in which there may be a seeming balance of testimony that leaves the mind in suspense. The genuineness or the Divinity of the Scriptures, for instance, is with some a subject of doubt, and is both affirmed and denied by those who judge of them by external evidence alone. We do not say that external testimony in this case is of no force, but it is obvious that it is of itself insufficient. Is there no means by which men disposed to judge justly are able to arrive at a certain and right conclusion? Solomon's judgment enables us to see that there is. Affection will sometimes enable us to untie a knot which thought makes but the faster. When the understanding is unable to determine, the heart will often give the true decision. The conscience will often enable us to see at once what a long process of reasoning cannot enable us to discover. We are sometimes at a loss how to judge and act, when a balance of reasons are present to the mind. Two different affections may each claim to be the mother of the living child—to be the parent of vital innocence. Do not natural and spiritual affection sometimes display this character? Does not natural affection at times maintain that natural delights are living, and that spiritual delights are dead? and yet natural delights, so far as they have any vitality in them, derive their life from spiritual affection; and if the delights are merely natural, they are stolen from the spiritual, and claimed by the natural as its own. There is nothing of vitality and innocence in natural delight but what it draws from spiritual affection. How is this to be discovered? Spiritual affection has a heart of goodness in it that can be appealed to; natural affection is heartless, or it is a heart of stone, that is susceptible of no tender emotions or disinterested affections. It is by appealing to this inner nature of affection that we can, in any doubtful case, discern between the genuine and the spurious; and that will enable us, without the shadow of a doubt, to say which is the spiritual affection and which is the natural, and to restore to the arms of the true mother the innocence which the false would willingly have seen divided, and thus dissipated and destroyed.

Let us remember that, in the language of the apostle, we must all appear before the judgment-seat of Christ, to receive according to the deeds done in the body, whether they be good or evil. We shall not, as is too often the case among men, be judged by what we say, but by what we are. The Lord looketh upon the heart; and through the heart we shall be judged, according to our works, our works being such as our hearts are. In that day the secrets of all hearts shall be revealed, and every one will be rewarded according to his work. Happy will it be for those who have cherished innocence. Whatsoever may have been their trials, the innocence which they have borne and nourished will be restored to their own bosom.

CHAPTER V.

THE POWERFUL SECURITY ENJOYED UNDER SOLOMON'S REIGN.

2 Kings iv. 21.

THAT earthly government is the best which secures to those who live under it, not only general protection from enemies without, but particular protection from enemies within; which removes all fear that the rights of private property and the sanctities of private life will be invaded, and which leaves the people in the undisturbed possession of liberty to cultivate the virtues, and enjoy the pleasures, of domestic life. That is the highest condition of national security when the inhabitants, like the subjects of Solomon, "dwell safely, every man under his vine and under his fig-tree." In the spiritual kingdom of the Lord Jesus Christ these two kinds of security are preserved inviolate. The external enemies to the stability and peace of the Lord's kingdom are the powers of darkness. The enemies who consist of the wicked in the world are the instruments by whom these act in the outer circles of the spiritual life. Of these there is no reason to fear, if the inner life can be preserved in connection with Him who is its author and preserver, and if the inward enemies of the heart itself do not obtain power over us. These enemies are our own evil ends, tempers, and lusts. The Lord by His works of redemption and salvation has provided for the security of every one against *all* the power of the enemy, both from within and from without, and for the enjoyment, by every loyal and virtuous subject of His kingdom, of the blessings of safety and prosperity. In His kingdom "Judah and Israel dwell safely, every man under his vine and under his fig-tree."

The particular and general, or the internal and external government of the Lord's kingdom are described representatively by those of Solomon in this chapter. Besides princes, priests, and other high officers, there were twelve officers over all Israel, who provided victuals for the king and his household: each man his month in a year. This distinction and subordination among the rulers in the kingdom represent such as exist in the Lord's kingdom, in heaven, in the Church, and in the human mind. In the Lord's kingdom, the principles of charity hold the highest place, and second and subordinate to these are the principles of faith. Among the highest officers of Solomon were the two high priests whose function corresponded to the ministry of love. The twelve lower officers with their monthly service points out their function as analogous to the ministry of faith. In the spirit-

ual sense periods of time signify states of life. A month, originally derived from the duration of the moon, and here expressed by it, is emblematical of a state of faith—the grace of faith being the "lesser light" which God places in the firmament of the inner man; and dependent upon and subordinate to the "greater light" of love and charity.

In accordance with this analogy, the tree of life in the Christian paradise bears twelve manner of fruits, and yields her fruits every month. For the vital principle of religion, which is love or charity, produces fruits according to the states of faith which exist in connection with it. Love is life in its essence and origin, but love has its development through faith, and has a quality according to it. Love in the soul is like heat in nature. Love is the proximate cause of spiritual, as heat is of animal and vegetable, life. Faith in the soul is like light in nature. Faith is the instrumental cause of the manifestation of spiritual life, as light is of natural life, in forms of beauty and fruitfulness.

The daily provision which we are enabled to make by faith working from love is the supply of the spiritual means of supporting the life of the soul. For the soul, not less than the body, requires to be sustained and fed, and to receive a daily supply—more especially in every recurring state of the spiritual life. The life of love in the soul is like the fire that burned upon the altar, which, to prevent its going out, was supplied with wood every morning. So has the love of God in the soul to be fed continually with instruction and practice in righteousness, to prevent its extinction, and to renew its power.

The provision of Solomon for one, or for each day, consisted of thirty measures of fine flour and threescore measures of meal, ten fat oxen, twenty oxen out of the pastures, and a hundred sheep, besides harts, and roebucks, and fallow deer, and fatted fowl. So does the provision for the spiritual life, comprehended here under the general name of bread, and all which is expressed by the "daily bread" of the Lord's Prayer, include all the principles of goodness and truth, celestial, spiritual, and natural. The fine and common flour denote celestial truth, derived from good, as flour is from wheat, and from which the good that supports celestial life in the soul is formed, and which good is specifically meant by bread. The animals of the flock and herd are the internal and external goods of the spiritual class, sheep especially denoting principles of charity. The untamed denizens of the field are the various principles of good and truth in the natural mind, or those of the most external character. The numbers, of which three predominates in the first class and ten in the second, are expressive of their quality, as being, like the trine in all things and the decade in many things, perfect in itself, and complete in its development.

While Solomon had his kingdom organized so wisely by these internal arrangements, that everything was preserved in order, his dominion extended over other kingdoms which served him and were tributary to him. "Solomon reigned over all kingdoms from the river unto the land of the Philistines, and unto the border of Egypt: they brought presents, and served Solomon all the days of his life. For he had dominion over all the region on this side the river, from Tiphsah even to Azzah, over all the kings on this side the river: and he had peace on all sides round about him." This extensive dominion of Solomon was intended to represent the spiritual dominion of the Lord in His glory, which is indeed described prophetically in almost the same words. In the 72nd Psalm, which literally relates to Solomon, but prophetically, as is evident, to the Saviour God and King, the extent of His kingdom is thus described, at the 8th verse: "He shall have dominion also from sea to sea, and from the river unto the ends of the earth. . . . All kings shall fall down before Him: all nations shall serve Him." These same words occur in the prophecy of Zechariah, in connection with those applied in the Gospel to our Lord: "Rejoice greatly, O daughter of Zion; shout, O daughter of Jerusalem: behold, thy King cometh unto thee: He is just, and having salvation; lowly, and riding upon an ass, and upon a colt the foal of an ass. His dominion shall be from sea even to sea, and from the river even to the ends of the earth" (ix. 9, 10). The extent of Solomon's dominion represented therefore the extent of the dominion of our Lord, specifically under the last best dispensation of His Church on earth, in which His love and wisdom shall be, more perfectly than before, the ruling principles in the minds and lives of men. The dominion of the Lord, as described by that of Solomon, is over the whole land, from east to west, from north to south. From east to west, which was from sea to sea, is the extension of the Lord's dominion over the mind in regard to states of goodness, and from north to south, which was from the river to the ends of the earth, is the extension of dominion over the mind in regard to all states of truth. The particular description of Solomon's dominion extending over all kingdoms, from the river Euphrates, that is, from Assyria, to the land of the Philistines, and to the river of Egypt, is descriptive of the Lord's dominion over the whole mind, from the rational to the scientific, or, from the highest perceptions of reason to the lowest acquisitions of sense. In the human mind there are three things that succeed in order, the rational, the natural, and the corporeal. These three parts of man wonderfully communicate, the corporeal with the natural, the natural with the rational. At birth man is merely corporeal, afterwards he becomes natural, and at length rational. These three constitute man; for humanity begins in the inmost of the rational

and terminates in the ultimate of the sensual. These, in their regenerate state, are the Assyria, Philistia, and Egypt to which the dominion of Solomon extends. But he is said to have reigned over all kingdoms between the Euphrates and the Nile, meaning that, besides being the ruler of his own kingdom, all other kingdoms were subject and tributary to him. We have seen that David subdued the nations bordering on Canaan; and that these represented such hereditary qualities as can be brought under subjection to spiritual principles, and can be made to contribute to the uses of the spiritual life. All these are now said to be in a state of entire submission to Solomon, who reigns over them; and they bring presents, and serve him; and this shall continue all the days of his life.

While all is submission and service without, all is peace, security, and enjoyment within. Judah and Israel are many, as the sand which is by the sea in multitude, eating and drinking, and making merry. And Judah and Israel dwell safely, every man under his vine and under his fig-tree, from Dan even to Beersheba, all the days of Solomon.

This is the state of the regenerate mind, when the affections of goodness and truth are multiplied indefinitely, and when they appropriate with delight the goods and truths of the Word as the meat and drink of the soul. This too is the state of peace, when "they dwell safely, every man under his vine and under his fig-tree, from Dan even to Beersheba;" when they live under the influence of spiritual and natural goodness, from the inmost even to the outermost of their life.

The beautiful imagery here employed to describe the peaceful and happy state of the Lord's spiritual Judah and Israel, is used in the prophets to describe the then future state of the Church, after and consequent on the coming of the Lord. Thus in the prophecy of Micah: "They shall beat their swords into ploughshares, and their spears into pruning-hooks: nation shall not lift up a sword against nation, neither shall they learn war any more. But they shall sit every man under his vine and under his fig-tree; and none shall make them afraid: for the mouth of the Lord of Hosts hath spoken it" (iv. 3, 4). The end of war is the conclusion of the conflict, in the mind and life of the Christian, which consists in the flesh warring against the spirit and the spirit against the flesh. This spiritual warfare does come to an end in those who suffer themselves to be regenerated; and peace, true spiritual and enduring peace, follows the conquest of the evils of the heart and life. Then it is that the swords are actually beat into ploughshares and the spears into pruning-hooks; for the Divine truths of the Word that had served to defend him against and to destroy the evil and false principles of his corrupt nature are capable of being applied, and are applied, to the cultivation of the mind, and its advancement in the life that produces the peaceable fruits of righteousness. The vine and the fig,

under the shadow of which the mind reposes, are the productions of the mind itself. Nothing that is without us, or separate from ourselves, can be either a shadow from the heat or a covert from the storm. True it is, the Lord is the vine; we are but the branches; and so far from our having any vitality in ourselves, except we abide in the vine we are cut off as withered branches, fit only to be cast into the fire and burned. But while it is true that we live and grow and bear fruit only while we abide in the vine, it is no less true that the life of the vine is communicated to us, and circulates through us, and produces in us the similitude of itself. The Lord compares His kingdom to a man who planted a vineyard and let it out to husbandmen. But where does He plant His vineyard but in the minds and hearts of His people? And the vine can be planted, as the seed of the kingdom can be sown, only in the good ground of an honest heart. The vine and fig-tree under which the regenerate dwell safely are first implanted by the Lord, and grow up under His care during their progressive advancement in a life of intelligence and virtue. His is the life which enters into and perfects them; but ours is the power to determine whether or not the Divine life shall be received and manifested in the growth of the mind in truth and love, and of the life in holiness.

If we would enjoy that state of security and peace which this imagery so expressively depicts, we must, like the husbandmen in the parable of the Lord, use the means. We must work in the vineyard and dig about the fig-tree and dung it. We must also use the ploughshare and the pruning-hook, as we have previously used the sword and the spear. We must have broken up the fallow ground, and we must keep the ground in cultivation: we must also, like the Divine Husbandman Himself, prune the tree of withered or exuberant branches, that the fruit-producing power may be preserved and improved. When the labour of combat has ceased, this work of love must continue; and its reward is security and delight.

CHAPTER VI.

PREPARATIONS FOR BUILDING THE TEMPLE.

1 *Kings* v.

THE building of the temple of Jerusalem was the great achievement, as it was the great glory, of Solomon's reign. Viewed in any other light than as a typical work it might be unwise to regard as the greatest glory of a monarch's reign the erection of an edifice, even for the worship of God, at so great an expenditure of a nation's wealth.

There are many other ways in which a sovereign and people can manifest their piety besides the rearing of magnificent temples. The greatest triumphs of architectural skill, encouraged by the greatest expenditure of wealth, are not always identified with the purest worship. Yet the temple of Solomon, when the case is fully considered, did not involve so vast an expenditure of the national wealth as may at first sight appear. The temple at Jerusalem was the one only place in the whole of Palestine where the worship of Jehovah was celebrated. The expense, therefore, might not be so great, when compared with that of the numerous churches which Christian nations provide for the performance of public worship. But uniqueness as well as magnificence was no doubt required to render the Jewish temple an adequate representative of its great Antitype. As Solomon himself was the highest regal representative of the Lord, who was to be born into the world as the King of the Jews, the temple which he reared was the highest representative of the bodily temple, in which the Sovereign of the universe was pleased to manifest Himself to men on earth. That Body—that Humanity—in which the Divine Majesty clothed Himself, and came down with shaded glory to the abodes of men, was ONE. The human nature which our Lord assumed was akin to universal humanity; but from the first, and still more at the last, the Lord's humanity, in relation to our common humanity, stood alone. The community and yet separateness of the Lord's humanity, both by nativity and resurrection—by its first and second birth—is variously expressed in the language of inspiration, both verbally and representatively. "Thou spakest in vision to Thy holy one, and saidst, I have laid help upon one that is mighty; I have exalted one chosen out of the people." He was of the seed of David, yet refused to be called the son of David. By birth He was the Son of God as well as the seed of David; by resurrection He ceased to be the seed of David, having by glorification put off all that He inherited from him through the Virgin Mary; and was wholly the Son of God, because His humanity was Divine. He was the true Nazarite to God from His mother's womb. He came in the likeness of sinful flesh, being made in all things like unto His brethren, yet in His life He was holy, undefiled, and separate from sinners. As the Son of Mary He was one of us, as the Son of God He was infinitely superior to all finite beings. But although the humanity, inwardly Divine by conception, became wholly Divine by glorification, this does not destroy, but rather increases, His affinity to us. It does not make Him less but more human, and therefore brings Him nearer and closer to everything that is truly human in us, and enables Him to make us more and more like unto Himself, by which we have a nearer relationship to Him and more intimate conjunction with Him.

Solomon's temple, representing, in its highest sense, the Lord's Humanity, the Temple of His essential and eternal Divinity, the holy temple in which we are enabled to approach and worship Him as our Creator and Redeemer, it must be to the Christian a subject of the highest interest.

Yet the interest and instructiveness of the sacred edifice do not end here. While, in its highest sense, the temple is the symbol of the Lord's own glorious Body, it is also the symbol of His mystical Body, consisting of Heaven and the Church, and, still more particularly considered, the symbol of the regenerate man, as one in whose purified soul the Lord has His dwelling-place. Between these there is an analogy as well as a connection; for both the grand or greatest man, consisting of Heaven and the Church, and the least man, consisting of the regenerate mind, are the creations and the images of the Divine Man, as He exists and is known to us in the person of the Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ.

Regarding this subject more especially as it relates to us as beings whom the Divine Architect ever desires to build up into temples of His Holy Spirit, we may with great advantage turn our attention to some of the leading parts of the inspired record, in which the building and dedication of the temple is described.

We need not enter very minutely into this subject. In its general arrangement, and in many of its particulars, the temple bears a close resemblance to the tabernacle of Moses; and this has been so minutely explained in the work of Swedenborg on Genesis and Exodus, that it would occupy space unnecessarily to enter into the details of a subject which any one can find minutely and luminously explained elsewhere. There are, however, differences as well as similarities between these two structures, both of which were no doubt built according to the pattern of things in the heavens; and these distinctions, as being intended for our instruction, it must be useful to consider.

In the previous chapter of this Book of Kings we find the work of preparation commenced on a scale of extraordinary magnitude. Hiram king of Tyre unites with Solomon in procuring and preparing the materials for the building of the Lord's house. More than a hundred and fifty thousand Israelites are employed, in conjunction with the Sidonians, of whom the number is not given, in preparing timber and stones to build the temple. The timber was of cedar and fir, and the stones were great stones, costly stones, hewed stones, to lay the foundation of the house.

The general difference between the tabernacle and the temple consisted in one being constructed of wood and the other of stone. This marks the general difference of their representative character, the tabernacle representing the Church as to the principle goodness,

and the temple the Church as to the principle of truth, or the celestial and spiritual worship of the Lord. But the distinction is marked by other differences. That chiefly employed in the construction of the tabernacle was shittim-wood, but in the temple were employed the olive, the cedar, and the fir. The shittah and the olive tree have nearly the same signification, both denoting, in the highest sense, the Lord's love to man, and, in the secondary sense, man's love to the Lord. But there is this difference between them, that shittim-wood signifies the Lord's merit in effecting the work of man's redemption, and which forms the ground of man's salvation. The tabernacle, which was set up while the Church was yet in the wilderness, passing through tribulation, points to the humanity of the Lord as present with us in the earlier period of the spiritual, and even of the natural life, but the temple represents the humanity of the Lord as it is with us in the more advanced stage of our spiritual journey, when rest is obtained, when the Lord reigns and His kingdom is established both in the heart and in the mind, in the outward as well as in the inward man.

It may, however, seem inconsistent that the temple, which is a symbol of what is spiritual, should come after the tabernacle, which represents what is celestial, and that the temple should have been built by Solomon. The tabernacle was reared during the government of the priesthood, and belongs, therefore, representatively, to the government of the Lord as the High Priest of His Church. The temple was built during the government of the kings, and therefore belongs, representatively, to the government of the Lord as the Kingly Ruler of His Church. The Lord's priestly government is His government by love, and His kingly government is His government by wisdom. But in the progress of regeneration, in its most comprehensive view, the government of love precedes the government of wisdom. Regeneration commences at birth, and the infant soul is first under the influence of love, and it is at a more advanced period and state of life that he comes under the direction of wisdom. The regenerating soul is therefore a tabernacle before he is a temple, or, the tabernacle of love is reared in his heart before the temple of wisdom is built in his understanding. The love that is first implanted in the human heart is also a tabernacle that is taken down. For the first love is not enlightened love, and therefore not real or perfect love. When the mind comes to be instructed in religious knowledge, early love passes into wisdom, as the tabernacle passed into the temple. For the temple was a more elaborate tabernacle; all the essentials of the tabernacle being reproduced in the temple. When early love has been bathed, where it has been for a time lost, in the ocean of light which is wisdom, it reappears purified and exalted. And now it is "a tabernacle that shall not be taken down; not one of the stakes thereof shall ever be removed, neither shall any of the cords thereof

be broken" (Isa. xxxiii. 20). And now the tabernacle appears again alone, and yet not alone; for in the holy city New Jerusalem, which represents the Church in its best state and the Christian life in its highest perfection, the Revelator says, "Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men. . . . And I saw no temple therein: for the Lord God Almighty and the Lamb are the temple of it" (Rev. xxi. 3, 22). The temple, then, considered with reference to the advancing work of regeneration, no doubt represents the Church in its more complete development, and here the temple itself is identified with, or lost in, the glory of the Divine Humanity of the Lord. In the olive, the cedar, and the fir, we see the symbols of the three great and universal principles which constitute the Church in man, good celestial, spiritual, and the natural, or the good of love to the Lord, the good of charity to the neighbour, and the good of obedience to the Divine commandments. The stones of which the walls and especially the foundation of the house were formed, denote truth in its general acceptation, especially Divine truth as it is in the letter of the Holy Word, consisting of those universal truths which teach the essentials of all religion, the knowledge of God, of a life after death, of happiness as the result of goodness, and of misery as the consequence of evil. These are the great stones, the costly stones, the hewed stones, that form the foundation of the Church and heaven in every regenerate mind. Of these, the knowledge and practical acknowledgment of the Lord Jesus Christ as the only God and Saviour is the chief corner-stone, that sure foundation, on which if we build the Church, the gate of hell shall not prevail against it. But with all these foundation truths there must be combined that without which there is no solid or enduring foundation for the house of God within us; there must be obedience to the truth, otherwise our house is built upon the sand.

In the preparation of these materials, and in the more minute and elaborate decorations of the temple and its furniture, workmen of a different character were employed from those who had done the corresponding work of the tabernacle. In Exodus we read of no particular agents employed in procuring or preparing the wood for the tabernacle; but in preparing the gold and the silver and the brass, and cutting the precious stones to set them, and carving the timber, special and cunning workmen were employed. In this kind of work Moses engaged Bezaleel of the tribe of Judah, and Aholiab of the tribe of Dan. For similar work Solomon employed Hiram, a widow's son of the tribe of Naphtali, whose father was a man of Tyre. As Judah was the highest and Dan the lowest, in representative character at least, of the tribes of Israel, the two workmen belonging to them represented celestial wisdom, from its highest to its lowest, or from first to last, which engages in the work of constructing and adorning the mind, when it is formed into a tabernacle of the Lord. But when the mind is more

fully perfected, by being regenerated more fully, and formed into a temple of the Lord, agents having a more spiritual representation are employed. In the Scriptures Tyre signifies the knowledge of things spiritual, and when, as is frequently the case, Sidon is mentioned in connection with it, Tyre signifies interior, and Sidon exterior, knowledge. On account of this representative character of Tyre, Hiram, the king of that eminent commercial city, whose merchants were princes, assisted Solomon in procuring and preparing materials for building the house. The faculty of knowing goodness and truth is one which enables the regenerating Christian to procure and prepare the materials with which the mind is to be made a living temple, built up of living stones, and furnished with the means of serving the Lord.

The difference of the representative character of the Tyrians and the Sidonians is indicated in the different parts of the work which they are mentioned as performing. "There is not among us," said Solomon to Hiram, "any that can skill to hew timber like unto the Sidonians." The Sidonians are therefore mentioned as those who assisted Israel in bringing the wood from the forest of Lebanon, which represented the more external and general work of procuring the goods of spiritual and natural truth from the Word itself. But when the more interior and particular work of preparing the furnishings and decorations of the temple are spoken of, a man, the son of an Israelitish mother and a Syrian father, is mentioned. And as a man of Tyre signifies the knowledge of internal truth, and an Israelitish woman the spiritual affection of truth, he who is born of such a marriage must represent a principle or faculty which unites in itself the spiritual affection and the rational perception of the good and truth, that prepare us for the kingdom of heaven. The mother, too, was of the tribe of Naphtali; and this tribe represented the conjunction of goodness and truth, which is the heavenly marriage. Still more, Hiram, who adorned the temple, united in himself the Jew and the Gentile: and it may not be inconsistent with the representative character of the temple to suppose that Hiram's work foreshadowed the work of the Lord, by which His humanity became the means of uniting in one all the families of the earth, and truly making them not only of one blood, but of one spirit, the spirit of loving God above all things and each other as themselves. When the Lord shall be acknowledged in the Church universal as the Divine Man, the Pattern of all true humanity, and the Author of all that is truly human in man, then will the Lord be King over all the earth, and there shall be one fold and one Shepherd.

CHAPTER VII.

SOLOMON'S TEMPLE. THE CORRESPONDENCE OF ITS PRINCIPAL DIVISIONS.

1 *Kings* vi.

WE have already considered the subject of the temple, so far as relates to the materials of wood and stone of which that sacred edifice was constructed, and the agency by which the great work was commenced and carried on to its completion. We propose now to enter within its holy precincts, and trace the analogy of its principal divisions, furniture, and elaborate decorations.

Already have we pointed out the general representative meaning of this wonder of the ancient world. A type as it was in its highest sense of the Temple of the Lord's body, the Object and the Origin of all holy worship, it represented, in its secondary sense, Heaven and the Church, which are the Lord's mystical body, the grandest and the brightest image of Himself, and in its particular sense it was a symbol of the regenerate man, who is an image of the Lord, and a heaven in its least form. To complete the chain of representatives we must take in the written Word; but this is nearest to, and indeed identical with, the Incarnate Word, being the Divine Truth itself presented in another form.

The first great truth we learn from the division of the temple, as from that of the tabernacle, is one that lies at the foundation of all our knowledge both of the Infinite and of the finite whom they represented. The temple, like the tabernacle, consisted, we have seen, of three principal divisions. It had an inmost place, called the holy of holies, a second apartment called the holy place, and beyond this a court. This last part of the sacred enclosure was twofold, there being an inner and an outer court, the reason for which will appear as we proceed.

The great truth represented in this division of the temple is, that in the Divine Being, and thence in heaven and in man, there is a trine, a trinity in unity, which is the universal type of all perfection both in the Infinite and the finite. In the Divine Being from eternity, and still more fully in relation to us since the Incarnation, there is a trinity of Divine Essentials. Love, wisdom, and power form the trine which must have existed in God, or in which God must have existed, from all eternity. Since God became incarnate we recognise this same trinity in the Lord's Essential Divinity, His Divine Humanity, and His

proceeding Holy Spirit. These in the New Testament are called Father, Son, and Holy Spirit. The Father is the Essential Divinity, or the Divine Love, the Son the Divine Humanity, or the Divine Wisdom, and the Holy Spirit is the Holy proceeding or the Divine Power. There is an apparent dissimilarity between these descriptions of the Divine Trinity, but there is none in reality. For it was the Divine Wisdom, or the Word, that was made flesh, and from the Word made flesh proceeds the Holy Spirit. From eternity God was not only a triune God, but He was a Divine Man. Before the Incarnation He was a Man in first principles; after that event He was a Man in last principles also. Before the Incarnation God was a Man chiefly as the Creator and Conservator; since the Incarnation He is Man as the Redeemer and Saviour also. Before the Incarnation God was the Divine Man as angels are finite men; after the Incarnation he was a Divine Man as we on earth are men. Before the Incarnation, therefore, God, when He appeared in person, assumed the angelic nature, being manifested in the spiritual form of an angel, which eminently was called the angel of His presence, and the angel of the covenant. When God became incarnate it was by assuming the human nature as it exists in the natural world, being born into the world as a man, the offspring of a human mother, though of a Divine Father. This humanity, born of a virgin mother on earth, and glorified by a Divine Father in heaven, and so made Divine even to the very ultimates called flesh and bones, is eminently the Temple of Jehovah: the one True Object of human faith and worship, the Lord Jesus Christ, in whose blessed and glorious Person is the Divine Trinity; three in one and one in three. The trinity in God does not consist of a tripersonality. The very nature of the Trinity is such, that if there were many Divine persons, no one of them could exist without having a trinity in himself; for no one of them could be a person without possessing the three essentials of love, wisdom, and power—or divinity, humanity, and operation. Trinity is as essential to a Divine existence as unity, and unity as trinity. The true doctrine of the Divine Trinity, so far from invalidating the doctrine of the Divine unity, confirms and exalts it; for the more clearly we see the distinction of the principles, the more clearly we see the unity of the person. The Divine Trinity, therefore, is not one God in three Divine persons, but one Person in three Divine Essentials: one Lord God, in whom we recognise our Creator, Redeemer, and Regenerator. "God is in His holy temple: let all the earth keep silence before Him."

This Divine Trinity in the One God, even from eternity, is the origin of the triune nature of all and everything in the realm of created existence. Throughout the whole of creation there is a resemblance,

an analogy, more or less distinctly marked, of the triune nature of its Divine original. Everything that exists has its essence, its form, and its use; and these, even in the very lowest of created things, are the analogies or correspondents of love, wisdom, and power: for love is essence or life, wisdom is form or the manifestation of life, and use is power or the active and ultimate result of life. This trinity and unity must pervade the whole creation, since no created being, however exalted, and no created thing however low, could form part of a universe, in which God is present as in His grandest finite temple, unless each part were an image of the whole, and capable of being a receptacle of that one Life from which all live, of that one Wisdom from which all are formed or organized, of that one Operation from which all act.

In the universe, created after the image of God, as necessary to His presence therein, there are several different but kindred parts in which the Divine image is more perfectly displayed. Higher in the scale of finite existence, they are in closer connection with the Author of their being and Fountain of their life, and in them the Divine purpose in creation is more fully brought out and more perfectly realized. The purpose of God in creation was to rear up from among the human race a heaven of glorified spirits, that should be an image, ever increasing in fulness and perfection, of His own immensity, glory, and blessedness. This heaven is the higher temple of the Divine Presence; and, considered in relation to it, and as parts of it, the regenerate are the living stones and other precious materials of which it is and will continue to be built up world without end. This heavenly temple has also its three mansions—its holy of holies, its holy place, and its outer courts. As there are three that bear record in heaven, so heaven itself is distinguished into three, of which number the Apostle Paul speaks, when he says he was caught up into the third. In these three we see the images and the receptacles of the Divine love, the Divine wisdom, and the Divine operation. The third or highest heaven is an image and receptacle of the Divine love, the second or middle heaven is an image and receptacle of the Divine wisdom, and the last or lowest heaven is an image and receptacle of the Divine power or operation. In the last or ultimate principle of every trine the two higher principles coexist in their fulness and in their power. The peculiarity of which we spoke regarding the court of the temple may now be seen with advantage. There were in fact two courts, which are mentioned as the inner and the outer court. The ultimate or lowest of the three heavens is also divided into two—not into two distinct heavens, but into two parts, corresponding to, and immediately communicating with, the two heavens which are above. The lowest heaven being the common basis of the other two, it communicates immediately with the highest or celestial heaven on the one hand, and with the middle or spiritual

heaven on the other. And as the ultimate heaven, in relation to the other two, is comparatively natural, and for the sake of distinction is called the natural heaven, the two parts into which it is divided are called the spiritual-natural and the celestial-natural heaven, and the angels which belong to or constitute them are also so distinguished.

But there is another peculiarity, another distinction, in the temple of the heavens which was represented by one that is mentioned in the temple of Solomon.

In the holy of holies of the symbolical temple was placed the ark containing the testimony—the two tables on which were written with the finger of God the ten commandments. These commandments represented the Lord Himself. The holy tables were deposited in the inmost of the temple to represent the Lord's more immediate presence in the inmost heaven. But for the tables of the law there was a receptacle within a receptacle. The law was within the ark, and the ark was within the holy of holies; so above or within the highest heaven there is another heaven, called in the Writings of the Church the heaven of human internals. This is the inmost receptacle and highest residence of God with the angels of His kingdom, and indeed with all human beings; for there is a region, or degree, or faculty in every human soul, be it the soul of angel, man, or demon, which is analogous to this inmost heaven, this heaven of heavens, and which forms a part of it, and in which the Lord has His immediate residence; in virtue of which every soul has immortality, entirely independent of his finite will and wisdom. But this part of the analogy of heaven with the temple will be better seen by considering the correspondence of the temple with the individual man, as he is constituted by creation, especially as he is perfected by regeneration.

The truth that every less is an image of the greater, that even every least is an image of the greatest, is in no instance more perfectly exemplified than in the case of man. Man is the highest and most perfect individual image of his God; and he is the nearest image of the universal heaven. He is the highest individual image of his God, because he was created to be the most perfect individual receptacle or recipient of a finite measure of the Infinite Principles, or Divine Essentials, that make up the very nature and person of God. God, we have seen, is Love itself, Wisdom itself, and Power itself: and man was created to receive from God a finite measure of these infinite principles. We do not call them simply attributes; they are the origin of all attributes, being in themselves the very Essentials of the Divine Essence, the Divine substance, and the origin of all others. As an image of God, man has a faculty for the reception of love from God, a faculty for the reception of wisdom from God, and a faculty for the reception and exercise of power from God. His faculty for the reception of God's love

is his will, his faculty for the reception of God's wisdom is his understanding, and the faculty for the reception of God's power is his ability or faculty of speaking and acting. Man is a *created* image simply in virtue of possessing these faculties. And as every one, except from accidental circumstances, inherits these faculties, every one is capable of receiving those spiritual and eternal gifts from his beneficent Creator and Redeemer. The impediments which the Fall introduced into the world to the reception of these gifts having been removed by the Lord's Incarnation and Redemption, all may freely receive what is now freely offered, love, and wisdom, and holiness, from the Saviour God. The actual reception of these makes man a spiritual image of his God—a new creature—a temple of the Lord's Holy Spirit—an image of the temple of the Lord's glorious Body—a little heaven, a resemblance of the greatest. Every one has within himself, in miniature, all that exists in the kingdom of heaven : by creation he has them potentially, by regeneration actually. The mind of every man consists of three distinct degrees, analogous to the three heavens ; and he enters, when he leaves this world, into that particular heaven, the analogue of which has been opened in himself during his residence on earth. These degrees respectively correspond to the court of the temple, the holy place, and the holy of holies. As in the universal heaven, so in the human mind, there are an inner and an outer court, surrounding the holy place, and an inmost receptacle of the Divine Testimony within the holiest place. The lowest mansion of the regenerate man, as a temple of God, consists of two parts, doing good and speaking the truth—a holy life and conversation. These also are the ultimates of a regenerate will and understanding ; for the new will is ultimated in good works, and the new understanding is ultimated in good words, or in doing and speaking the truth every man to his neighbour.

Within or above the holiest place in the human mind there is a higher region—a more transcendent faculty, in which the Eternal dwells alone. Into this human internal man never penetrates. It is above the sphere of his consciousness and beyond the limits of his power. However he may pervert or destroy the life of love and truth in the regions of his mind below, he cannot even disturb the order of this. God has mercifully reserved it for Himself. It is His high and holy place which man can never desecrate. Through it the Lord preserves in every one the faculties of liberty and rationality, as well as immortality; and from that high and holy place He is ever ready to descend, when there is a contrite and humble spirit to receive Him. This impenetrable sanctuary of the Lord in the human mind is that of which Solomon speaks by the Holy Spirit in his dedication of the temple. The Lord said that He would dwell in the thick darkness. The highest human and angelic intelligence can never pierce the cloud that over-

hangs this secret place. There the Lord dwells in the thick darkness of His superhuman wisdom and overruling Providence. But in this as in all His dealings with His creatures His regard for their eternal interests is the ground of His economy. He conceals Himself from human wisdom and consciousness, that man may act from freedom according to reason, as if he were the author of the blessings he enjoys; and only leads him by revelation to see and acknowledge the operation of the hand which he can neither perceive by sense nor feel by consciousness.

To complete the series of analogies of what is Divine and spiritual in the temple of Solomon, it may be observed, in conclusion, that the Word of God is eminently the temple of the Lord. In this the Lord dwells both with angels and men—in heaven and in the Church. In the Word are three distinct senses, celestial, spiritual, and natural; but above the highest of these there is in it a sense purely Divine, which, like the human internal of man, is above the reach of the highest human intelligence.

Having traced the general correspondence of the temple which Solomon, by Divine appointment, built for the worship of Jehovah, we must reserve for another chapter a more minute delineation of the sacred edifice.

The treatment of the subject in the present chapter may perhaps seem to have too little tendency to edification. We are, however, to reflect that there is a wide difference between speculation and truth; and that while speculation may end in theory, truth has an invariable direction in the way of practical usefulness. That symbolism which leads us to look upwards to the Lord and inwards to ourselves, and that reflects some of the highest truths relating to the works of redemption and salvation, cannot fail to afford the means of improving the heart as well as of enlightening the understanding. When we look into the historical books of the Sacred Word, and find that they reveal some of the deepest mysteries of the kingdom of God under the form of the plainest narrative, our veneration for the inspired volume becomes increased, while our views of the kingdom itself become enlarged. When we view the temple of the Jews as symbolizing the Sacred Word in which the Lord dwells with His people, the human mind that has been formed by the principles of the Word into a habitation in which the Lord dwells, the angelic heaven where the Lord is ever in the midst, and above all, the Temple of the Lord's Humanity wherein all the fulness of the Godhead dwells—that Godhead which the heavens, even the heaven of heavens, cannot contain—our contemplation of so many correspondent and harmonious truths must, if we are disposed to be benefited, fill our hearts with gratitude, and lead us onward and upward in the way of improvement. Does not the contemplation of these truths teach us, that we must be fitted to enter into the universal

harmony which exists among the angels of heaven, and between them and the Author of their happiness, before we can enter into their habitations and participate in their joys? Does it not tell us that He who originally created us after His own image, now desires to re-create us after His own likeness; and that if we would become spiritual and living temples, we must follow in the footsteps of Him who built up the Holy Temple of His Divine Humanity in labour, and self-denial, and suffering, as well as in works of love and beneficence? He has now opened up a new and living way of access to Himself, as our Father, through the veil, that is to say, His flesh. We are able to enter even into the holy of holies. Further, the temple is now opened in heaven, and there is to be seen in heaven the ark of His Testament (Rev. xi. 19). The way is thus opened for the penitent and obedient to enter into the holiest of all. Let us strive to realize the Divine declaration: "Behold, the tabernacle of God is with men, and they shall be His people, and God Himself shall be with them, and be their God" (Rev. xxi. 3).

CHAPTER VIII.

SOLOMON'S HOUSES.

1 *Kings* vii. 1-12.

THE Word of God being inwardly Divine and spiritual, every particular it contains is pregnant with purely religious instruction. The subjects of its historical records pass away—the shadowy dispensation itself, to which a great part of it relates, ceases to have a visible existence, but there arises out of the dead form of the literal history a living and eternal principle that points the way to heaven, whence the spirit descended that clothed itself with those transitory forms of material existence which are now only to be found, and will abide for ever with us, in the written Word. The temple of Solomon with all its magnificence has long since passed entirely away, the palaces which emulated the temple in grandeur have long ceased to exist; but they will continue to teach lessons of spiritual wisdom to the spiritually minded in all future ages of the world, as they will do for ever in the kingdom of heaven. In the glorious Temple of the Lord's Body the members of the Church militant and of the Church triumphant will see the grand antitype of the temple of Solomon, and will be able to trace the spiritual analogy through all the descending degrees of finite existence in its sanctified condition; for the Lord is the origin of all holiness, and His saving work on earth is the ground of all sanctification. "For their sakes I sanctify Myself, that they also

might be sanctified through the truth." And what and where is the truth that sanctifies? Our Lord answers this question in the conclusion of His important declaration: "Thy Word is truth." This very Word, then, in which we find the history of a kingdom that has long since passed away, of a Church long since perished, is that in which we are to find the truth that alone can make us free.

Our reflections on the building of the temple of Solomon have led us to see by what means and in what way the Divine Being builds up His willing and obedient children into temples of His presence. The houses or palaces which the king built as his own habitations will lead us to reflect on a kindred subject. There is indeed an important distinction between them. The temple was built by Solomon as a house for God to dwell in, and where He might be worshipped; the palaces were built as habitations for himself and his wives. But as Solomon represented the Lord Jesus Christ as God in His Humanity, both the temple and the palaces must have relation to the same Divine Person. The temple represented the Lord in His priestly character, and the palaces represented the Lord in His kingly character. This is viewing the subject in its highest sense, in application to the Lord Himself. In its lower sense it refers to the regenerate man, who is the Lord's image; and in this sense it may be more profitable to consider it.

As the temple consisted of three great divisions, Solomon built three palaces. Between these there is an analogy. Both represent in their spiritual sense the regenerated human mind, as the dwelling-place of the love and truth of God; but they do not represent the subject under the same aspect, nor precisely as to the same distinctions. We have seen that the temple as consisting of three different parts represented the trine in the Lord, the three heavens, and the three degrees answering to them in the human mind, and also and eminently the three senses in the Word; in all of them termed celestial, spiritual, and natural. The three houses which Solomon built represent the mind under a different division of its faculties and the principles of which they are receptive: they represent the mind as consisting of the faculties of perception, of reason, and of science; or to express the same idea otherwise, they represent the mind as it consists of a spiritual, a rational, and a scientific faculty. The highest of these representatives is more intimately connected with that of the temple itself; and may be considered as involving the general signification of that holy edifice.

We proceed then to consider the description of these houses which Solomon built, with the view of tracing in that description the nature and spiritual formation of the faculties and principles of which they are the sacred symbols.

Solomon built his own house, the house of the forest of Lebanon, and the house for Pharaoh's daughter. Of the first house no description is given; we are simply informed that it was his own, or more especially for himself. And this mode of expression has no doubt been adopted in order that this house might represent the spiritual faculty itself—that faculty by which the mind has a perception of spiritual things, of the spiritual principles of goodness and truth; for Solomon represented these principles, he, more than any other king, representing the principles of the good and the true in a state of harmony and oneness.

The house of the forest of Lebanon bespeaks, by its origin, the nature of the faculty and the principle which it represents. As all places in the Holy Land were representative of faculties and states of the human mind, Lebanon represents the rational faculty. The trees of its forest were symbolical of the rational perceptions of truth and goodness, and the wood of the cedar-tree symbolized the good which is acquired by those perceptions. In harmony with this symbolical meaning of the cedar, we find that in the temple itself the cedar held a middle and appropriate place. The temple, built of stone, was lined with cedar-wood, which was overlaid with gold. The stone was outermost, the gold was innermost, and the cedar was between. For the temple itself, while, in its three divisions, it represented the three degrees of life in the Creator, and thence in all created beings—the celestial, spiritual, and natural—in its materials and structure, under a different threefold division, in its very walls consisting of stone, cedar-wood, and gold, it comprehended in itself that which the palaces of Solomon represented in a more outward and visible manner.

Besides the house of the forest of Lebanon, Solomon built a house for Pharaoh's daughter, whom he had taken to wife. In the third chapter we read that Solomon made affinity with Pharaoh king of Egypt, and took Pharaoh's daughter, and brought her into the city of David, until he had made an end of building his own house, and the house of the Lord, and the wall of Jerusalem round about. The representative character of Egypt, which occupies so conspicuous a place both in the historical and prophetical parts of the Word, shows us at once what the palace built for Pharaoh's daughter spiritually represented. For Egypt, wherever it is mentioned in Scripture, stands as a symbol of that faculty of the mind which may be called scientific, and which is aptly represented by Egypt, the grand refuge of primeval science—the science of spiritual things, the accumulated perfections of which existed in the science of correspondence, and the remains of which we see in the "wisdom" and the symbol-writing of the ancient Egyptians. It was on account of this representative character of Egypt that Abraham, the father of the faithful, visited Egypt, and that the

whole house of Jacob sojourned there, and it was for the same reason that our Lord Himself was carried down thither when an infant. In all these instances instruction and initiation into the science or knowledge of Divine and spiritual things was represented. The repetition of this sojourning points out the importance of the work or state which it represented. For science or knowledge forms the very foundation of the Church in the human mind. Nothing is effected in a state of ignorance; and all the Divine arrangements, both in nature and in revelation, have no other end than the instruction of the human mind, with a view to its regeneration. The human being is brought into the world only that he may be prepared for another. This is the sole end of his temporal existence; and all that exists around him, in the heavens, in the earth, and that is revealed to him in the written Word, is nothing but a means to this end. The human soul is brought into existence in a body endowed with senses, which are designed for nothing but to serve as avenues of knowledge, with its attendant delights, to the spiritual and immortal inhabitant within. Natural knowledge is the necessary precursor of spiritual truth. Nature is the gateway to revelation. And how beautifully is this seen to be provided for in the arrangements of infinite wisdom, when we know that nature and revelation, and that earth and heaven, are linked together by mutual correspondence. Heaven and earth are but the spiritual and material forms, because the outbirths, of the same Divine Word—that Word which was in the beginning, by or through which all things were made, and without which there was not anything made that was made. That Word of infinite wisdom that created them, put forth, and as far as possible embodied, its own sublime perfections in them; and when that Word came forth as a Divine revelation, it only expressed, in higher and more direct language, what nature itself declares when rightly interpreted. Not that nature can disclose the mysteries of life or immortality, or even reveal the existence of a Creator; but when these truths have been made known by Revelation, then does creation raise her voice in confirmation and illustration of the truth revealed. And it is in the knowledge of nature that the knowledge of revelation has its beginning and foundation. For this reason the nature of our being, and the requirements of our life, necessitate the precedence of the scientific element in the progress of human life. And when we speak of science we include all knowledge, even that which an infant learns on its mother's breast. But the science which forms the actual foundation of the spiritual life is the science of spiritual things; and it is this which is more especially understood by Egypt.

In order, then, to acquire this knowledge, which is introductory to spiritual life, and which forms the foundation on which religious truth rests, it is necessary to be inspired by the love of knowledge. The love

of knowledge, or the affection of science, was represented by Pharaoh's daughter whom Solomon took as a wife. The daughter of the Egyptian king was, so far as we read, the first of Solomon's wives, because she represented the first of the affections under the influence of which the mind is led to cultivate the means of spiritual and eternal life. The important part which this affection performs in building up the mind for heaven, by forming it into an image of heaven, is strikingly taught in a representative way in the history of Abraham. When Sarah was barren, she gave to Abraham Hagar her Egyptian handmaid, that she might have children by her; but after the birth of Ishmael Sarah had a son of her own. In this way was it represented that the higher attainments of the spiritual life cannot be made but by means of the lower. This incident in the history of Abraham represents a truth similar to that symbolized in the history of Solomon. For in the history of Abraham, the Egyptian handmaid represented the affection of science, and Ishmael the first rational principle, which is natural; while Sarah represents the affection of truth, and Isaac that rational principle which becomes the means of acquiring that which is truly spiritual.

There is thus a similarity in this respect between the history of Abraham and that of Solomon. But Scripture never repeats itself, although there are many resemblances, so many as to form a ground for the negative argument that one sacred writer borrows his ideas from another. In the history of Abraham the birth of the principles themselves is treated of; Solomon is represented as providing habitations for them; the building of his three palaces symbolizing the confirming and fixing in the mind by ultimating in the life, the principles previously acquired. Principles are first acquired in the internal man and are then ultimated and confirmed in the external.

The end of all true life is the building up of the mind into the form of heaven, which is the throne of God, and we may learn from this part of the sacred history how this is advanced and finally attained. There are three great stages in all intellectual advancement in the spiritual life. We must *know*, *understand*, and *see* the truth. The affection of knowing lies at the foundation of all true progress. We can only understand what we know, we can only perceive what we understand. The perception of truth is wisdom. But there is no wisdom which is not founded on knowledge and built up by reason. The love of knowledge, looking forward to the end of knowledge, which is wisdom, is the incipient love of wisdom, or the love of growing wise; and this love lies at the very basis of all spiritual advancement.

Every one is born with the faculties of knowing, understanding, and perceiving the truth of heaven; but these faculties have to be developed or built up by the orderly exercise of the powers inherited and the right and faithful use of the means provided. The worldly and theological

maxims of the dark ages—that ignorance is the mother of devotion, and that the understanding is to be kept under obedience to faith—are not less inconsistent with the nature of religion than of the human mind. Both live and grow and strengthen in the light and sunshine of the eternal truth. Any fears or maxims to the contrary must arise from the prevalence of darkness, which dreads the scrutiny that it deprecates.

In these days when the light of the moon has become as the light of the sun, and the light of the sun has become sevenfold as the light of seven days, there is no cause to dread the legitimate exercise of any of the mental faculties, but the greatest reason to invite and encourage the exercise of them all. When the Lamb had taken the book out of the hand of Him that sat upon the throne, as He opened the seven seals with which it had been closed for long centuries, each of the four beasts said, "Come and see." The Word of life is now indeed unsealed. Its internal sense is now laid open. The mystic horses have come forth; and these symbols of the understanding of the sacred oracles have been sent forth by Him who is the Word of God itself, and who, as the Word, has come to restore the great charter of man's spiritual liberty; and those who are disposed to behold the truth as now made known are invited to come and see. If the sight which is now opened to us by the unfolding of the Divine Word be followed by religious practice, our minds will be formed into the image of heaven. That heavenly form which religion impresses on the mind comprehends in itself every particular form of beauty and use. But the particulars which are contained in the account of the palaces of Solomon, especially that of the forest of Lebanon, which is more fully described, will be explained in a future chapter. Here we have only attempted a general exposition.

In this chapter we have proceeded on the understanding that the three houses, the king's own house, the house of the forest of Lebanon, and the house for Pharaoh's daughter, were regal palaces, distinct from the temple, the house of the Lord. In this we seem to differ from a high authority. In the "Apocalypse Explained," No. 654, we read that "whereas every man has a spiritual, a rational, and a natural mind, therefore Solomon built three houses, the house of God, or the temple, for the spiritual mind, the house of the forest of Lebanon for the rational, and the house for the daughter of Pharaoh for the natural." The author here speaks of the temple as one of the three houses that Solomon built, the other two being the house of the forest of Lebanon and the house for Pharaoh's daughter. To make the temple one of the three houses, we must understand the king's own house (chap. vii. 1) to mean the temple. But the king's house is evidently distinguished from the temple, not only by its being called Solomon's own house, but by the greater length of time it was in building. The temple was

built in seven years (vi. 38), but the building of Solomon's house occupied thirteen years (vii. 1), and we find these two periods afterwards combined: "It came to pass at the end of *twenty* years, when Solomon had built the two houses, the house of the Lord, and the king's house," etc. (chap. ix. 10.)

CHAPTER IX.

THE VESSELS OF SOLOMON'S TEMPLE, MADE BY HIRAM.

1 *Kings* vii. 13-51.

IN our reflections on the temple of Solomon we have endeavoured to trace the spiritual analogy of that gorgeous edifice with the Temple of the Lord's Body, the Divine Word, heaven, the church, and the regenerate mind. The Temple of the Lord's glorified Humanity is the Divine pattern and the infinite origin of all that is truly human in heaven and on earth; and in the chain of dependence from Him, who sustains both the spiritual and the material universe, we are enabled to see His image in all that is in the order of His creative wisdom and saving providence. In tracing the analogy of the temple with the Lord Himself, we fix our mind for the time upon the highest truth which it represents, and which, being the highest, enters into all the others.

There is one part of the temple of Solomon which, to be seen in its full import in relation to us, must first be viewed in its typical relation to the Lord. Solomon cast two pillars of brass, eighteen cubits high apiece, with chapiters five cubits high, and nets of checkerwork; and he set them in the porch of the temple, and He called the one Jachin, and the other Boaz.

These two pillars seem to have been an addition to the temple, considered as a more permanent form of the tabernacle; and it has been conjectured that they were intended to represent the pillar of the cloud and the pillar of fire, which may be considered as the pillars of the tabernacle, while the children of Israel journeyed with it through the wilderness. This is not grounded in any law or perception of spiritual analogy, but only in a perception of outward or nominal similitude. Still it may be admitted that the pillar of fire by night and the pillar of cloud by day had a similar representative character to the two great pillars that adorned the entrance of Solomon's temple. The pillars of the temple were natural, the pillar of fire and pillar of cloud were supernatural; and the fiery and cloudy pillar which, like the food of Israel in the desert, was given from heaven, represented the same

protective, guiding, and sustaining power as the people enjoyed in a more fixed and material form, when they had entered and become established in their promised inheritance.

The temple of Solomon representing the Divine Humanity of the Lord, the two pillars of brass that stood in the porch represented the Divine natural principle of the humanity. We are instructed in the Writings of the New Church respecting this heavenly mystery, that in the Lord from eternity there were the Divine celestial and the Divine spiritual actually, and there was also the Divine natural potentially. And it was to put on the Divine Nature actually that the Lord came into the world, and was born of a human mother. Before the Incarnation the Lord was indeed human, but He was human in the degrees that angels are human, who, as departed men, have left their natural bodies in the natural world. By incarnation the Lord became a man in the degree that we are men, who, while we possess the higher degrees of human nature in common with angels, have that degree which they have for ever laid aside. *Our* consciousness is in the natural world, *theirs* is in the spiritual; and it was to bring Himself, with His regenerating love and truth, down to the sphere of our consciousness, and make Himself an object of our natural apprehension and reception that the Lord became a man like ourselves; and through the humanity which He assumed and glorified on earth, He is with us alway even unto the end of the world.

It is needful to direct our minds thus far to this profound but important subject, for the purpose of showing how this great truth enters into the representatives of the Israelitish Church, and is presented symbolically in the Divine Word. For the truth represented by the two brazen pillars of Solomon's temple was presented in vision to the seers of the Old and New Testament.

In Ezekiel (chap i.) the Lord's providence is described by the cherubim, who are said to have the likeness of a man, and their feet were straight feet: and they sparkled like the colour of burnished brass. In Daniel (chap. x.) Jehovah Himself is described as a man, whose body was like the beryl, and His face as the appearance of lightning, and His eyes as lamps of fire, and His arms and His feet like in colour to polished brass. But in Revelation (chap. i.) this representation is brought out still more clearly and fully. There, John, in the Spirit, sees Jesus as the Divine Man, "clothed with a garment down to the foot, and girt about the paps with a golden girdle: His head and His hairs white like wool, as white as snow, and His eyes as a flame of fire; and His feet like unto fine brass, as if they burned in a furnace."

In all these instances the Divine natural principle of the Lord is described or represented. That principle is especially signified by His feet; and these are said to have the appearance of brass, because

brass is the symbol of natural good, or good in the natural degree ; and this brass is said to have a burning and burnished appearance, its burning appearance indicating that that good in the Lord was filled with the ardency of the Divine love, and its brightness indicating that it was filled with the light of the Divine wisdom.

The representative meaning of the two pillars of Solomon's temple is further indicated by their names. The right pillar was called Jachin, and the left was called Boaz. The one name expresses stability and the other strength. And these names express precisely what was accomplished by the Lord's assuming and glorifying the natural degree of humanity. Stability and power are in ultimates ; and the Lord's becoming man in ultimates, as He had from eternity been in first principles, brought down His power to the uttermost of human need, and provided for the stability of all things, spiritual and material. To the first of these our Lord referred when He said, "All power is given unto Me in heaven and on earth." To the second He alluded when He said to Peter, who had confessed Him to be the Son of God : "On this rock I will build My Church ; and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it." The glory of Christianity and the hopes of the world rest on the grand truth that the Son of Man has all power—that the Divine power is brought down to the lowest affections and perceptions of the human mind, not merely through heaven, or by the agency of angelic ministration, but immediately through the Humanity of the Lord—the veritable Son of Man. The love and truth of God thus ultimated are the very pillars of heaven and the church, and consequently of the universe itself; for, as we are again instructed, unless the Lord had come into the world no flesh could have been saved, nor could heaven have remained in a state of integrity. The Lord's coming prevented universal ruin ; and the pillars of the temple—the temple of His humanity, of heaven, and the Church—which were then set up, will remain in their strength and stability for ever.

But not only the names but the place of the pillars of Solomon's temple indicates their meaning. The pillars were set up in the porch, through which there was entrance into the temple. And in harmony with this situation of the pillars the Lord says of Himself, "I am the door of the sheep: by Me if any man enter in, he shall go in and out, and find pasture." The Divine natural of the Lord is the door : "No man cometh unto the Father, but by Me." There is no means of entrance into the church or into heaven but by the Humanity of the Lord, therefore except by the acknowledgment of Jesus as the God of heaven and earth, the Saviour of mankind. Not that He excludes those who either do not know or worship Him by name ; but without that state from which acknowledgment springs there can be no admission. Children, who know little or nothing of the Saviour, are yet justly

regarded as within the pale of the Church, and those who die in childhood are admitted into heaven; yet they do not actually form a part of the Church or heaven, until they have entered by the knowledge and practical acknowledgment of their Lord and Saviour. Acknowledgment of heart constitutes that state which is essential to the existence and stability of heaven and the Church.

Besides the brazen pillars of the temple there are some other important parts of the sacred edifice, or things connected with it, which demand our attention. Among these was the brazen sea, which stood upon twelve oxen. In this sea the priests were required to wash before they entered into the temple or made offerings to Jehovah upon the altar. In this vessel for purification, considered in relation to the Lord, we see a representation of Himself as the truth which purifies from sin, a type of that of which Zechariah speaks: "In that day there shall be a fountain opened to the house of David and to the inhabitants of Jerusalem for sin and for uncleanness" (xiii. 1). The brazen sea was a symbol of the Divine natural principle of the Lord as to truth, by which there is purification from spiritual uncleanness. It is called a sea, because a sea signifies Divine truth in its fulness, and therefore in its power. This sea was contained in a brazen vessel, to represent truth grounded in goodness; and the vessel contained two thousand baths, to indicate that purification has for its end the renewal of man both as to his intellectual and voluntary life. The sea stood upon twelve oxen, to signify that Divine truth in the natural mind must rest upon and be supported by all the good natural affections, which are symbolized by oxen.

Besides the molten sea there were ten lavers on ten bases, and each of these contained forty baths. These lavers, like the sea, represented the receptacles of truth in the natural mind, but they represented receptacles of a lower order, or of a more external kind. There are in the mind various receptacles of truth, or what is the same, truth is differently perceived in the different degrees of the mind—for example, in the sensuous and the rational. The sensuous is the lowest degree of the natural mind, and the rational is the highest. Both the molten sea and the lavers of brass denote receptacles of truth in the natural mind, and indeed the sensuous degree of that mind; but the ten lavers represented the very lowest receptacles, such as they are in the senses themselves. Thus the water in these lavers denote truth as it comes down to the very lowest degree of sensual apprehension. And what is the meaning of this typical arrangement for washing those who entered into the temple? It means that no thoughts and feelings ought to be admitted into the mind from the world without, no desires should be allowed to pass from the flesh into the spirit, without being purified by Divine truth, so that their natural or hereditary defilements may be

removed. Worldly and sensual things are continually flowing into our minds, for we are surrounded by them; and to represent this, the twelve oxen were placed under the sea looking to the four cardinal points.

The means of such purification, as represented by the sea and the lavers of the temple, are provided in their greatest possible fulness in the Christian Church, because the Lord has Himself become the Laver of regeneration. But they do not so exist to us in a practical way until our own minds have become receptacles of heavenly truth, and until that truth has been employed for the purification of the desires and affections of our minds, even the most external. Therefore the brazen sea, in reference to us, represents the natural mind itself, as the recipient of truth, and the truth of which it is receptive. And the molten sea, for containing the water, was made of brass, to teach us that good is the receptacle of truth. Brass is the symbol of good, as water is of truth. The good signified by brass is that which is called natural good. It is not, however, that which is hereditary, or those good natural dispositions which every one more or less inherits from his parents. These natural inclinations are not, strictly speaking, human, but are similar to those of the gentler animals, and were therefore represented by the twelve oxen that supported the brazen sea. The natural goodness represented by the brazen sea is that which has a spiritual origin, and is religious, and therefore human, goodness. This acquired goodness rests upon hereditary goodness, as the brazen sea rested upon the twelve oxen. The human being inherits evil as well as good dispositions from his parents, but the evil form no actual basis for acquired goodness. Evil and falsehood can afford no basis or support for goodness and truth. Hatred cannot support love, anger mercy, or envy benevolence. Not the ferocious tiger or the treacherous leopard, but the gentle ox was the chosen support for the brazen sea. And thus would the Divine Oracles teach us that not the ferocious and treacherous, but the gentle and docile, dispositions of the natural mind, are those which can supply a basis for the good which, natural in its degree, is spiritual in its origin. Spiritual dispositions are ingrafted upon those which are natural. But there must be a similarity of nature between the scion and the stock in order that the one may be grafted on the other. The cultivated may be grafted on the wild, but it must be on one of the same kind, not on one of a diverse kind. So with renewing of the life of man. The Divine Husbandman desires to renew us by imparting to us of His own nature; but He cannot ingraft a scion from the tree of life except on some corresponding stock in our own natural minds. And in this case He ingrafts it on that which is His own; for every good natural disposition is originally from Him, and is a survival of something of that which originally belonged to man, when God beheld all that He had

made, and behold it was very good. That which God the Creator originally did, God the Redeemer desires again to do. He desires to restore us to a state of holiness, that He may restore us to a state of happiness. He desires to find in us some natural goodness, that He may found upon it the brazen sea that will contain the water of purifying truth, in which we may wash and be clean, and so be fit for entering into His presence, and worship in His holy temple.

One singular circumstance connected with the building of the temple is deserving of our particular attention. "The house, when it was in building, was built of stone made ready before it was brought thither: so that there was neither hammer nor ax nor any tool of iron heard in the house while it was in building" (vi. 7). This absence of the sound of any tool in the house, though not required by any direct command, was no doubt ordered in conformity with what had taken place in the construction of the tabernacle, and with a very strict prohibition respecting the building of the altar. The tabernacle being of wood, and intended to be set up when the congregation rested, and taken down when they journeyed, it was necessary that the planks should be separated, shaped, and so formed as to be capable, without further preparation, of being united into a complete habitation. But this necessity did not naturally belong to the altar, to which the prohibition against the use of any tool was so strictly applied. It was a command to Moses, immediately connected with the giving of the law of the decalogue, "An altar of earth thou shalt make unto Me, and shalt sacrifice thereon thy burnt-offerings, and thy peace-offerings, thy sheep, and thine oxen: in all places where I record My name I will come unto thee, and I will bless thee. And if thou wilt make Me an altar of stone, thou shalt not build it of hewn stone: for if thou lift up thy tool upon it, thou hast polluted it" (Exod. xx. 24, 25). There is nothing but conjecture to guide us in an effort to discover a reason affecting the Israelites themselves in regard to this stringent law. It is supposed to have been intended to prevent them from following a practice of the heathen nations around them. But if we cannot find a sufficient reason for the law in regard to the altar, and for the observance in regard to the temple, we are supplied with a very adequate one in regard to that which the altar and the temple represented. If the letter affords little light or instruction on the subject, the spirit supplies us abundantly with both. In the Writings of the Church it is explained clearly and practically:—

"The altar, and afterwards the temple, were in an especial manner representative of the Lord as to Divine goodness and Divine truth, wherefore the stones of which they were built signified the truths of doctrine, of religion, and of worship. That nothing of self-derived intelligence should accede to the truths of doctrine and worship

derived from the Word, and consequently be in them, was represented by the stones being whole, and not hewn, of which the temple and the altar were built. For the work of the workmen and the artificer signified such intelligence. The tools also, as the hammer and the axe, and the iron in general, signified such truth in its ultimate form, and this is especially falsified by the selfhood of man, for this truth is the same as the literal sense of the Word. The truths from which the Lord is worshipped ought to be taken from the Word, for in everything of the Word there is life from the Divine Being, from whom they are. When truths are taken from the selfhood, they respect and have for their end dignity and eminence over all in the world, and also the possession of the earth and opulence above all, wherefore they have in them the love of self and of the world, thus all evils collectively; but truths from the Word respect and have for their end eternal life, and have in them love to the Lord and love to the neighbour, thus all good collectively. When truths are hatched from the selfhood or from one's own intelligence, they domineer over the truths that are Divine in their origin, for these are applied to confirm the others, when yet the truths which are from the Divine Being ought to have the dominion, and those which are from self-intelligence ought to serve. We speak of those which are of self-intelligence as truths, but they are not truths, they only appear as truths in the external form, for they are only rendered like truths in the external form by applications from the literal sense of the Word, while in the internal form they are falsities.

"What is derived from self-intelligence in itself is void of life, nay, is spiritually dead; for the selfhood of man is nothing but evil. If, therefore, Divine worship be performed from the selfhood, that worship is nothing more than as the worship of a graven or molten idol, in which there is no spirit, that is, no life. What, on the contrary, is from the Word, is serviceable for Divine worship, because in itself it is alive. For inwardly in every particular of the Word there is a spiritual sense which treats of the Lord's kingdom, and within that sense there is a Divine sense, which treats of the Lord alone. From this and from no other source are the life and sanctity of the Word. The Word is as a Divine Man. The literal sense is, as it were, His body, and the spiritual sense is, as it were, His soul. Hence it is evident that the literal sense lives by the internal sense. It would appear as if the literal sense vanishes and dies by the internal sense; on the contrary, it does not vanish, still less die, but by the internal sense lives. From these considerations it is now manifest that worship truly Divine exists from those truths which are from the Word, and in no case from those which originate in self-derived intelligence. Hence it is that the expression, 'If thou lift up thy tool upon the altar thou shalt profane it,' signifies that in case thou devise such things as belong to

Divine worship, not deriving them from the Word but from self-intelligence, there is no worship. And so of the temple, in which no sound of hammer or of axe or any tool of iron was heard during the time it was in building."

CHAPTER X.

SOLOMON'S PRAYER AT THE DEDICATION OF THE TEMPLE.

1 *Kings* viii.

THE ceremonial by which the temple of Solomon was dedicated to the name and the service of God is one of the grandest recorded in the Scriptures: it was not unworthy of the splendid edifice it was designed to consecrate, and a not unfitting homage to the Great Being for whose glory it had been reared. All the great and venerable in the congregation were then assembled to do honour to so grand an occasion, and thousands from all parts of the land formed the vast multitude of worshippers, while the wisest and richest of the kings of Israel presided over the whole. Yet, grand and imposing as the ceremonial was, considered as a whole, it was essentially Jewish in its character. The long line of priests carrying the ark of the Lord, and the tabernacle of the congregation, and the holy vessels that were in the tabernacle, and the slaying of sheep and oxen that could not be told or numbered for multitude, formed a spectacle and a religious service that were adapted only to produce a holy impression on the mind of one who lived under a dispensation that was typical and shadowy. In the magnificent address and prayer of Solomon there are indeed, even in the plain literal sense, some great truths—truths that belong exclusively to no one age or dispensation, but are of universal application. The infinity of God—His omnipresence, omniscience, and omnipotence are clearly and powerfully expressed; sin, repentance, and forgiveness are fully recognised; and the Divine clemency and mercy are acknowledged as abounding to the penitent. While, in the fulness and fervour of his pious joy, Solomon was able to say, "I have surely built Thee an house to dwell in, a settled place for Thee to abide in for ever;" his just views of the Divine immensity led him to exclaim, "But will God indeed dwell on the earth? behold, the heaven and heaven of heavens cannot contain Thee; how much less this house that I have builded?" Entreating the Divine forgiveness for the sins of his people, he regards actual sinfulness as not only a possibility, but as an unavoidable result of the condition of our nature as fallen creatures; and this condition is such, that there is no man that liveth and sinneth

not. And when praying the Divine justice to give to every man according to his ways, he trusts, for an unerring judgment, to the searching truth, "Thou, even Thou only, knowest the hearts of all the children of men." Still, notwithstanding these admirable marks of catholicity, by which the address and prayer of Solomon are distinguished, considered as a whole it is essentially Jewish. It is not unreasonable, but rather necessary, to suppose that his views of the immensity of God, of the nature of sin and forgiveness, partook of the character of the Church to which he belonged, in which Divine truths of every kind were but dimly perceived. The general tenor of the prayer justifies this conclusion, and shows that a temporal idea pervades the whole. He speaks of human sinfulness and of Divine forgiveness; but both the calamities and the blessings are of the body and the world. Spiritual life and immortality, future happiness or misery, have no place in it.

But is this grand and solemn service less deserving our attention, and less instructive to us, on this account? Could we look no deeper than the surface—were we able to take no more unworldly a view of the subject than did those who took a part in the august solemnity, it would profit us but little. But when we are able to see that under the outward grandeur of the letter there lies a series of truths, spiritual, heavenly, and practical, which tends to true edification in the highest Christian principles, the whole ceremonial assumes a new aspect. Under the splendid Jewish garb we are able to discern a living Christian form, displaying the grace and breathing the spirit of heavenly and eternal life. It is therefore to direct attention to this "body," so much more to us than the "raiment" that covers it, that we purpose to enter on the consideration of the dedication service of the temple of Solomon.

In the first place we have to recall the typical character of the temple itself. We have to think of the temple of Solomon as representative of the temple of the Lord's body. This is the temple of which Jehovah has said, "My name shall dwell there;" this is the habitation of which Solomon, speaking in the name of the Messiah, could truly say, "I have surely built Thee an house to dwell in, a settled place for Thee to abide in for ever;" and it is to this house that the eyes of Jehovah are open day and night. In this glorious temple the Infinite and Eternal, otherwise invisible and incomprehensible, is to be approached and worshipped as the visible God. It was for this reason—to represent this all-important truth—that the children of Israel were not permitted to offer sacrifice in any other than the one appointed place—in the house where the holy ark dwelt in the thick darkness, under the overshadowing cherubim. But still more to our present purpose, it was towards this house that every Israelite in his own distant dwelling turned his face when he offered his thanksgivings or addressed his prayers to his God,

who had there inscribed His name. This he did, whether in freedom in his own land, or in captivity in the land of an enemy. So we find Daniel, with the windows of his chamber open towards Jerusalem, kneeling upon his knees three times a day, and praying and giving thanks to God.

To God in the Holy Temple of His Divine Humanity His people are to turn in heart and mind when they pray and give thanks—when they supplicate the Divine mercy or praise the Divine bounty. As the Israelite turned the eyes of his body to the holy hill whence came his aid, the Christian is to turn the eyes of his mind to Him that is able to succour him in all his trials, to strengthen him in all his weakness, and deliver him out of all his distresses.

The circumstances in which the Divine aid is to be sought are as various as the states and experiences of human life—more especially those of the Christian life, considered as the life that is to be formed and matured by labours and trials as well as by tranquil study and virtuous enjoyment. The present subject leads us to consider these circumstances as described in the prayer of Solomon.

In the prayer of Solomon there are seven different petitions, relating to as many different circumstances, six relating to the Israelites themselves, and one to the sojourner that is amongst them. The first petition is for him who trespasses against his neighbour; the second is for the people when smitten in battle; the third is for relief when the heaven is shut up because there is no rain; the fourth is for succour when famine is in the land; the fifth is for the sojourner; the sixth is for success in divinely sanctioned wars; and the seventh is for the people when they have been carried into captivity. In every series of events or circumstances that occurs in the Divine Word there is a connection between the parts, however independent of each other they may be in the historical relation. The circumstances or conditions of the people which are enumerated in this prayer, in which the Divine aid is implored for those who see their sins, and repent, and turn in earnest supplication to God in His temple, describe states of the spiritual life that follow in succession during the progress of regeneration. It may not be essentially necessary to see this connection to derive instruction from the several petitions. Our various individual states may find in some one of the circumstances something that comes home more immediately and forcibly to ourselves; but if there is nothing in our own hearts or understandings, in our words or works, that strike us, while considering these petitions, with a sense of sin or a feeling of penitence, we may be sure that the train of spiritual ideas that the series contains will afford us little satisfaction or yield us little profit of a spiritual kind. Trusting, however, that our contemplation of these various petitions may find for them an inward witness and response,

we will proceed to consider them at such length as our space will permit.

1. In his first petition Solomon prays, "If any man trespass against his neighbour, and an oath be laid upon him to cause him to swear, and the oath come before Thine altar in this house: then hear Thou in heaven, and do, and judge Thy servants, condemning the wicked, to bring his way upon his head; and justifying the righteous, to give him according to his righteousness." This petition evidently refers to the law delivered in the twenty-second chapter of Exodus, in which it is enacted, that if any one delivers any thing or beast to his neighbour (or companion) to keep, and it be stolen, or be driven away, or die, no man seeing it, "an oath of the Lord shall be between them, that he hath not put his hand unto his neighbour's goods." That which is given by one man to another to keep is that which has been given by the internal to the external man, and is laid up in the mind as a means of preserving and supporting the spiritual life of the soul. This may be lost, or may pass away from the mind, which may result either from evils of intention or evils of infirmity. When the question is brought to God, or submitted to the decision of Divine Truth, a true judgment is obtained. If it has proceeded from an evil intention, and thus from wickedness, the evil is seen and condemned; but if it has only proceeded from infirmity, or has resulted from error of judgment, no wickedness is imputed. The case supposed by Solomon seems, however, to refer further to a judgment between two, one of whom has actually trespassed against his neighbour; and the Divine decision brings to light the guilt of the one and the righteousness of the other. Such a Divine judgment is that which enables us to distinguish and to separate between good and evil, and truth and falsity in ourselves. And this is the first act of saving truth in the mind that has entered on the regeneration. The unregenerate have no clear distinction between spiritual good and evil in themselves. They call that good which they love, and that truth which favours their own ends; and on the other hand they call that evil which they do not love, and that falsity which is unfavourable to their own ends. It is Divine Truth alone—it is God—that enables us to see what is evil in itself and what is good in itself; for that only is good which comes from God and leads to Him, and that is evil that comes from self and leads to self. The first of our petitions to the throne of grace should therefore be, to receive into our minds the judgment of eternal truth, which will enable us to distinguish and to sever between the righteous and wicked in ourselves.

2. Although the first act of the spiritual life is to distinguish and to sever between good and evil in the judgment, many other acts are required before they can be entirely and finally separated in the life.

Evils, although seen and acknowledged, cannot be removed but by actively resisting them, and this resistance is compared in Scripture to a warfare. The second petition of Solomon, therefore, has relation to the people when contending with and smitten down before the enemy. In our first conflicts with the enemy of our own heart, we fight very much in our own strength, and in the confidence of the victory, and thus sin against Him who alone can strengthen us with strength in the inner man to overcome our corruptions. Our weakness is made manifest to us by defeat; and defeat begets humility and dependence. When we turn from ourselves to the Lord, and confess His name, and pray, and make supplication unto the Lord in His house, then does He hear and forgive, and bring us again into the land that He gave unto our fathers, by bringing us into some degree of spiritual goodness, as the result of submission to the will and wisdom of our Divine Deliverer. In the earlier states of the religious life there is inexperience of the difficulties and dangers attending real progress in truth and goodness. For these principles have not only to be known and understood, but to be made our own by being admitted into the life of the understanding and will. They are not received into the inner life without trial and temptation respecting them. These temptations are described in the next two subjects of Solomon's prayer. Truth and good are the water and the bread of the soul's true life; and a famine for bread and water are spiritually famine for the inward spiritual hearing of the Word of God.

3. Solomon therefore prays, "When heaven is shut up, and there is no rain, because they have sinned against Thee; if they pray, hear Thou in heaven, and give rain upon Thy land." And again—

4. "If there be in the land famine, if there be pestilence, blasting, mildew, locust, or if there be caterpillar; if their enemy besiege them in the land of their cities; whatsoever plague, whatsoever sickness there be; what prayer and supplication soever be made by any man, or by all Thy people Israel, which shall know every man the plague of his own heart, and spread forth his hands toward this house: then hear Thou in heaven Thy dwelling-place, and forgive, and do, and give to every man according to his ways, whose heart Thou knowest."

Heaven is shut up, and no rain descends to refresh the earth, when the inner man is either temporarily or permanently closed, and no truth flows down into the outer man to refresh and fructify him. When this continues, famine, or defect of goodness, must follow, for a defect of the one produces a defect of the other. But when good fails, how many evils spring up to desolate the mind! With the want of rain no other evil is connected in the prayer of Solomon; but when famine is the subject, pestilence, blasting, mildew, caterpillar, and the besieging army follow in its train. Goodness is the staff of spiritual life; and

when this fails, the gate is opened for the entrance of every pestilential, consuming, and destructive principle. Above all things is it, then, important for every man to know the plague of his own heart; and this we do spiritually when we know not only our general sinfulness, but our particular evils, and include that knowledge in the general confession of our sinfulness.

5. Those experiences which give the mind a sense of its inherent deficiencies in goodness and truth, inspire it with a desire to increase in the knowledge of these essential elements of eternal life. One who desires to be instructed in the knowledge of these principles, and, in the abstract sense, the desire itself to receive instruction, is signified by a sojourner; for those who came from a far country for the Lord's name's sake were in search of the wisdom which the children of Israel possessed. The fifth petition of Solomon's prayer is, therefore, for the sojourner, that the Lord might do for him, when he prayed towards the temple, all that he might call for. And the object of this request was not merely for the sake of the sojourner himself, but "that all people of the earth might know the name of the Lord, and fear Him, as the people Israel;" that is, that the influence of the Divine love and wisdom may be diffused over the whole mind—that the whole natural mind may yield a willing obedience to the Lord's will, as well as the spiritual.

6. The sixth petition of the prayer of Solomon has, like the second, relation to war, but in this instance the people are spoken of as going out to battle against their enemy by the command of the Lord—"whithersoever Thou shalt send them." And here the prayer is that the Most High will maintain their cause, when they pray towards the city which the Lord had chosen and the house that had been built for His name.

7. The seventh petition has also relation to war; but the prayer in this is on behalf of the people when they sin, and when the Lord is angry with them, and delivers them to the enemy, so that they carry them away captives unto the land of the enemy far or near. If they bethink themselves and repent, and make supplication, the Lord is entreated, not only to forgive them, but to give them compassion before them that carried them away. All this literally happened to the people afterwards, when they were carried away captive into Babylon. And this captivity, like that of Egypt, represented the complete end of one state; and their deliverance and re-establishment in their own land represented the beginning of another. The Divine Being by whose inspiration Solomon delivered that beautiful prayer at the dedication of the temple foresaw the captivity of the people which was thus comprehended in it. But as that captivity was representative of the last and severest temptation which the spiritual undergo, in one state and stage of the new life, and through which they pass into another, it

formed the last subject of that supplication which was designed to include all possible states in which the mind can feel the necessity of drawing near to God and seeking conjunction with Him. And here it is not deliverance that is immediately prayed for, but the compassion of their enemies towards them; as if the last stage was to subdue enmity itself, and turn their very captivity into freedom and their sorrow into joy.

When Solomon had made an end of praying, he rose from before the altar of the Lord from kneeling on his knees, with his hands spread up to heaven, and he stood and blessed all the congregation of Israel with a loud voice. One part of that blessing may well form the subject of our ardent desires: "The Lord our God be with us; let Him not leave us, nor forsake us: that He may incline our hearts unto Him, to walk in all His ways, and to keep His commandments."

God is indeed with us in His Holy Temple: let it be our earnest desire that He may incline our hearts unto Him, to walk in all His ways—those ways that He has Himself walked in while Himself a sojourner on the earth. These are ways of self-denial, integrity, holiness, meekness, mercy. He learned obedience by the things that He suffered. He fought, He thirsted, He hungered, He was led into captivity, even becoming captive to the last enemy, which is death. His captivity was but the last stage of His earthly life, and was the gate of His glorious resurrection, by which He overcame death, and became, even as to His humanity, life itself, and the Author of life, spiritual and eternal, to all who follow Him in the regeneration.

If the Jews rejoiced at the consecration of the temple in which the Divine name might dwell in the midst of them, infinitely more may we rejoice that the Lord has opened up for us a new and living way of access to Himself, which He hath consecrated through the evil, that is to say, His flesh. And if their fidelity and obedience were to be made more perfect as an offering of gratitude and a means of protection and blessing, immeasurably more should ours become so, when we have so much more to call forth our gratitude, and far more precious blessings to secure. While we offer up to our merciful Saviour the sacrifices of Praise and Thanksgiving, for grace so free and mercy so unbounded, let "our hearts be perfect with the Lord our God, to walk in His statutes, and to keep His commandments, as at this day."

CHAPTER XI.

SOLOMON'S SECOND OFFERINGS, AND THE LORD'S SECOND APPEARANCE TO HIM.

1 *Kings* viii. 62-66.

WHEN Solomon had ended his prayer and addressed the people, "the king, and all Israel with him, offered sacrifice before the Lord. And Solomon offered a sacrifice of peace-offerings, which he offered unto the Lord, two-and-twenty thousand oxen, and an hundred and twenty thousand sheep. So the king and all the children of Israel dedicated the house of the Lord." After, in the same way, hallowing the middle of the court, "Solomon held a feast, and all Israel with him, a great congregation, from the entering in of Hamath unto the river of Egypt, before the Lord our God, seven days and seven days, even fourteen days." Sacrifice was the sealing and sanctifying worship of the Israelitish Church. Through the sacrifices which Solomon offered in conjunction with the people he completed the dedication of the temple. Sacrifice was to the Israelite what worship is to the Christian. It was confession and supplication, thanksgiving, and especially the dedication of himself to the service of the Most High. Solomon and all the congregation of Israel, when the ark of the covenant was being removed from the city of David to be placed in the temple, went before it sacrificing sheep and oxen that could not be told nor numbered for multitude. There the internal worship of the heart and mind, or the worship of the inward man, was represented. And the things that enter into this worship cannot be told or numbered for multitude. So the Psalmist says, "How precious are Thy thoughts unto me, O God! how great is the sum of them! If I should count them, they are more in number than the sand" (cxxxix. 17, 18). "Many, O Lord, are Thy wonderful works which Thou hast done, and Thy thoughts which are to usward: they cannot be reckoned up in order unto Thee. If I would declare and speak of them, they are more than can be numbered" (xl. 5). Internal worship is a deep sense of the wonderful works which have been done to us and in us, and the precious thoughts that have been to usward, in the work of our regeneration; for that work and these thoughts transcend our apprehension and our power of estimation. This is the internal worship so well described by Addison when he says—

"When all Thy mercies, O my God,
My rising soul surveys,
Transported with the view, I'm lost
In wonder, love, and praise."

The bringing up of the ark of the covenant, to be deposited in the holy of holies, which is the raising of the holy law of God into the holiest place in the mind, is itself an act of the holiest and most interior worship, and one in which the worshipper has an inexpressible sense of the love and mercy of Him who has not only given us His law for our guidance, but who has given Himself for our salvation, and who has promised to meet us and commune with us over the mercy-seat of His propitiating love, and between the cherubim of love to Him and charity to our neighbour. For "the priests brought in the ark of the covenant of the Lord unto his place, into the oracle of the house, to the most holy place, even under the wings of the cherubims." And such was the holiness of the law, that "when the priests were come out of the holy place, the cloud filled the house of the Lord, so that the priests could not stand to minister because of the cloud: for the glory of the Lord had filled the house of the Lord." It was then that Solomon spake, and after he had explained to the people the reason that he, rather than his father David, had been appointed to build the house, offered up the dedicatory prayer, the spiritual import of which we have considered.

The sacrifice which the king, and all Israel with him, offered unto the Lord after his wonderfully comprehensive and beautiful prayer was ended, represented that worship which is of the external man, the things of which can be numbered. For numbering, as we have seen, does not, in the spiritual sense, express quantity but quality. Things and states that in their nature transcend the ideas of thought, that are matters of feeling rather than of thinking, are said to be unnumbered; while those which become subjects of thought and thence of utterance, are capable of being numbered, since their quality can be known and estimated. And this external worship is the complement and fulfilment of internal worship. Worship, like life, desires to come into fulness in outward and expressive acts. Therefore we often read in the Word of seeming repetitions, because that which is done in outward act is often a seeming repetition of what has been previously done as an act of the mind. The mind is indeed in every outward act, otherwise the act would be automatic; but the mind sometimes acts without the simultaneous action of the body, although the body does not so act without the mind. But worship, although it may be a separate mental act, must in due time and at suitable seasons become an act of the mind and body combined. This makes the act of worship complete. And when worship exists in its fulness it exists in its holiness and in its power.

Besides the general sacrifices which Solomon offered, or included in them, he offered a sacrifice of peace-offerings. Now the peace-offering was among the freewill-offerings. And the freewill-offerings repre-

sented worship from freedom, and what is from freedom is from love; and love is the perfection of worship, as it is the fulfilling of the law. Peace, too, is the highest end of worship. The end of worship is to be at peace with God. And worship has this peace-making effect when it brings the mind of the worshipper into conformity with the mind of the Being worshipped. And this it does when all the affections and thoughts are brought into conformity with the will and wisdom of God, and are devoted to the service of Him who bestowed them. This is true worship. The affections and thoughts which are to be devoted to the Lord in worship, and which constitutes worship, were represented in the Israelitish Church by the offerings made to the Lord, especially by the clean and unblemished animals offered in sacrifice upon the altar. Solomon's peace-offerings consisted of oxen and sheep; and animals from the herd represented celestial-natural affections, and animals from the flock represented celestial-rational affections. The number of animals offered on the occasion of dedicating the temple must have been immense, and the profusion was no doubt intended to express, in their own way, the fervour of the devotion by which the king and the people were inspired on so grand a ceremonial. And grand it was beyond all their conceptions. No less than the representative occasion of the King of kings dedicating the glorious Temple of His perfected Humanity to the indwelling Divinity, when all the human affections and perceptions of the Glorified Man were hallowed, by being offered and united to the Divine Love and Wisdom, as existing from eternity in the Creator of heaven and earth. And as the effect and image of this, it was the representative occasion of dedicating to the Saviour the Church, as the mystical body and temple of His presence with His people, and, not the least significant and important to us, the dedication of regenerated humanity, in the persons of those who are built up into temples of the Holy Spirit, which is the Spirit of the Lord dwelling, with all the riches of redeeming love, in the hearts of the faithful. This state is peace in its realized spiritual sense. It is the inward peace which is secured by the Christian having, by the power of Jesus Christ, conquered all his inward enemies, and brought every thought and affection into a harmonious relation to each other, and to the Lord, who conquered all that raised itself above His Divine authority. And the multitude of oxen and sheep offered is expressive of the completeness of the worship which consists in hallowing all the affections to the Lord and to His service. For the twenty-two thousand is expressive of the conjunction of goodness and truth in the outward man, or the celestial-natural mind, and the hundred and twenty thousand sheep is expressive of the conjunction of goodness and truth in the inner man, or the celestial-rational mind.

A thousand often occurs in the Word as expressive of a large but

indefinite number. In the Divine sense it is expressive of what is infinite and eternal; and in the spiritual sense, of what has something of infinite and eternal in it, or of that in the human mind in which the Lord dwells with His love and wisdom, giving to the finite recipient the power of indefinite and endless progression in goodness and truth. The Lord dwells, and can only dwell, in that which is His own, not in anything that is ours. In every human mind the Lord provides that some heavenly seeds shall be sown by angelic and human hands during infancy and childhood; and these, like the first vegetation that clothes the flinty rock or barren ground, form the vegetable soil which becomes, in those who preserve and improve it, the good ground of an honest heart, in which the seeds sown by the Son of Man in later life take root, and bear fruit, and bring forth, some an hundredfold, some sixty, some thirty. These are the "remains" in which the heavenly life in every one has its beginning. And these are especially meant, when they are expressed numerically, by ten; and they may indeed be expressed by any multiple of ten; for this mode of increasing a number does not change its characteristic meaning but only exalts it. Twenty has thus the same meaning as ten; so has ten tens, and so has ten hundred. The same idea enters into them all; the difference is only in degree. This number enters into so many others, because that which it primarily signifies enters into all subsequent states of mind; for regeneration is according to the quantity and quality of remains. There are other numbers that express other ideas, because there are various states of human experience. For although the essential elements of spiritual life are the same in all, there are differences in each. There are states through which all pass, and states which only some experience; and all these are expressed, when the subject requires it, by different numbers. Six, for example, is expressive of a state of labour and temptation, and seven of a state of rest and peace: like the six days of work and the Sabbath of rest. Two is expressive of the heavenly marriage, or the conjunction of goodness and truth. And this is the reason that the two in the first of the present numbers directs us to this meaning.

But besides the offerings which Solomon made to the Lord in dedicating the temple and hallowing the middle of the court, the king "held a feast, and all Israel with him, a great congregation, from the entering in of Hamoth unto the river of Egypt, before the Lord our God." While sacrifice represented the conjunction of the numbers of the Church with the Lord, feasts represented their conjunction with each other. The means of conjunction are love to the Lord and love to each other. The sacrifices and feasts were therefore other forms of the two commandments on which hang all the law and the prophets. The vast congregation which participated in this uniting feast, was

from Hamoth unto the river of Egypt, to mark the extent of Solomon's dominion. Hamoth was on the northern and Egypt was on the southern extremity of the land which owned his sway, so that his dominion extended from Syria to Egypt. The extent of Solomon's dominion was, in fact, that which the Lord through Moses had promised should be the extent of Israel's possessions. "Your border shall be from Egypt unto the entrance of Hamoth" (Num. xxiv. 5-8). This promise was now fulfilled; and in its fulfilment was represented the extension of the Church from wisdom to science, for the Syrians were among those who were called sons of the east. The feast is said to have lasted seven days and seven days, even fourteen days. In the Book of Chronicles it is said "they kept the dedication of the altar seven days, and the feast seven days" (2 Chron. vii. 9). The eighth day on which the people were sent away was therefore the first after the seventh day of the feast. Seven is a holy number, and twice seven is expressive of what is most holy. The eighth day is the beginning of a new state, which includes in it the previous states of holiness, which have been acquired in the course of the regenerate life, states of love and states of charity. The people "blessed the king, and went unto their tents joyful and glad of heart for all the goodness that the Lord had done for David His servant, and for Israel His people."

In looking at this subject in its highest and therefore holiest sense, in which the temple represents the Lord's humanity, we see in its completion and dedication the glorification of the humanity, and its union with the Divinity. It is not perhaps necessary that there should be any outward resemblance between the historical circumstances connected with the building and dedication of the temple and those recorded in connection with the glorification of the Lord's humanity. Yet it is not unreasonable to expect that the historical as well as the prophetical Scriptures should show some traces of literal similitude, such as those between the prediction and the event in Zechariah and the Psalms. It was after the Lord's triumphal entry into Jerusalem, immediately before His crucifixion, and in reference to which He said, "The hour is come that the Son of Man should be glorified" (John xii. 26); and, when Judas had gone out to betray Him, "Now is the Son of Man glorified, and God is glorified in Him" (xiii. 31): it was on this occasion that He went into the temple, and cast out the mercenary dealers, and said unto them, "It is written, My house shall be called of all nations the house of prayer; but ye have made it a den of thieves" (Mark xi. 17). It was then also that the Lord ate the passover with His disciples, and instituted the Holy Supper, as a feast commemorative of His great works of Glorification and Redemption. And the dedicatory prayer of Solomon may find a parallel, both in character and meaning, in that Divine prayer in which Jesus, when

He had lifted up His eyes to heaven, said, "Father, glorify Thy Son, that Thy Son also may glorify Thee;" in which He prayed for His disciples, that they might be kept from evil and sanctified through the truth, and might be one even as He and the Father were one; and in which, as Solomon prayed, not only for his own people, Israel, but for the stranger, who cometh out of a far country for the Lord's name sake; so the Lord prayed, not only for His disciples, but for them which should believe on Him through their word.

When we regard Solomon as a type of Jesus, and the temple as a symbol of His humanity, we can, at least, see that the grand ceremonial of its dedication is no less than a foreshadowing of the consecration of the Lord's humanity to the service of the Divinity, as the Temple in which the Creator dwells, in which He is present with angels in heaven and with men on earth, towards which all eyes are to be turned and all prayers directed, and from which all help and blessing come. When spiritual Israel look up to Jesus as their King, as much greater than Solomon as the eternal is greater than the temporal, and unite with Him in celebrating the great event of the Incarnation, which has brought their God near to them, for their help and comfort, they have reason to bless their King, and to go unto their tents joyful and glad of heart, for all the good that the Lord hath done for David His servant, and for Israel His people. The faithful, when they have entered in spirit into the contemplation of that marvellous work of Divine wisdom and benevolence, which has provided for them and for all men the inestimable blessing of Salvation, cannot but be joyful and glad of heart, and carry that state of mind down into their homes and into all their conduct and life in the world.

An encouraging and warning voice came to Solomon, after he had finished the temple, and through him to the people, after they had departed to their homes. "The Lord appeared to Solomon the second time, as He had appeared unto him at Gibeon. The Lord said unto him, I have heard thy prayer and thy supplication, that thou hast made before Me: I have hallowed this house, which thou hast built, to put My name there for ever; and Mine eyes and Mine heart shall be there perpetually." This second appearance of the Lord to Solomon, like Solomon's second sacrifice, is the completion and confirmation of the first, as that which is begun in the inner, is perfected in the outer man. Regarded in its highest sense, how well does the Divine language apply to the Divine Humanity. "I have hallowed this house, which thou hast built, to put My name there for ever; and Mine eyes and Mine heart shall be there continually." The Temple of the Humanity is the Lord's eternal dwelling-place, and His Wisdom and His Love shall be there perpetually. The Lord promises to Solomon that if he will walk before Him, as David his father did, in

integrity of heart and uprightness, and do all that He had commanded him, He would establish the throne of his kingdom upon Israel for ever; but that if he should at all turn from following the Lord, He would cut off Israel out of the land, and the house itself He should cast out of His sight, and Israel should become a proverb and a byword among all people. How can this apply to Him whom Solomon and the temple represented? It can apply to Him relatively, not absolutely; as the Lord is represented as a lamb slain, when the Divinity of His Humanity is denied (Rev. v. 6). But the encouragement and the warning are to the Church and its members. That which has been built up by faith and labour can only be preserved by integrity of heart and uprightness of life. This is the lesson which the Lord, on His second appearing to Solomon, teaches us. And it is one that we should lay to heart, for in no state that we attain on earth can we forego the exercise of watchfulness and prayer.

CHAPTER XII.

CABUL.

1 Kings ix. 10-14.

HIRAM, king of Tyre, who had supplied much of the material and many of the skilled workmen for building the house of the Lord and the king's house, had received, during the progress of the work, a yearly subsidy of twenty thousand measures of wheat for food for his household, and twenty measures of pure oil (v. 11). Thus the natural man supplies the spiritual with the materials, and the knowledge required for preparing the materials, for building in the mind a habitation for the Lord to dwell in, while the spiritual man supplies the natural with the principles of truth and goodness as the means of supporting the life of faith and love. But "it came to pass at the end of twenty years, when Solomon had built the two houses, the house of the Lord, and the king's house, (now Hiram the king of Tyre had furnished Solomon with cedar-trees and fir-trees, and with gold, according to all his desire,) that then king Solomon gave Hiram twenty cities in the land of Galilee." So that the spiritual man not only supplies the natural with the internal and essential principles of truth and goodness, but gives him the external and doctrinal principles corresponding to them, and in these doctrinals the external affections of goodness and truth which constitute their life: for the cities which Solomon gave to Hiram were not only Israelitish cities, but cities inhabited by Israelites, cities filled with life and industry. These cities

were in Galilee; but Galilee had not yet acquired the Gentile character and external signification that it had after the deportation of the ten tribes, and the filling of their depopulated cities with the subjects of their heathen conqueror. Galilee belonged at this time to the tribe of Naphtali, that tribe to which the mother of Hiram, the Tyrian artificer, belonged. Naphtali was described by Jacob as a hind let loose, giving goodly words (Gen. xliv. 21); and signified the freedom of natural affection, especially after temptation. Galilee partook of this natural signification; so that cities in that part of Canaan formed a suitable present to the king of Tyre, whose representative character accorded with the place where the bestowed possession lay. Galilee also was contiguous to Tyre, which was on the sea-coast to the west of Galilee; so that from its natural situation, it was a suitable gift, so far as Solomon was concerned, and from its spiritual meaning suitable, so far as regards the spiritual man.

But the result was not what Solomon no doubt desired and expected. "Hiram came out from Tyre to see the cities which Solomon had given him; and they pleased him not. And he said, What cities are these which thou hast given me, my brother? And he called them the land of Cabul unto this day." Attempts have been made to discover the ground of Hiram's disappointment and chagrin. Some have supposed that as the Tyrians were a maritime people, a commercial nation, whose merchants were princes, Hiram was displeased at being presented with inland towns, instead of places that would have afforded him room for extending his border along the seashore. But the narrative itself suggests another and the only plausible reason. Hiram seems to have made no objection to the situation of the cities, and only found fault with the cities themselves after he had seen them. It is not at all surprising that the cities of Canaan, even in the time of Solomon, may have appeared mean and squalid in the eyes of the king of Tyre. Tyre was then perhaps the richest, the most prosperous, and the most luxurious city in the world; and although David and Solomon had amassed great wealth for the building of the temple, and the Israelites had made considerable progress in the arts, yet in wealth and refinement the subjects of Solomon must have been far behind those of Hiram. This condition of Tyre answered to her representative character. And indeed the representative character of the ancient peoples and nations that have a place in the Bible history, is not arbitrary, but arises out of the particular genius which they inherit and develop. For the different nations of the earth are, in relation to each other, as the different individuals or classes in one nation are to one another; and both of these differences owe their origin and existence, and correspond, to the different faculties of the human mind, all national differences of character and pursuit being the result of one

particular faculty having, from natural tendency or accidental or local circumstances, taken a particular direction. So much is this the case that there are, we are told, nations in these modern times of ours answering to all the nations of antiquity, having similar characteristic differences and similar correspondences. And these differences and correspondences must become more distinctly marked the more the national characters are developed. These differences are providential, and are important means of general advancement as well as of present benefit. It is, on the largest scale, a division of labour, mental and physical, by which greater perfection is attained, both in the quality and measure of production, than would be possible if all nations took one direction and pursued one object. It is a reason for amity between peoples and nations, and for friendly intercourse, and the free exchange of their mental and physical wealth. Such will be the happy result of these differences of natural character and pursuit when men and nations become wiser and better; when they recognise and work in harmony with the Creator, who has made of one blood all nations of men for to dwell upon the face of the earth; when Ephraim shall not envy Judah, and Judah shall not vex Ephraim; when, in brief, men shall see that, both in their individual and national dealings with each other, what is right in principle is best in practice.

Yet there is this to be expected, that those who are lower in the scale of intellectual development will be less willing to yield compliance with the awards of high principle; just as in our own nature there are some elements that are less disposed than others to comply with the requirements of law and order, that are ordained for their own good, as well as for that of the whole man, body and soul. Our natural appetites and passions are sometimes unwilling to submit to the dictates of reason and prudence. Some of the most necessary of our mental acquisitions have a tendency to deteriorate the mind which they are intended to improve. Solomon represents wisdom as exhorting men to receive knowledge rather than choice gold (Prov. viii. 10); and yet the Apostle tells us that knowledge puffeth up (1 Cor. viii. 1); this however is knowledge without charity, which, he tells us, edifieth. Now Tyre represented knowledge, even that kind of knowledge of which the Apostle speaks; and the Tyrians represented those who cultivate knowledge, but are liable to neglect charity, and who therefore are in danger of being puffed up, being deficient in the grace that edifieth. In the prophets Tyre is described generally as being of this character, and her ruin is predicted as a consequence. "Thou hast been in Eden the garden of God; every precious stone was thy covering. By thy great wisdom and by thy traffic hast thou increased thy riches, and thine heart is lifted up because of thy riches. Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty" (Ezek. xxviii.). "It shall come to

pass after the end of seventy years, that the Lord will visit Tyre, and she shall turn to her hire, and shall commit fornication with all the kingdoms of the world upon the face of the earth. And her merchandise and her hire shall be holiness to the Lord: it shall not be treasured nor laid up; for her merchandise shall be for them that dwell before the Lord, to eat sufficiently, and for durable clothing" (Isa. xxiii. 17, 18). Here we have a very striking representative description of the result of unsanctified knowledge in puffing up the mind, and that of the true value and use of knowledge, in its being sanctified, and becoming holiness to the Lord, when bestowed upon those who will apply it to its right use, by employing it to procure the essential means of life.

Now the very tendency to this pride of knowledge, and the consequent tendency to place it above the charity which edifieth, may enable us to see why Hiram, king of Tyre, when he came to see the cities in the land of Canaan which Solomon had given him, should have seen no beauty in them, but have given them a name which meant that he had no pleasure in them. This does not, however, imply that he regarded them with disgust or contempt. It is evident from his addressing Solomon as his brother, and from giving the king of Israel sixty talents of gold, that he appreciated the gift, although he saw no beauty in it. The character of the Tyrians was like that of the spirits of mercury, who occupy a province in the Grand Man, and are therefore in a heavenly state, and yet are chiefly concerned with the knowledge of things. They correspond to the memory, but to the memory of things abstracted from what is terrestrial and purely material. When it was suggested to them whether they proposed any use from their knowledge, since it is not enough to be delighted with knowledge, because knowledge has respect to use as an end, they replied that they were delighted with knowledge, and that to them knowledge was use. The genius of these spirits our author exemplifies by his own experience. Spirits, when they come to any one, put on all things contained in his memory. "Some spirits came to me. Whilst searching into various things (in my memory), and among them the cities and countries where I had been, I observed that they had no wish to know the temples, palaces, houses, and streets, but only the things that had been transacted in them, with what was transacted there, and to the genius and manners of the inhabitants, and other similar things. I was surprised to find them of such a character, and inquired why they disregarded the magnificence of the places, and attended only to the parts and transactions connected with them. They replied that they had no delight in regarding natural, corporeal, and terrestrial objects, but only things that are real."

The cities of Canaan represented the doctrines of the Church and of religion. This is the spiritual meaning of cities in the most

comprehensive sense; but in the particular sense they signify the interiors of the mind where doctrinals are, or rather where truths are conjoined to goodness; for the principles of truth and goodness which belong to any one form as it were a city, and hence one in whom the Church is, is called the city of God. The signification of a city is like that of a house. In the universal sense a house signifies goodness, but in the particular sense it signifies a man, especially his mind, where goodness and truth are conjoined; and a house with its apartments, circumjacent buildings, and courts is a city in the least form.

Those who are in the knowledge more than in the life of religion can take pleasure in what we may call the outworks of religion, in building churches and attending to all that relates to their support and adornment; in contributing to the agencies that are employed for increasing and diffusing a knowledge of the truth; and in supplying the skill as well as the means for organization and development. They do not originate any great or useful work of an internal and elevating kind. They do not produce and nourish living principles, but only help to construct the outward forms in which inward principles may find a dwelling-place. Their character and function in this respect are well described by the prophet Isaiah, in the burden of Tyre: "Be thou ashamed, O Zidon: for the sea hath spoken, even the strength of the sea, saying, I travail not, nor bring forth children, neither do I nourish up young men, nor bring up virgins" (xxiii. 4). Tyre and Zidon are those who are in the knowledge of truth and goodness, but who do not give birth to these living principles themselves, and do not therefore nourish the affections of truth nor bring up the affections of goodness, but are content to remain in the knowledge of divine and spiritual things. As merchants and traffickers in spiritual things, they are useful to others; and therefore it is said, "Be still, ye inhabitants of the isle; thou whom the merchants of Zidon, that pass over the sea, have replenished" (ver. 2).

There are those who find their vocation and the delight of their lives in verbal criticism, and in the study of subjects that tend to establish the truth and elucidate the meaning of the letter of the Scriptures. And all such students perform an important use. They are doing for the theologian and the preacher, and for the whole Church, what Hiram did for Solomon, and through him for Israel. For the letter of the Word is the temple in which its spiritual and celestial senses are contained, and in which the Divine presence is with men; and whatever helps us to a more exact knowledge and intelligent understanding of the literal sense of the Word, helps us to a more accurate view of its internal meaning. Such students of the letter, though affirmative and devout, may not feel an interest or take delight in the interior subjects which the Bible, as a Divine revelation, was designed to teach. They do not reject them as things of no value and unworthy,

of their acceptance, but they have no pleasure in them as subjects of study. To them they are Cabul, and the sphere of investigation to which they belong is the land of Cabul; and if they continue in this state of mind, the higher objects and studies of religion are what the cities of Canaan, given by Solomon, were to Hiram, who "called them the land of Cabul unto this day."

Those who belong to that class of minds represented by the king and the men of Tyre, and whose genius makes them willing and skilful workers in the sacred cause of revealed religion, but in that department which relates to its external evidences, need to be careful that they do not so neglect or contemn its inward spirit as to bring themselves under the condemnation pronounced against Tyre as the enemy of Israel. Science and knowledge supply and prepare the material for laying the foundation and building the house, but the end or purpose of the house is that the Lord may there inscribe His name, and that He may be worshipped therein.

CHAPTER XIII.

SOLOMON'S CITIES: TADMOR IN THE WILDERNESS.

1 Kings ix. 16.

IN chapter v. we read that Solomon made a levy out of all Israel, and the levy was thirty thousand men. And Solomon had seventy thousand that bare burdens, and eighty thousand hewers in the mountains: besides the chief officers who were over the work, three thousand and three hundred, who ruled over the people that wrought in the work. It appears however from chapter ix. that those who performed the servile labour were the children of the nations of Canaan whom the Israelites had been unable to subdue. On these Solomon levied a tribute of bond-service; but of the children of Israel Solomon made no bondmen, but they were men of war, and his servants, and his princes, and his captains, and rulers of his chariots, and his horsemen. These were the chief officers that were over Solomon's work, five hundred and fifty. This was the usual fate, in olden times, of conquered nations. In the case of the Israelites it represented the natural in subjection to the spiritual, and the service which the lower was made to render to the higher. The Israelites themselves had been bondmen, and had been made to render bond-service, to the Egyptians, and all their service was with rigour; but this represented that inversion of order, the spiritual in bondage, and compelled to render bond-service, to the natural. Besides the house of the Lord, and his own

house, Solomon built Millo, and the wall of Jerusalem, as well as a number of cities. Millo, as the name expresses, was a rampart or mound, which had been built by David (2 Sam. v. 9), but was so extended by Solomon, as to entitle him to be considered the builder of the new structure. This and the wall of Jerusalem were for the protection of the city, which now contained the glory of Israel, the house dedicated to the Lord as the true God, to which the nations might look and from which they might learn. The wall, great and high, which encloses and defends the holy city New Jerusalem, shows that the wall of the earthly city had a representative meaning. Walls and ramparts signify the doctrines of the literal sense of the Word; for the literal sense of the Word defends its spiritual sense, as walls defend a city. But as doctrines introduce those who are friendly, as well as exclude those who are hostile, to the Church, the walls of the holy city had gates on all sides.

Solomon built several cities in Canaan itself, which represented internal doctrines of the Church. Hazor was in Naphtali, Megiddo was in Manasseh, Gezer was in Ephraim, Bethhoron the nether was in Benjamin, and Baalath was in Dan. It would be interesting to consider these cities singly as well as collectively, but as this would occupy too much space, it must suffice to notice one or two. Hazor, the first mentioned, and whose name indicates a place of great strength, had formerly been the head of all the Canaanitish kingdoms. This is evident from the account given by Joshua of the conduct of Jabin king of Hazor, when he heard of the defeat of the five kings on the memorable day when the sun stood still. He sent to the kings of the Canaanites east and west, south and north, and they went out, they and their hosts with them, much people, even as the sand that is upon the sea-shore for multitude, with horses and chariots very many. Encouraged by the Lord, Joshua led Israel against this mighty host, and they smote them until they left them none remaining. "And Joshua at that time turned back, and took Hazor, and smote the king thereof: for Hazor before time was at the head of all these kingdoms" (xi. 1-10). This head of all the Canaanitish kingdoms, which had been destroyed by Joshua, was built by Solomon. "There is a time to break down, and a time to build up" (Eccles. iii. 3). Solomon's reign was the time for building up. The reign of goodness is the time for building up habitations of peace where habitations of violence had been, and which the power of truth had destroyed. In the place where the head of all these evil kingdoms had been, Solomon planted a new city in the possessions of that tribe to which Hazor had been assigned, those of the tribe of Naphtali, because that tribe represented those who, by temptation-conflicts, come into a state of liberty, and into the marriage of goodness and truth.

In the "Adversaria" the city of Hazor, in Joshua xi., is explained to mean the Roman religion, which is expressed by various names. As the leading characteristic of that religion is the love of dominion, which is the desire to rule over all, this is well represented by Hazor being the head of all the kingdoms of Canaan, and by their kings obeying the call of Jabin to come up and fight against Israel. But as the love of dominion is not confined to any one form of religion, nor to any one class of men, we are to look for it and fight against it in ourselves. And when we have overcome that great evil, we are to build up that which is its opposite in character and use. The cities which Solomon built or rebuilt in Canaan occupied the same sites and bore the same names as those they superseded. An evil is but a good perverted. The evils of the Canaanites were the perverted goodnesses of the Ancient Church; and the places in Canaan had their representative character from that earlier dispensation. The Israelites did not originate, they only restored, the symbolisms of the Ancient Church, even in rebuilding the cities which they themselves had thrown down. This city is the first mentioned of those which Solomon built, because the principle it represented is the first in importance of all which these restored cities of Canaan represented.

Gezer is mentioned with this peculiarity, that "Pharaoh king of Egypt had gone up, and taken it, and burnt it with fire, and slain the Canaanites that dwelt in the city, and given it for a present unto his daughter, Solomon's wife." Why Pharaoh had gone up against Gezer, which was in Solomon's dominions, it is difficult to conjecture, and impossible, in the absence of any explanation, to understand. We find that when Horam king of Gezer came up to help Lachish, Joshua smote him and his people, until he had left none remaining (Josh. x. 33). The children of Ephraim, who obtained this city as part of their inheritance, "drave not out the Canaanites that dwelt in Gezer: but the Canaanites dwell among the Ephraimites unto this day, and serve under tribute" (xvi. 10). This condition of things was not peculiar to the sons of Ephraim and the inhabitants of Gezer, for several of the tribes failed to drive out the original inhabitants of the cities they took, and continued to live together with their vanquished enemies. But Pharaoh, in this instance, accomplished what the sons of Ephraim had been unable to effect. It would seem, indeed, that not only had the children of Ephraim failed to drive out the Canaanites, but that the Canaanites had driven out the children of Ephraim; otherwise Pharaoh would not have burnt the city—unless we are to suppose that at the time he went up against Gezer he was not on friendly relations with Israel. But whatever may have been the circumstances, the facts recorded are all we have to guide us to their spiritual meaning.

Gezer, as part of the possession of Ephraim, partook of the repre-

sentative character of the tribe. Ephraim represented the intellectual principle of the Church, or the new understanding, as Manasseh, his elder brother, represented the new will, born and existing in the natural mind. But there is something connected with Ephraim and Manasseh which does not apply to the fathers of the other tribes. They were the sons of an Israelitish father but of an Egyptian mother, for Joseph was married to Asenath, daughter of Poti-pheri, the priest of On, and being born and educated in Egypt, they had something of the Egyptian character as well as nature in them. Asenath was not, like Hagar, a handmaid and concubine, but the daughter of a priest and a wife. She represented, not the affection of science, but the affection of good, but of good having a scientific origin, and therefore having a scientific character. Here we find Gezer, a city of Ephraim, a tribe descended from the son of an Egyptian mother, taken by an Egyptian king, and restored to Solomon, as king of Israel, through an Egyptian wife; for Gezer was part of the dower which Pharaoh's daughter brought to Solomon. Gezer must therefore represent the doctrine of the Church, as built up in the intellect grounded in the affection and perception of science, the science not of material but of spiritual things. For it is to be remembered that Gezer, as it came to Solomon, was but the ruins of the Canaanitish town. Pharaoh took it, and burnt it with fire, and slew the Canaanites; it was Solomon who built or restored it.

There is one other city that Solomon built that demands special notice. Tadmor in the wilderness has acquired celebrity from its having risen, after Solomon's time, from a simple town, for the rest and refreshment of merchants in passing through the Syrian desert, into a city of extraordinary magnificence. To the general reader of history it is better known as Palmyra. Both names have the same meaning, and designate it as the city of palms. The description of this city as given by Jones, in his work on the proper names of the Bible, is the most concise we can present:—

"Solomon built this city on a fertile spot, on what is usually called an oasis in the desert; for here were fountains of water to refresh the thirsty traveller, and shady trees to screen him from the sun. It is remarkable that he should have chosen such a spot to found a city, surrounded as it was with an extensive and inhospitable waste—a wilderness of barrenness and desolation; but when we consider that it was a place abounding with palms and fountains of water, and that all caravans with the produce of Eastern Asia from the Persian Gulf and the banks of the Euphrates to Phœnicia, Syria, and the various mercantile cities of the Mediterranean, must necessarily pass that way, we see at once the good policy of the Jewish monarch in founding a city there. His wisdom in the selection is proved from the fact that it

became the greatest mercantile city of the ancient Eastern world, and was the emporium of all the luxuries of India. Nothing is recorded in Scripture about it except that Solomon built it. It was first destroyed by Nebuchadnezzar, according to an ancient historian; and afterwards it submitted to the Persians, the Greeks, and the Romans; but it was only under the last of these that it attained the summit of its glory. In the time of Aurelian, the governor, Odentos, styled himself emperor of Palmyra and the east, and he bid fair to maintain the dignity he had assumed; but sudden death arrested him in his career. His queen, however, followed in his steps; but the emperor Aurelian marched a large army against her, and, after one battle, compelled her to retire within the walls of Palmyra. He laid siege to it, and, after an obstinate resistance, subdued it, consigning the city to the rapacity of his soldiers; it was afterwards however repaired.

"The queen of the Eastern world is now a ruin, and the abode of a small tribe of Arabs, whose wretched hovels are established in the peristyle court of the great temple. The ruins of this city are the most magnificent in the world, if one may so term such an evident token of human frailty. Here are thousands of Corinthian columns, some of which are forty feet high, erecting their heads towards the sky. Before Bruce penetrated into Abyssinia, he visited this place; and he says that when he arrived on the top of one of the hills on the west or north-west, he beheld the most stupendous and astonishing sight. The extensive plain below was covered so thick with magnificent buildings, that one seemed to touch the other; all of fine proportion, all of agreeable form, and all of white stone; and in the distance the magnificent Temple of the Sun reared its lofty head, to the honour of which the Palmyrenians dedicated their city. For ten miles in circumference there are remains of this ancient city, though the principal ruins may be contracted to three. In this space travellers find the courts and halls of once proud palaces; here a temple with its peristyle half thrown down; and there a noble piazza, half a mile in length and forty feet in breadth, with two rows of marble columns; now we see a triumphal arch, or a violated tomb. Wherever the traveller turns his head, the earth is strewn with chiselled stones half buried, with broken entablatures, with damaged capitals, mutilated friezes, disfigured relics, effaced sculptures, and ruined altars." It may be remarked that more recent travellers have made, by closer observation, some deduction from the grandeur of this description, especially as to the purity of the style of architecture and the finish of the work; but after all allowance is made for the glow of first and general impressions, there can be no doubt that the ruins of Palmyra are something marvellous.

But our chief concern is with the beginning of this magnificent place as Tadmor in the wilderness.

If we view this city, erected by Solomon in the desert, as a resting-place for pilgrims, in connection with the cityless desert through which Israel passed in their way to Canaan, we can hardly fail to see in it the sign and emblem of a change of state, such as that not unfrequently predicted in the prophets, when "the wilderness and the solitary place shall be glad for them; and the desert shall rejoice, and blossom as the rose. And an highway shall be there, and it shall be called The way of holiness; the unclean shall not pass over it; but it shall be for those: the wayfaring men, though fools, shall not err therein. No lion shall be there, nor any ravenous beast shall go up thereon, it shall not be found there; but the redeemed [of the Lord] shall walk there: and the ransomed of the Lord shall return, and come to Zion with songs and everlasting joy upon their heads: they shall obtain joy and gladness, and sorrow and sighing shall flee away" (Isa. xxxv.). All this cannot be drawn from the circumstance of Solomon building a city in the desert, but it points in this direction. The Psalmist, speaking of the redeemed of the Lord, whom He redeemed from the hand of the enemy, describes their destitute and tried condition by saying, "They wandered in the wilderness in a solitary way; they found no city to dwell in." Yet the Lord "led them forth by the right way, that they might go to a city of habitation" (Ps. cvii.). Now the circumstances were changed. The traveller and the pilgrim were now provided with a city in the desert, where they might avoid the ills which the Psalmist laments his forefathers had suffered, when "hungry and thirsty, their soul fainted in them" (ib.). And so with the Christian. He too has to wander in the wilderness. But when he is in some degree perfected by suffering, and has prospered, and the kingdom is established in him, he can and will build a Tadmor in the desert, that it may serve to refresh those who bring their treasures to enrich and delight his soul. May we not say with the sweet singer of Israel in the same inspired composition, "O give thanks unto the Lord, for He is good: for His mercy endureth for ever"?

CHAPTER XIV.

SOLOMON'S FAME: THE QUEEN OF SHEBA'S VISIT.

1 Kings x. 1-10.

THE wealth, the glory, and the wisdom of Solomon became so famous as to gain him the admiration and the homage of all other kings. "He exceeded all the kings of the earth for riches and for wisdom. And all the earth sought to Solomon, to hear his wisdom, which God had put in

his heart. And they brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and garments, and armour, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year." In this exaltation in riches and wisdom over the kings of the earth was represented that of the Lord Himself as King of kings. This supreme royalty of the Saviour does not merely mean that He is the supreme ruler on earth as He is in heaven, that all kings rule in His might as by His authority; but understood in relation to the Church and heaven, it describes the fact that all Divine Truths, which kings signify, have relation to Him who is the Truth itself, and that their power to rule and the efficacy of their governments are derived from the Lord alone. The Lord to us is King of kings, when all the truths we know and acknowledge are subordinate to the one Divine truth that the Lord is all to us, that He is the author of our mercies and the Saviour of our souls—that Jesus in His Divine Humanity is the only object of our love and faith. This precious truth is that which sanctifies all others; and the practical exaltation of Him who is the way, the truth, and the life is that which brings wealth and peace to the soul. Solomon, as richer and wiser than all kings, is the true order of Divine truths in the inner man; and when this order is established, then the faculties and principles of the outer man render a universal submission, and bring their various offerings of gratitude or duty, to the ruling power. All the earth seek to Solomon to hear his wisdom, which in its origin is Divine, when the whole natural mind turns to the spiritual for instruction and guidance in the ways of wisdom and of life, and bring the various perceptions and knowledges of goodness and truth, to enrich the inward man with the wealth of knowledge and science. We bring our gifts, vessels of silver and of gold, and raiment, and spices, horses, and mules, year by year, when we apply the scientifics of good and truth, and the intellectual and rational perceptions of truth and goodness, to the inward principles of religion in order to confirm and illustrate them, and thus to enrich and exalt them. Such things are involved in the kings of the earth being excelled by Solomon, and by all the earth coming to hear his wisdom, and presenting him with gifts.

But while we thus read of the kings of the earth being inferior to Solomon in riches and wisdom, we find that one of the queens of the earth made a pilgrimage to the city of the renowned sovereign, to hear his wisdom and to test it with hard questions. "The queen of Sheba, when she heard the fame of Solomon concerning the name of the Lord, came to prove him with hard questions. And she came to Jerusalem with a very great train, with camels that bare spices, and very much gold, and precious stones."

The visit of the queen of Sheba to Solomon is essentially Oriental in its character. It has something of the air of an Eastern romance. But it is true history, and shows that truth is more beautiful and

instructive, if not always stranger, than fiction. It is not of human but of Divine creation. It is not shaped by the human imagination, with a view to produce a certain effect and teach a particular moral lesson. It is the outgrowth of human nature, and is shaped by that providential operation which enters into all the affairs of human life. It comes home therefore to the hearts and understandings of men, and does not, like fiction, merely or chiefly play about the imagination and appeal to the moral sentiments. The difference between them is like that brought out in one of the traditional stories that have come down to us respecting the queen of Sheba, in testing Solomon's wisdom. The queen appeared once in the presence of Solomon with two flowers in her hands, one natural and the other artificial, and demanded of the king which was the true and which the false. The artificial flower was so much like nature that the king was unable to decide; but raising his eyes he saw some bees outside the lattice; he ordered the window to be opened, when the insects at once made their way to the true flower, where the honey-cells were contained. As, in the case of the two women, he discovered the true from the false mother by appealing to the affection of the human heart, he now saw which was the true flower and which was the false by appealing to animal instinct, which, in its own sphere, is more unerring than human wisdom, but in the ready employment of which human wisdom shows its superiority and power.

One of the uses of the historic form in which God has been pleased to present a considerable portion of His Word is, that it may interest the minds of pious readers, especially of the young and simple. And as the Word is the medium of connection between heaven and earth, and of communion between angels and men, the narratives of the Bible not only, like other histories, afford immediate pleasure and instruction, but they are the means by which attendant angels convey some of their own celestial affections and delights to the mind, where they lie like hidden manna, that is gradually gathered up to feed the tender germs of heavenly feeling and thought that the Spirit of the Lord generates in every human soul.

To the young mind, with warm impulses, an ardent desire for knowledge, and a keen relish for the beautiful and the true, what can be more interesting than the conduct, what more inspiring than the example, of this Eastern queen undertaking a long and toilsome journey to do homage to the king whose fame for riches and wisdom had spread through all lands, and whose wisdom she had come to try with hard questions, not as a mere intellectual exercise, but as a means of drawing forth the treasures of human and Divine knowledge with which this favourite of heaven had been so richly endowed?

We need not stop to examine the question as to the particular

country from which Solomon's royal visitor came. Sheba is mentioned several times in Scripture, but without anything being said from which we can determine with certainty whether it was in Arabia or in Ethiopia. Our main object is to draw from it some religious instruction, and this we must expect to find in its spiritual meaning. And perhaps the safest ground on which we can base our idea of place in regard to the queen's dominions is that contained in the statement of our Lord, who calls her the queen of the south—south in relation to Palestine, south in the spiritual sense.

To the young mind, with generous sympathies, an ardent desire for knowledge, and a keen sentimental relish for the beautiful and the true, what can be more interesting than the conduct, what more inspiring than the example, of the Arabian queen undertaking a long and toilsome journey, to do homage to the king whose fame for riches and wisdom had spread through all lands, and whose wisdom she had come to try with hard questions, not as a mere intellectual exercise, but as a means of drawing forth the treasures of human and Divine knowledge with which this favourite of heaven had been so highly endowed?

Under this pleasing narrative lie profound spiritual truths relating to the Lord and the Church. In its highest typical sense it relates to the Lord Himself. The queen of Sheba coming to Solomon, to Jerusalem, with a very great train, with camels carrying spices, and very much gold and precious stones, represented the wisdom and intelligence that were added to the Lord in His humanity, whom Solomon typified. In a lower sense the incident, as we learn from the Lord's teaching, had reference to the Gentile Church. For in the Gospel, our Lord, favourably contrasting the conduct of the Gentiles of former times with that of the Jews in those days, addresses His unbelieving and profane hearers in these words: "The men of Nineveh shall rise in judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: because they repented at the preaching of Jonas; and, behold, a greater than Jonas is here. The queen of the south shall rise up in the judgment with this generation, and shall condemn it: for she came from the uttermost parts of the earth to hear the wisdom of Solomon; and, behold, a greater than Solomon is here." The Gentile queen, no doubt, therefore represented the Gentile Church, which turned with affection and a teachable spirit to the Lord the Saviour, who was indeed greater than Solomon. For if Solomon in all his glory was not arrayed like one of the lilies of the field, how much less was he to be compared to Him who created the lily, and who taught it to grow, without toiling or spinning, into a thing of simple but exquisite beauty and grace, and whose internal structure, composed of fibres woven by the hand of infinite Wisdom, is still more admirable than its outward appearance?

And what is true of the lily was still more true of Him who made it, since, under the simple garb of frail humanity, though adorned with virtue and beneficence such as never man exhibited, and speaking words such as never man spake, concealed under His human form glory, and wisdom, and riches, in themselves infinite and incomprehensible.

In its particular sense and individual application, the queen of Sheba represents that love of true wisdom which, as it is inspired by, turns to, Him who is Wisdom itself—the wisdom that is displayed and reflected in the works of creation, which is manifested in the works of Providence, Redemption, and Salvation, and which is revealed in its fulness in the Sacred Scriptures. This love of wisdom is inspired indeed into all minds. It is that which prompts the human mind everywhere to seek after knowledge—for even the love of the knowledge of nature is from the Source of all love and the Author of all knowledge. The knowledge of nature is introductory and subservient to that which we derive from the Word of God. There is an exact correspondence between them; for the same Divine love and wisdom are embodied in and expressed by both. But it is the wisdom that cometh from above through the written Word that we are now to consider. And the love of this wisdom, like its object, is spiritual, not because of a difference in its Source but in its recipients. That same love which is natural in the natural mind is spiritual in the spiritual mind. It is only those, therefore, whose minds are in some degree spiritual that can desire and seek after the wisdom of heaven. But as natural knowledge is introductory to that which is spiritual, and as spiritual knowledge itself is but the means of introduction into true wisdom, those who would acquire the wisdom of eternity from the Eternal Himself, must bring their gifts to Him whose favour they would entreat, and of whose wisdom they would receive a share.

The gifts presented in ancient times were intended to show respect and to secure favour. Those which are offered to God by the spiritually minded, are indeed intended as expressions of reverence and homage; but they are not offered as the means of propitiating Divine favour, since God is ever propitious, and more ready to give than we can be to ask. Christian offerings are made to the Lord as the overflowings of a grateful heart, that feels its affections satisfied in rendering, in humble acknowledgment, the blessings which have been received from the Divine bounty back to their beneficent Giver. And this return of the Lord's gifts to Him to whom they belong re-connects them with their Author, and brings the offerer into closer connection with Him.

The gift of the queen of Sheba was similar in its nature, as it is in its signification, to that presented to the Lord at His birth by the

wise men who came from the east to worship Him. And such gifts signify the offerings of love and faith which the true worshipper presents to the Lord, as the Object of worship, and as the Origin and Owner of everything which enters into the formation of love and faith. The wise men from the east presented to the Lord, gold, frankincense, and myrrh; and the queen of Sheba came to Solomon with a very great train, with camels that bare spices, and very much gold and precious stones. The spices signify the grateful and delightful perceptions of the Lord's love and truth, which make worship itself delightful. Every one recognises in the incense of the representative Church the symbol of the incense of praise, offered by the grateful heart to the Author of its mercies and its joys; and the spices, which were abundantly employed in the censers and on the altar of incense, denote the interior truths, which have become truths of affection, and give a grateful perception of the delights and satisfactions of holy worship.

Of the gifts brought to Solomon by the queen of Sheba, the spices were the sweet and grateful perceptions of goodness and truth, and the gold and silver were the principles of goodness and truth themselves, which are presented to the Owner and the Author of true wisdom; the very camels by which they are borne symbolize the science of the natural mind on which its higher and more valuable acquisitions rest, and which serve as the lowest mediums of connecting them with the end of all knowledge, the wisdom of loving God and keeping His commandments.

The queen of Sheba had not only heard the fame of Solomon, as a king distinguished for his wisdom and magnificence, but she had heard his fame concerning the name of the Lord. This is the great point on which our minds should be fixed in regard to the Lord Jesus as the antitype of Solomon. We should be able to say, in the language of the prophet, "Surely God is in Thee; and there is none else, there is no God. Verily Thou art a God that hidest Thyself, O God of Israel, the Saviour." The name of Jehovah is in Him: Jesus is the name, the manifestation, the expression, the form, the person of Jehovah. In coming to Him we come to the Infinite and Eternal, in Himself incomprehensible, brought near to our apprehension, and still nearer to our affections, in the blessed person of the Divine Man, with whom we are able to associate all that is pure and merciful and good, and who has encircled us within the outstretched arms of His all-comprehensive Humanity. This is the Grand Object to whom we are privileged to come, whose fame is as wide as the universe, for He is the Saviour, as He is the Author, of all the earths in the universe. Are we influenced by that love for the Lord which will inspire us with a desire to see and hear Him for ourselves? and will it draw us to Him

as nothing but the cords of love and the bands of a Man can draw us? For mere human strength and ardour shall fail, but they that wait upon the Lord shall renew their strength; they shall mount up with wings as eagles, they shall run and not be weary, they shall walk and not faint.

Let us now consider the queen's object in coming to Solomon, and the actual result of her visit. She came, it is said, to try him with hard questions. The queen's purpose no doubt was to test the wisdom of Solomon in the way which was much practised in those times. She came to propose enigmas, and test his wisdom in their solution. Those who come to the Lord have their hard questions, though they do not put them forth as riddles, to try the skill of Him whom they interrogate. The natural man indeed plays something of this part even with the Author of Revelation itself. Once, at least, it was the fashion for the natural man to maintain that both nature and Revelation were full of enigmas, which he believed even infinite Wisdom itself could never solve. Hard but honest and earnest questions—how many of these have been solved by that very Book in which the wisdom of the Lord is revealed! How many hard questions and dark enigmas has the revealed wisdom of God solved to the satisfaction of the yearning soul! The highest intellects of the heathen world laboured long and hard to solve the mysteries of God, of creation, of the soul's immortality, and future states of existence. But with all the aids derived from the traditional light of ancient, and the influence and diffused light of contemporary revelation, how obscure and distorted were their views of those great truths which are so plainly delivered in the Bible! These have ever been hard questions with mankind; and only in proportion as men have been able or willing to bring them for solution to the revealed or incarnate Wisdom have they been able to obtain true and really satisfactory answers. Such questions as these Christians do not indeed need to ask, as involving points that still require solution. But, independently of these, there are hard questions enough in every earnest one's experience. We who possess and believe the Scriptures do not question the existence of God, or of the human soul, or of heaven or hell, or even the wisdom and goodness of the Lord in His dealings with His creatures. And yet, when we come into the real business of spiritual life, there are many hard questions, both of the intellect and the heart, that can only be set at rest by submitting them in humility to the decisions of Divine Wisdom. The young Christian may know little of these except when they come in the shape of intellectual difficulties which he is not well able to surmount, or disappointments which he finds it hard to bear. In the ordinary course of religious experience there are, in later periods of life, more difficult questions to be solved, and nicer distinctions to be

drawn between God and self, and between the love of the neighbour and the love of the world; for life presents motives for increasing attachment to the two earthly loves which are antagonistic to those of heaven.

But the result of every earnest appeal to the wisdom of the great King will be such as that which attended the trial of the queen of Sheba: Solomon told her all her questions; there was not one hid from the king which he told her not. The queen, too, had communed with Solomon of all that was in her heart. And this laying open of the heart is one of the means of obtaining a full and satisfactory solution of the real questions of life, and making its paths plain, if not easy. The difficulties of life and the pains attending it arise essentially from the discordance between the human and the Divine will and wisdom. If the human will and understanding could feel and see finitely as the Divine will and understanding feel and see infinitely, there would be no mental conflict either in our perceptions or volitions—there would be no perplexities to clear up, no doubtful points of belief to determine, no conflicting impulses to decide between. It is only our nearer approach to a state of harmony with the Divine will and wisdom that brings us into a clearer perception of all truth and a more perfect love of all goodness. Every real coming to the Lord is a practical coming; a coming with the heart as well as with the understanding, and with the works as well as words.

But the answers to her questions did not constitute the whole benefit and satisfaction which the queen of Sheba derived from her visit to the court of Solomon. She had heard reports of his acts and of his wisdom in her own country, but now she saw with her own eyes and heard with her own ears. Such is the difference between indirect and direct knowledge, between what we learn from others and what we know from the Lord: and such is the difference between knowledge and wisdom; and between what the Apostle calls faith and sight. We must all first, in our own land, hear from others of the wonders of wisdom and love that exist in the spiritual and heavenly kingdoms of the Lord: but if we desire or expect to see them in reality and as they are, we must go up to Jerusalem and see eye to eye. Too often in the things of this world does distance lend enchantment to the view; and the things which we pursue as the greatest blessings often elude our grasp, or when we have obtained them, perish in the using; but those which are spiritual and eternal are seen to be more beautiful and enduring as we approach them more nearly, not theoretically but practically. The reason of this is, that the nearer we come to the Lord by a life of religion, the nearer we come to that state which reflects the Divine attributes in their purity, for we see the Divine perfections only as they are faithfully mirrored in our own minds. Nor

is the conception of the beauties of heaven an exception to this. The glories of that kingdom are indeed, in themselves, such as eye hath not seen, nor ear heard, nor hath it entered into the heart of man to conceive, yet all its magnificence and beauty will remain for ever unseen and unfelt unless they be reflected in our own hearts and understandings. We must first go up to heaven as a state before we can go up to heaven as a place. And if we indeed do go up in heart and mind to the heavenly Jerusalem while we are sojourners in this world, truly will the truth of the saying be realized, "Behold, the half was not told me." And this may be a matter of experience with regard to the heavenly state itself even while we live in this material world, obscured though our perceptions are by the dulness of the material body. Experience realizes more than knowledge promises. Such was the testimony of the queen of Sheba; and such will be the testimony of every one who acquires *for* himself and *in* himself that wisdom which comes but by experience. "And she said to the king, It was a true report that I heard in mine own land of thy acts and of thy wisdom. Howbeit I believed not the words, until I came, and mine eyes had seen it: and, behold, the half was not told me: thy wisdom and prosperity exceedeth the fame which I heard." In every instance of indirect and direct knowledge the experience of the queen of Sheba is repeated. But far more is this the case with regard to spiritual knowledge. Those who know the truth of religion, the things of eternity, only by report, as others have declared and described them, know little and believe less. We must know these things for ourselves: we must see them with our own eyes and hear them with our own ears, before we can have any adequate conception or any well-grounded belief of what has been told us. And then shall we be convinced that the half was not told us—that the reality exceeds the fame of the Lord and His kingdom.

In a still more practical view—if we know the things of religion only intellectually or theoretically, we have but an indirect knowledge of and a weak faith in them. It is only when they become things of the will and of practice, that they become truly our own; that we see them in ourselves, and feel their power, and form a true estimate of their value and importance. Happy is it when the indirect and intellectual knowledge of these things leads us to seek that more intimate and practical acquaintance with them, which opens the mind to a perception of their reality and a sense of their grandeur. While the mind is content with a kind of hearsay knowledge of religion, how distant, and cold, and formal is the state and practice of the Christian! When, on the contrary, men hear and believe the report of the glad tidings, and are inspired with an earnest desire to know these things for themselves, though they may be far removed from the centre of light and perfection, yet the desire itself is a source of satisfaction as well as a means of

progress; and although, in the words of the Lord, they be, like the queen of Sheba, in the uttermost parts of the earth, they will find their way to the city and temple of the Lord, to see the beauty of the Lord and to inquire in His temple. And if we consider the Lord's words in their spiritual sense, how expressive are they! For the south signifies where there is light or knowledge, and by the uttermost parts of the earth is signified the extreme limits of the Church—also the lowest degree of the natural mind. To come from the uttermost parts of the earth, even when it is in the south, to Jerusalem, is to advance from the most external state to the most internal—from the lowest to the highest state and condition of mind.

How far the reality exceeds the expectation in matters of spiritual faith and eternal life, we may learn from the history before us. "When the queen of Sheba had seen all Solomon's wisdom, and the house that he had built, and the meat of his table, and the sitting of his servants, and the attendance of his ministers, and their apparel, and his cupbearers, and his ascent by which he went up unto the house of the Lord; there was no more spirit in her." The splendour of Solomon's court, and the magnificence of his palaces and of the temple, represented the glory of the Church and kingdom of the Lord in His Humanity. In reference to the Church and the member of the Church the king's house and the house of Jehovah are the faculties themselves that are receptive of the principles of truth and love, for a king is the symbol of truth, and Jehovah is expressive of Divine love. The principles of goodness and truth, considered as the support of the spiritual life of the soul, are the meat of Solomon's table and the wine supplied by his cupbearers; the perceptions of truth and affections of goodness are his servants and ministers, their apparel being the holy truths by which they are adorned and distinguished. The wisdom which is first mentioned in this enumeration of the objects that the queen beheld with speechless admiration is that in which all spiritual principles have their beginning; while the ascent to the house of the Lord, which is last mentioned, is that to which they all tend. Where wisdom is the principal thing in the Church and in the mind, all intermediate things are means, the end of which is ascent to the house of the Lord—ascent into conjunction with the Lord in His Divine Humanity—ascent into a state of love to the Lord above all things—and finally an ascent into the house not made with hands, eternal in the heavens; into the mansion where the Lord dwells with the angels, with whom the regenerate as angels shall unite in serving the Lord, and shall dwell in His presence for ever. There it is that the blessed state shall be fully realized: "Happy are thy men, happy are these thy servants, which stand continually before thee, and that hear thy wisdom."

CHAPTER XV.

SOLOMON'S THRONE.

1 *Kings* x. 18.

THE regal splendour of Solomon was representative of the kingly glory of Him who was greater than Solomon, and whose kingdom is a spiritual kingdom that shall endure for ever. The wealth and magnificence which distinguished the reign of the Israelitish monarch presented a type of the spiritual riches and grandeur, the abundance of wisdom and knowledge, of goodness and truth, provided for mankind under the dominion of the King of kings, the Lord the Saviour. For this reason the particulars recorded in the Word concerning Solomon are the means of religious instruction, shadowing forth the mysteries of the Lord's kingdom, and introducing us into a knowledge of the things of the Church and heaven, as they exist without us, and as they must, in order to our salvation, be formed and established within us.

Solomon as a king represented the Lord as to His regal power and government. And the kingly power and government of the Lord, as distinguished from the priestly, are those which He exercises from His Divine truth, as distinguished from those which He exercises from His Divine love. Much is said in Scripture of the Lord as a Priest and as a King, but except from the spiritual sense, none but a worldly or natural idea of the subject can be entertained. The common idea is, that the Lord's priestly office consists in presenting the offerings of the faithful to His Father, and pleading for their acceptance on account of His own merits; and that His kingly office consists in ruling in the spiritual affairs of men in the name and by authority of the Father. This opinion, while in itself natural, is grounded in the belief of a plurality of persons in God, and cannot exist without it. But there is no God but in the Lord Jesus, and that which is called a distinction of office, is the Lord's government, as exercised by Him over angels and men in different states of spiritual perfection. The kingly government of the Lord is the government of His Divine truth, and His priestly government is the government of His Divine love: and these two kinds of government do not originate in any official distinction in the Lord, but in a difference of state in those who are the subjects of His government, both in heaven and in the world.

Solomon representing the Lord as a king, the Divine government of the Lord's truth, or of the Lord as the Truth itself, is described repre-

sentatively by the throne which Solomon made, and of which there was none made like it in any kingdom.

A throne is the sacred symbol of government and of the kingdom over which it is exercised. Heaven is the throne of God. This is the general meaning of a throne; and the other significations which it has, as of dominion and judgment, are all included under this, since heaven as a kingdom cannot stand without them: for judgment and justice are the habitation of God's throne. The throne of Solomon was the symbol of that which is called the throne of God—His kingdom consisting of the Church and heaven—the government of His Divine truth in heaven and in earth.

As Solomon was a type of the Lord as the Saviour of men—of the Lord in the Humanity which He assumed and glorified in the world—the throne which Solomon made was symbolical of the kingdom which the Lord established when He was in the world, and which was and is distinguished from all the kingdoms or churches which existed previous to His coming in the flesh. If it were our purpose to engage the reader's attention on the nature of the kingdom and government of the Lord under the Christian dispensation, as it is in its general form, and as it consists of the many, we should point out the nature and ground of the difference. But it is intended more especially to consider the subject in its particular sense and in its individual application; to consider the kingdom as it is to rule in the mind of every member of the Church—the throne as it is to be set up in every heart. Let us then consider the subject under this view.

"Solomon made a great throne of ivory, and overlaid it with the best gold."

The first peculiarity of this throne is, that it was made of ivory: and ivory signifies rational truth—or spiritual truth rationally seen and applied. This signification of ivory arises from the circumstance that an elephant signifies the natural mind in general, and the tusks of the elephant, as being the instruments of his power and the weapons of offence and defence, and also as being white and of a fine texture, signify the most excellent truth of the natural man, which is rational truth.

Ivory is mentioned in several parts of Scripture, where truth of this kind is treated of. Once in three years the ships of Tarshish brought gold and silver, ivory, apes, and peacocks (x. 22). In the 27th chapter of Ezekiel, at the 5th and 15th verses, we read, as indicating the wealth of Tyre, that their ships had oars of oak and benches or seats of ivory; and that the merchants of many countries had brought them horns of ivory and ebony. Tyre signifies the knowledge of truth by which we acquire intelligence: and this knowledge is signified by a ship, the oars of which were of oak and their benches of ivory: oars

denote those things of the understanding which are allied to the senses, and ivory those which belong to reason: horns of ivory denote the power which is derived from truth rationally understood.

We read in Scripture of palaces, houses, and beds of ivory; palaces and houses signifying the mind itself as formed or regenerated from rational truth; doctrine derived from such truth being meant by beds of ivory. In the 45th Psalm, which treats of the Lord's union with the Church, all His garments are said to smell of myrrh, and aloes, and cassia, out of the *ivory palaces*, whereby they have made Him glad: the perfumed garments out of the ivory palaces are truths derived from the Lord, grateful to the perception of the rational mind—or from their being seen in the clear light of reason.

Truths of this description are eminently those of the Christian Church, and more especially of that Church as it exists under the Lord's Second Advent. For the glory and also the power of Christian truth arise from the circumstance, that it is not only acknowledged to be of Divine authority, but it is seen to be of Divine wisdom. The simple acknowledgment of the truths of Revelation cause them to enter into the natural or external mind, where they remain as matters of science and authority; but perception introduces them into the rational or internal mind, and renders them subjects of light and reason. The acknowledgment without the perception of truth is that which gives rise to a state and sense of servitude; but the perception of truth produces a state and sense of freedom: for when one thus knows the truth, the truth makes him free; and he whom the Son, who is the Truth itself, makes free, is free indeed.

It is not indeed to be understood that the mental perception of truth, considered simply as an operation of the mind, can give this freedom. But when we speak of the perception of truth we include in that perception the love and the practice of truth, without which there can be no real perception. For how can the understanding perceive the truth which the will opposes and the life belies? We do not really see the truth of any part of Revelation or religion, but what we practically as well as intellectually acknowledge. It is only in proportion as we do the Lord's will that we know His doctrine to be true and Divine.

This is not left to be inferred or understood in the present instance: it is expressed. For the throne, while said to have been made of ivory, is described as a *great* throne, and as having been covered over with gold. And greatness implies goodness; for there are two things —magnitude and number—which denote goodness and truth. Gold also signifies goodness or love. The greatness of the throne indicates therefore the essential goodness of the Lord's kingdom and government; and gold, with which the throne was covered, indicates goodness in

which truth is grounded and in which it is manifested, goodness of heart and holiness of life.

The throne of the Lord, or His government and kingdom, as set up in the regenerate mind, is formed from truth, but that truth must be grounded and manifested in love and goodness. It must have goodness as its inward essence and goodness as its outward form. And indeed what is the Divine government if it do not include and comprehend the government of the heart and the actions? We are gifted with the capacity and the means of knowing and understanding the Lord's will, but it is only that we may love and do it.

This truth is still further taught and enforced in the present case: there is another predicate which directs us to goodness as entering into the perception and use of the truth which is accommodated to the apprehension of the reason. The top of the throne was *round* behind; and of forms, what is round or circular is predicated of goodness, and what is angular is predicated of truth. For this reason, as well as for another, the steps by which there was ascent to the throne signify truths. And as there is a connection and correlation between truth and goodness, this is expressed in the description, that "the throne had six steps, and the top of the throne was round behind." Although the terms which express the size and form of the throne both denote goodness, they do not denote goodness of the same kind and degree. The goodness denoted by magnitude is more especially the goodness of love, that denoted by form is more especially the goodness of truth. The truths by which goodness is attained is signified by the steps by which there was ascent to the throne. Steps denote truths, for it is by means of truths that the mind is elevated from a natural to a spiritual state of the will, or is raised from earth to heaven. Jacob's ladder, which reached from earth to heaven, was an emblem of the revealed Word, which connects heaven with the world and the Lord with man; and the steps of that ladder signified the truths of the Word, by which there is a descent of God through heaven to man, and an ascent of man through heaven to God. The steps which went up to the throne of Solomon were six; for six is a number which signifies truths: but this number implies at the same time states of labour and trial. These, as well as truths, are meant by the six days in which God is said to have created the world, and by the six days which man was appointed to labour, preparatory to the seventh day, in which he was commanded to rest, as God had rested from all His works which He had created and made. The six days in which the Lord Himself is said to labour are all the states of instruction and labour through which He conducts those who are being regenerated, the state of regeneration itself being meant by the seventh day of rest. Heaven is hence called rest, and life on earth, which is preparatory to endless life in heaven, is called labour;

for the state of the soul in heaven compared with its state on earth is as a state of rest compared with a state of labour—labour implying resistance to evil and temptation, and the doing of good from a sense of duty more than from a feeling of delight. The necessity of conquering evil, as a means of attaining to the state and kingdom of heaven, is plainly declared by the Lord, in His address to the Church of the Laodiceans : "To him that overcometh will I grant to sit with Me in My throne, even as I also overcame, and am set down with My Father in His throne." To sit with the Lord in His throne is to be in His kingdom, and to have dominion over all the lower thoughts and affections of the mind, through which there had been temptation. As this labour is spiritually meant by the six days of Creation, and is implied by the six steps of the throne of Solomon, the Lord in His address to the Laodicean Church calls Himself the beginning of the Creation of God, since from Him is all spiritual creation, which is regeneration, or the creation of a new heart and of a right spirit within us. The number six denotes states of trial and labour, as well as states of truth, because states of truth, compared with a state of good, are states of labour. Truth is given to lead us to goodness. It is given to discover to us our evils of heart and life; for we should not know sin but by the law : but it is also given us to lead us to resist and forsake evil, since the knowledge of evil, without the inducement and power to remove it, would be of no advantage, but would rather be a curse than a blessing. The power to resist evil resides in truth and comes to us by truth ; not that truth alone has this power, but the power is in it and by it. Power originates in goodness, but goodness has no power but by truth as an instrument. As all spiritual power comes to us by truth, and as, when grounded in goodness, truth is able to conquer all the evils of heart and life, therefore twelve lions stood upon the steps of Solomon's throne, as emblems of the complete and irresistible power of a true faith—that is, of faith grounded in love. For he who has faith, such faith as the Gospel requires, even as a grain of mustard seed, shall say to the sycamine-tree, or even to the mountain, "Be thou plucked up, and cast into the midst of the sea," and it shall obey him ; for true faith has power to remove false and evil principles, which the tree and the mountain signify, and send them to that kingdom whence they came.

CHAPTER XVI.

SOLOMON'S NAVY.

1 *Kings* ix. 26-28; x. 11, 22.

No single passages of the historical part of the Scriptures have been the subject of so much research or of such varied conjectures as those which relate to Solomon's navy and its achievements. After all that has been done and suggested to elucidate the sacred texts which relate to this subject, the land that afforded Solomon a supply of gold and silver, elephants' teeth, apes and peacocks, remains to this day a matter of uncertainty. Perhaps India is entitled to rank first in the scale of probability. It seems entitled to do so in regard to its productions. And if the fleet, which made a three years' voyage, mentioned in chapter x., is the same as that mentioned in the previous chapter, which sailed from Ezion-geber, on the shore of the Red Sea, the voyage does not present itself as a matter of serious, or at least of insuperable difficulty, even in those days of coasting navigation. If, however, this navy of Tarshish sailed from some port on the coast of the Mediterranean instead of the Red Sea, to reach India it must have sailed round the whole coast of Africa, a feat which is believed to have been accomplished two hundred years later, but which we can hardly suppose could be mentioned as more than a single, but not as a repeated occurrence, in the reign of Solomon. Tarshish, of which so frequent mention is made in the Old Testament, is understood to be the ancient Tartessus on the coast of Spain, one of the numerous colonies of Tyre; but a navy or a ship of Tarshish is not considered to mean one that sailed to that distant colony only, but to be a term applied generally to vessels of the largest class, and such as were therefore employed in the longest and most important voyages. A navy of Tarshish might thus sail from the Red Sea in a direction opposite to Tarshish itself; and we can hardly conceive that, if India was the destination of Solomon's navy, it could take any other course than through the straits of Bab el Mandeb into the Arabian Sea, and east along the coast of Hindustan.

Such investigations as these, though not entirely destitute of interest to the reader of the Scriptures, are not the highest that can engage his attention; and the solution of the questions that have been so largely discussed is not essentially necessary to the spiritual understanding of the passage.

The general object of the tenth chapter seems to be to show,

not only that Solomon was the wisest and richest of kings, but that all the earth came to hear his wisdom, and that the most distant parts of the world were made to enrich him with their treasures. The greatness of his power, the wealth of his kingdom, and the extent of his dominion, seem to be the great themes of the sacred historian. Not only were the king of Tyre and the queen of Sheba his admirers and allies, and contributed to his greatness and magnificence, but those who came from all the earth to hear his wisdom "brought every man his present, vessels of silver, and vessels of gold, and garments, and armour, and spices, horses, and mules, a rate year by year." The power, the riches, and the dominion of the King of spiritual Israel were symbolized by those of Solomon.

And this universal homage rendered to that eminent type of Jesus was but the shadow of that which shall yet be rendered to Him, to whom every knee shall bow and every tongue confess, of things on earth, as it already is of things in heaven; for He whom all the angels of God worship, and to whom they offer their most precious gifts of love and gratitude and devotion, shall yet be the one grand Object to whom all the earth shall come, to hear His wisdom, and to whom they will spontaneously render their continual service. In the true Church of the Lord, where His true character is known, such homage and offerings must be unreserved and constant.

The ships built by Solomon on the Red Sea formed the first and perhaps the only navy that ever existed in connection with the kingdom of Israel. Much less important in themselves, and much humbler in their immediate commercial objects, were the ships that so many ages afterwards were navigated upon the Sea of Galilee by the disciples of Jesus; but far more precious was their freight when they carried from place to place Him in whom dwelt all the riches of wisdom and knowledge, and all the blessings of redemption and salvation, and who came on earth to dispense them without limit or partiality to His creatures. In both cases, however, the ships had the same signification, and in both cases the use they performed teaches us a similar spiritual lesson. A ship in Scripture is the symbol of knowledge, and the analogy is to be discovered in its use. Knowledge is not wisdom, but knowledge is a vessel which contains wisdom and conveys it to the mind. A ship, by means of which the merchant visits different and distant lands, and exchanges the produce of his own country for that of others, and by which both are enriched, is the symbol of that knowledge which, though it does not constitute the true riches, is a medium by which they are acquired—a vessel, so to speak, that contains them, and carries them on to their proposed end, which is their application to the purposes of life. It is for this reason that those who by knowledge enter into the Divine Word, that they may contemplate the

wonders of redeeming love and acquire the wisdom of realizing its benefits, are represented as going down into the sea in ships, and doing business in great waters; of whom it is said, that they see the works of the Lord, and His wonders in the deep. For the same reason those in the mystical Babylon who had made traffic of sacred knowledge are represented as lamenting her fall. For "every shipmaster, and all the company in ships, and sailors, and as many as trade by sea, stood afar off, and cried, Alas, alas, for that great city, wherein were made rich all that had ships in the sea, by reason of her costliness! for in one hour is she made desolate."

The navy which Solomon built, and by which he had communication and commerce with the most distant lands, may be regarded as symbolizing that knowledge which under the Gospel is to convey to the most distant nations the blessings of religious light and virtue, and to extend the knowledge of the Lord, that is to cover the earth as the waters cover the sea. But besides this very general view which may be taken of its typical meaning, we are no doubt to understand the ships of Solomon, like those of the disciples, in which our Lord travelled, from which He taught, and from which He stilled the tempest, as representing the knowledges of His own Divine Word, in which He eminently is, by which He is brought near to us and we to Him, from which He instructs us in the great doctrines of life and immortality, and the true means of realizing them, and from which He restores tranquillity to the troubled soul.

The articles with which the ships of Solomon were freighted have, however, a specific spiritual signification. The gold and silver signify the goodness and truth of the inner man, the ivory, apes, and peacocks those of the outer man. Gold and silver are so frequently employed by the prophets as emblematical of the most precious spiritual graces, that every one must at once recognise their meaning. Of all the graces love is the purest and the most precious, and of this gold is the universal emblem. Because the reign of Solomon represented the reign of love—because his kingdom represented the kingdom of the Lord, in which love to Him is the ruling and cherished principle—therefore it was, in order to represent it, that Solomon made targets and shields of beaten gold, and that all his drinking vessels were of gold, and all the vessels of the house of the forest of Lebanon were of pure gold; and that silver, of which none of them were made, was nothing accounted of in the days of Solomon, who made it to be in Jerusalem as stones. And by this mode of expressing the abundance of gold, and the relative worthlessness of silver, we are instructed, that when love to the Lord reigns in the heart, good is the ground of defence, intelligence, and reason, and that spiritual truth, which is silver, takes the place of natural truth, which is stone. Of the three natural produc-

tions of the country to which the ships of Solomon went, ivory signifies rational truth, which is the highest truth of the natural mind or outer man. Solomon therefore made a great throne of ivory, which he overlaid with the best gold. The appropriateness of this will at once be apparent; for judgment is peculiarly the function of the rational faculty of the mind; it is this that weighs and compares evidence, that discriminates and separates between truth and error, and that forms from the whole a conclusion which constitutes a judgment. Yet judgment is not to be formed and pronounced from truth alone; for truth alone, though it may be not unjust, is yet severe, in its judgments. Judgment should be according to truth, but it should be tempered with mercy. The throne of judgment should indeed be of ivory, but it ought to be overlaid with gold. The rational faculty is, strictly considered, intermediate, occupying a place, and forming a medium between the inner and outer, or the spiritual and natural mind. The ivory, which is the symbol of rational truth, occupies here a middle place between the gold and silver, which signify the good and truth of the inner man, and the apes and peacocks, which signify the good and truth of the outer man. It is not of essential importance for us to know, nor shall we attempt to determine the disputed question, whether these are the very creatures which the original terms were intended to designate. It is sufficient for our purpose that one is a beast and the other a bird, which we know correspond to the principles of good and truth, or to the affections and thoughts. Their reference to the natural mind is determined not simply by the nature of the animals themselves, but by the place they occupy in the enumeration, and by the circumstance that animals specifically signify the natural affections and perceptions of the mind, because the natural mind of man is in its nature similar to that of animals.

The voyage which was undertaken for the purpose of bringing these rare and precious things from foreign countries to the land of Israel was performed once in three years. And as a trine is the symbol of state; and three is a figure which involves the idea of that trine, in which the circle of every state is completed and its purpose is fulfilled, this period is expressive of the completeness of the regenerated state, by which the highest and lowest, the most interior and the most exterior, principles of the mind are brought into connection and harmony.

But the navy of Solomon, in these expeditions, was accompanied by the navy of Hiram, as that mentioned in the previous chapter is said to have been accompanied by the servants of Hiram, shipmen that had knowledge of the sea. Israel was not a naval or commercial nation, but Phœnicia, the Britain of the ancient world, was eminently so. Tyre, "that crowning city whose merchants were princes," had

numerous trading colonies on either shore of the Mediterranean and beyond it, another commerce extended even to the British Isles. It was no doubt her commercial character that gave her the representative character that she has in the Scriptures. We have already spoken of Tyre and its king Hiram, when treating of the building of Solomon's temple, of which he supplied so much of the material. Tyre, we have seen, represented the knowledge of good and truth, of which a ship itself is the symbol. As everything is recorded in the Word for the sake of the spiritual sense, the shipmen and the fleet of Hiram accompanied those of Solomon to represent the fact that even the higher faculties of the mind are aided by the lower in carrying out their useful objects. There is also in the Church, as in the world, a variety of gifts ; and all its members are capable of being useful to each other ; and all work together for the general as well as for mutual good when, however diverse their gifts, they are all animated by the same spirit. Some are suited for study and some for action, some find their satisfaction in pursuing their religious object by the most practical means, others find their peculiar delight in the acquirement of knowledge. Of this last description are the Hirams and the Tyrians. Like the spirits of Mercury, they are pleased with knowledges alone, and see in every object and in every pursuit what ministers to the desire and the delight of knowing. They are in some respects and in some of their uses like the Gibeonites, the hewers of wood and drawers of water to the house of God. Or they are like those outsiders, those lecturers who deal in other people's wares, but who care little for them themselves, except so far as they can be made matters of profitable merchandise. They labour for others rather than for themselves, yet without intending to confer on others the benefits they are able to extract from their labours. This character, in its uses and its dangers, might be exemplified from the history of Solomon as given in the Scriptures ;—in its usefulness, as exemplified in the important services Hiram rendered to David and Solomon, in assisting them to procure the materials for building up the temple of the Lord ; and in its dangers, from the pride of Tyre, against which so many and awful denunciations are uttered by the prophets, and by the state of utter ruin to which her loftiness and corruption finally reduced her. We see, I apprehend, the character of that state which Tyre and Hiram represented in one incident recorded in the previous chapter. When Solomon had completed his great works, he gave to Hiram, for the valuable assistance he had rendered him during their progress, twenty cities in the land of Canaan. But when Hiram came to see them they pleased him not. "And he said, What cities are these which thou hast given me, my brother? And he called them the land of Cabul unto this day." These cities in Galilee of Canaan signified

doctrines of the Church, which are of a more internal character and of a more practical nature than the knowledges which are represented by ships of the sea. And the king of Tyre being displeased with these cities which were given him by Solomon, who, there is reason to think, would not be wanting in liberality to the friend and lover of himself and his father, only shows in the representative language of inspiration, that those who are delighted with knowledges alone, can see no beauty and feel no pleasure in those truths which come immediately from the Lord and lead immediately to Him. We speak of such a state as relative, not absolute—as one in which the external delight is so prominent and active as to render the internal delight comparatively, though not absolutely, unfelt. We do not therefore mean an outward delight in knowledge that nauseates and rejects every inward principle of religion. Hiram did not refuse the cities of Solomon, though they were not pleasing to him. The positive dislike and rejection of inward truth and good is the abuse of the love of knowing. In this case knowledge puffeth up; and such was the ultimate result with Tyre. Hence the judgments against her. "Say unto the prince of Tyrus, Thus saith the Lord God, Because thine heart is lifted up, and thou hast said, I am a god, in the midst of the seas; with thy wisdom and with thine understanding thou hast gotten thee riches, and hast gotten gold and silver into thy treasures: thou hast been in Eden the garden of God, every precious stone was thy covering; thou sealest up the sum, full of wisdom and perfect in beauty. Thine heart was lifted up because of thy beauty; thou hast corrupted thy wisdom by reason of thy brightness. Therefore thus saith the Lord, thou shalt die the death of the uncircumcised by the hand of strangers." It was because Tyre signifies the knowledge of goodness and truth, and these are meant by her riches, that it is said, her meretricious hire should become holiness to the Lord. For when knowledge, which the unfaithful have made a matter of traffic, is taken away from them, and is given to the faithful, it becomes a means of promoting the life of holiness, being devoted to the service of the Lord, like the jewels of gold and silver, and the garments, that were taken from the Egyptians, and were put upon the sons and daughters of Israel, some of the precious things being devoted to the adorning of the tabernacle itself.

We have spoken of the fleet that was built at, and that sailed from, Ezion-geber on the Red Sea by the land of Edom, as being possibly the same as that mentioned in this place. The place where the fleet was built and whence it sailed is mentioned on account of the spiritual sense. The Red Sea, so famous in the history of the Israelitish deliverance from Egypt, signifies science, or the simple knowledge of spiritual things, and which is specifically meant by Ezion-geber. It is from science that knowledge is derived, and from science that the mind sets

out in the search for spiritual good and truth, just as Israel set out from Egypt in their journey to Canaan. The religious journey commences with religious science. And when this science, or scientific knowledge of religion, is grounded in natural goodness—represented in the present instance by this port being on the land of Edom—the commencing state is such as to promise prosperity.

If the spiritual life be compared to a voyage, that achieved by the fleet of Solomon must be representative of an important circle in the progress of the soul, from which therefore we may learn how we may become rich in the wealth of heaven, by entering into the deep mines and far-off regions of wisdom that are now opened up to us in the spiritual sense of the Divine Word.

CHAPTER XVII.

SOLOMON'S ARMY.

1 *Kings* x.

DAVID was a man of war, and his soldiers formed an army of warriors; and we have in the annals of his reign a long list of his mighty men, some of whom performed prodigies of valour (2 Sam. xxiii.). But Solomon was a man of peace; and although, as we shall see, his reign was not altogether undisturbed by foreign aggression, his army seems to have been intended, and to have served, for the display of his regal magnificence more than for the defence of his kingdom. The "host," of which we read in the time of Solomon, was that which had existed in the time of David. Soon after his accession to the throne he put Benaiah, whom he sent to slay Joab at the altar, in his room over the host (1 Kings ii. 35, 44). The appointment of Benaiah to be over the host in the place of Joab, was in accordance with the higher representative character of the kingdom under Solomon. Joab was of the family of Jesse and nephew of David, and was thus near to the throne; but Benaiah was the son of Jehoiada the high priest, and was thus near to the altar; so that he represented truth derived from goodness of that holiest character which was represented by the priesthood. But besides the host which had come to him from his father David, "Solomon gathered together chariots and horsemen: and he had a thousand and four hundred chariots, and twelve thousand horsemen, whom he bestowed in the cities for chariots, and with the king at Jerusalem" (x. 26). The number of horses is not here mentioned, but many years before the time to which this relates, "Solomon had forty thousand stalls of horses for his chariots," the number of horsemen being then,

as at the later period, twelve thousand (iv. 4). Solomon, therefore, added to his host an army of horsemen with war-chariots, which do not appear to have formed any part of the host of Israel under either Saul or David. This no doubt indicates a great advance of the kingdom in wealth and civilization. But it indicates something more. It symbolizes a higher representative character of the kingdom under Solomon than it sustained under David. Horses and chariots represent understanding and doctrine, and horsemen, those who are intelligent, and guide the understanding. This meaning of the horse and his rider is well exemplified in the Book of Revelation. When the Lamb had prevailed to open the book that was sealed with seven seals, which none in heaven or on earth could open, or even look upon, there came out one after another four horses, each with a rider. These horses represented the understanding of the Holy Word in the successive ages of the Church, and the colour of the horse and the character of the horseman represented what the quality of the understanding of the Word in the several ages of the Church had been. The first horse, which was white, and whose rider had a bow, and who went forth conquering and to conquer, represented the understanding of the Word in the first age of the Church. His whiteness is emblematical of the intellectual purity and freeness from error which characterized the Church of the earliest times, when, in consequence, they were able to conquer, as the apostles and early Christians did, the opposition of the heathen world and everywhere win souls to Christ. The red horse, to whose rider it was given to take peace from the earth, and that they should kill one another, and to whom was given a great sword, describes the beginning of sorrows to the Church itself, when opinions became divided and contentions arose, and love, which is life, began to grow cold, and death as well as dispeace began to invade the sanctuary, where love gave peace and unity gave power. The black horse represents the understanding of the Word in the Church darkened, the light of truth having given place to the darkness of error, in consequence of which the principles of goodness and truth, that support the spiritual life of the soul, are lightly esteemed, a measure of wheat being offered for a penny and three measures of barley for a penny. The pale horse, which came last, expressively symbolizes the understanding of the Word in the Church at the time of its end, when the life of love as well as the light of truth is extinguished. His rider is death, and hell follows with him ; and power is given unto them over the fourth part of men, to kill with sword, and with hunger, and with death, and with the beasts of the earth.

The same subject is treated of by the same symbolism by the prophet Zechariah ; but the four chariots, with their red, black, white, and grisled

and bay, or rather strong, horses, that came out from between two mountains of brass (vi.), represent the doctrine and understanding of the Word, not in a falling but in a rising Church; for here the rebuilding of Jerusalem and the temple, or the restoration of the Church, is spoken of. They are the four spirits of the heavens, which go forth from standing before the Lord of all the earth. The black horses are here followed by the white, and go forth into the north country, and the grisled go forth toward the south, while the strong horses walk to and fro through the earth. The whole prophecy evidently relates to the coming of the Lord, the man whose name is the BRANCH; and the going forth of these chariots and horses figuratively describe the diffusion of the Gospel with its light and power.

But the spiritual meaning of the horse and his rider is perhaps still more obviously brought out in the Revelation (xix.), where John "saw heaven opened, and beheld a white horse; and He that sat upon him was called Faithful and True, and in righteousness He doth judge and make war. His eyes were as a flame of fire, and on His head were many crowns; and He had a name written, that no man knew but He Himself: and He was clothed with a vesture dipped in blood: and His name is called The Word of God." The white horse, the understanding of the Word as it had been in the primitive Christian Church, is here again restored; for the restoration of the Church is treated of by the descent of the New Jerusalem; but it is restored in more than its former power and glory, for He who sits on this white horse is the very Word of God, who has gone forth to judge between right and wrong, and to make war against ignorance, error, and evil. From this state of intellectual purity in the last Church there is no predicted departure. The vesture of Him who sits upon the white horse—the outer garment of the letter of the Word—is, indeed, crimsoned with the blood of its martyred truths; but the white horse of the Word is followed by no others bearing the marks of degeneracy. On the contrary, He who sits upon the white horse is followed by the armies of heaven, riding also upon white horses, and are clothed in fine linen white and clean.

Admitting the spirituality of the Scriptures and the representative character of Solomon, it is almost obvious from the Scriptures themselves what the meaning of the king's numerous horses and chariots with their horsemen must be. If natural war against the enemies of Israel is typical of spiritual war against the enemies of the Church, then, as the weapons of the Church are not carnal but spiritual, the chariots and horses must be intellectual and not physical; and in relation to the Lord, as Solomon's antitype, must mean what the prophet, addressing the Divine Being, calls His horses and His chariots of salvation, upon which He rode, when He went forth for the salvation of His people, even for the salvation of His anointed (Hab. iii. 8, 13).

Solomon's forty thousand stalls for horses, his fourteen hundred chariots, and his twelve thousand horsemen, are expressive not only of the abundance but of the quality of the spiritual instruments and agents which they represent. Whatever is numbered by thousands is expressive of qualities or things that are grounded in goodness, the number of thousands expressing other elements that enter into and modify them. Forty generally indicates something of temptation and its combats, fourteen, like seven, of what is holy, and twelve of what is true, or the truths of faith in plenitude and power.

There are two particulars connected with Solomon's army of horsemen that might seem to deprive it of any merit or of any good significance. Moses, speaking to the people of the time when they would desire a king, laid it down as a rule for his observance, that he should not multiply horses to himself, neither should he cause the people to return to Egypt to the end that he should multiply horses (Deut. xvii. 16). Yet this wisest of their kings multiplied horses, and if he did not send his own people to Egypt to procure them, he had them brought from thence; for "Solomon had horses brought out of Egypt. . . And a chariot came up and went out of Egypt for six hundred shekels of silver, and an horse for an hundred and fifty." That which is wrong in the letter cannot represent that which is absolutely right in the spirit, but it can represent that which is relatively right. There are things which are the result of evil that are not themselves evil. Reasoning comes of evil, and yet in itself it is not evil. Our Lord says, "Let your communication be, Yea, yea; Nay, nay: for whatsoever is more than these cometh of evil." If men had never fallen from their original state, they would have perceived the truth, and seen the difference between what was true and not true without reasoning. But now that the power of perception is lost, men require to reason in order to discover whether a thing be so or not. Reason is indirect and imperfect perception. It cometh of evil, but it is the means of overcoming the evil from which it comes. The law itself cometh of evil. The law of love was originally inscribed upon the mind. Its being written on tables of stone was a necessity produced by its having been effaced from the table of the heart; and yet "the law is holy, and the commandment holy, and just, and good" (Rom. vii. 12). The injunction that the king was not to multiply horses to himself, nor cause the people to return to Egypt to the end that he should multiply horses, was grounded in a law of order and necessity. Egypt represented science; and the horses of Egypt represented the understanding reasoning from science respecting religion, or seeking to enter through natural science into spiritual truth, which is as impossible as for a camel to go through the eye of a needle. But although one cannot enter through natural science into spiritual

truth, it is possible to confirm and illustrate spiritual truth by natural science, when a spiritual state has once been attained. This state was represented by the reign and kingdom of Solomon; therefore it was allowable for him to multiply horses, and to go down to Egypt for horses and for chariots. When the mind is established in the truth of religion, the understanding and the doctrines of science may be made the means of defending as well as of confirming the truth.

So far as the history of Solomon's reign affords the means of judging, his army was never engaged in offensive warfare, but, if employed at all, as there is reason to believe it was, against the enemies of Israel, it was only for the purpose of defence. It is indeed remarkable that there is nothing said of Solomon making any but defensive implements of war. "King Solomon made two hundred targets of beaten gold: and he made three hundred shields of beaten gold;" but we do not read of his making either swords or spears. The higher state of spiritual warfare is purely defensive. So long as the Christian is progressing from truth to goodness, he attacks as well as defends. The true principle of spiritual warfare is defence; and this is the true principle of natural warfare also. But the principle of self-defence sometimes requires offensive operations. True principle, either spiritual or natural, never seeks occasion of war, or enters on a war of aggression. But in the war of the religious life the spiritual and the celestial man, or the man of faith and the man of love, act differently. The warfare of the celestial man is more purely defensive in its character than that of the spiritual man. Love employs the shield more than the sword, faith employs the sword more than the shield. The man of true faith uses the sword of truth, indeed, under the influence of love. The Israelitish warriors anointed their swords and shields with oil, to represent that even the spiritual man must have his sword of truth anointed with the oil of love. But the celestial man fights, so far as his defensive warfare can be called a combat, from love itself. Solomon's targets and shields were made of beaten gold, the emblem of love. The Lord, even when He fought with the whole infernal host, never entered into conflict with the enemies of Himself and His people, except when He was assailed by them. Nor does He in the minds of the faithful. Whatever in their conflicts is more than this is from their own self-hood. The promise to the faithful is, "His truth shall be thy shield and buckler" (Ps. xci. 4). But His truth is the form, His love is the substance. It is the shield and the buckler of beaten gold.

The Christian life is a warfare as well as a pilgrimage; and in passing through it we have to fight under the banner of Saul and David as well as of Solomon. In all our conflicts the Lord is our Leader, and He has trod the thorny path and fought the good fight before us. But He appears to every one according to his state. The same in

Himself and in all His operations, He appears to all men according to the nature and measure of their reception of His love and truth. Those who receive more of His truth than of His love see Him as a Man of war; and those who receive more of His love than of His truth, see Him as a Man of peace. Those who fight from truth, apparent and real, are led by Him as Saul or David; those who resist from love are led by Him as Solomon. He leads all who are earnestly pursuing their way to His kingdom of love and wisdom, of righteousness and peace; but He desires to lead them through their necessary conflicts with self, the world, and the flesh, in the spirit and in the state in which He can protect them from evil and enrich them with good, and enable them to sit every man under his vine and under his fig-tree, and none shall make them afraid.

CHAPTER XVIII.

SOLOMON'S IDOLATRY.

1 *Kings* xi. 29-32.

THE tendency of the Israelitish people to idolatry is painfully manifest throughout their whole history, from the time that Aaron made the golden calf to that in which Manasseh the king set up a graven image in the temple of the Lord itself (2 Kings xxi. 5). To regard this subject from a negative view we might suppose this to be an evidence of the inefficacy of the religion that was established among them. But religion is not always to be judged of by the conduct of its professors, although their conduct may always be justly judged by the religion they profess. The conduct of the Jews in this respect only shows how deeply rooted in the human mind was the idolatry which so extensively prevailed at that period amongst the nations of the earth. So deeply rooted was the worship of the dumb idol, that the knowledge of the living God, who created the earth and the heavens, was insufficient to preserve the chosen people from an infatuation which might be supposed only possible in a state of gross ignorance or error.

Not the least remarkable of the numerous instances of idolatry among the Israelites was that of Solomon. Solomon, who had desired and had received in an eminent degree the gift of wisdom, who had built and dedicated the temple, where Jehovah might dwell among His people, where and towards which every true Israelite might pray in the fulness of his heart or in the bitterness of his spirit,—for him to fall away from the worship of the true God, and build "an high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab, in the hill that is before Jerusalem,

and for Molech, the abomination of the children of Ammon," is almost unaccountable, and can only be explained on the principle that there are evils in the human will that are ever inclining the mind to congenial errors. In Solomon's case special reasons are, it is true, assigned for his departure from the worship of that God whose name he had so greatly exalted. He had married many strange wives, women of the corrupt nations around him; and when he was old, his wives turned away his heart after other gods. But neither the waning powers of old age nor the influence of strange wives could have led to this lamentable apostasy, had there not been a lingering attachment to idol-worship in the mind of the king, as the seed of an idolatrous generation. The very fact of his taking these daughters of idolatrous kings showed his leaning to their religious worship, or, at the least, his too loose attachment to that which the law of Moses commanded. He who can cleave to a woman in love without any regard to her religion can have very little respect for his own; and it can be no great marvel if one should supplant, or each should neutralize, the other.

While it is useful to draw from the historical circumstances of the Old Testament the moral they teach, there are other lessons which they were designed to convey. All these circumstances are representative of divine and spiritual truths. In their highest sense they relate to the Lord, as the Saviour of the world, in their subordinate sense they relate to the regeneration of man. Yet it may appear somewhat extraordinary, and even inconsistent, that circumstances which bespeak the corruption of the human heart or the fatuity of the human understanding, should be employed as representative of works or of events in which we may trace the hand of our all-merciful and all-perfect Redeemer. But in this respect the literal is often different and sometimes opposite to the spiritual sense. Nor is this to be wondered at in historical relations, considering that the corrupt state of human nature might fail to supply the means of providing a homogeneous basis for the spiritual sense, when we find in the descriptive and declarative language of the Scriptures numerous instances of the same apparent anomaly. When He who is mercy itself is spoken of as being angry and furious; when He who is good itself is said to do evil; when He who is light itself is declared to create darkness; when He who is unchangeable is said to repent; we have, in apparently spontaneous expressions, the very opposite of the reality presented to our minds. If, then, the Divine character and works can be described in language that bespeaks human frailty, may they not be represented by human acts in which human frailty is actually manifested in frail human nature? If God is described as an imperfect being, He may fitly be represented by beings who were really imperfect. Solomon, even the present phase, and in all the other phases, of his character,

some of which have been formerly noticed, is representative of that of our Lord and Saviour Jesus Christ. The general truth represented in Solomon's having so many wives of so many different nations and religions, and yielding in his old age to their superstitious worship, is that which teaches the universality of human redemption and the possibility of universal salvation. The same truth is presented in the visions of John in the Revelation. After the sealing of the twelve tribes of the children of Israel, besides the one hundred and forty-four thousand out of all the tribes, John beheld a great multitude, which no man could number, of all nations, and kindreds, and people, and tongues, standing before the throne, and before the Lamb, clothed with white robes, and palms in their hands, who cried with a loud voice, saying, "Salvation to our God which sitteth upon the throne, and unto the Lamb." The same theme was sung by the four beasts and the four and twenty elders, when it was found that the Lamb had prevailed to open the book; for they sang a new song, saying, "Thou art worthy to take the book, and to open the seals thereof: for Thou wast slain, and hast redeemed us to God by Thy blood out of every kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation." The universality of human redemption, and the possibility of salvation to all men, of whatever kindred, and tongue, and people, and nation, is one of the great and consolatory truths represented in the Old Testament and clearly revealed in the New. There is nothing to surprise us in the narrow spirit of Jewish sectarianism and national exclusiveness, which led them to believe that the Divine favour was limited to themselves, and that even few of their own number would be saved. But that among the disciples of Christ, who displayed as well as revealed the Divine character in its purity, there should be found those who maintain that the whole heathen world is excluded from any share in the Lord's work of salvation, except so far as in this life they receive the joyous message, is both astonishing and humiliating. It would almost seem as if that manifestation of the boundless love of God rendered salvation more difficult and more circumscribed than before. Certain expressions have been construed into statements to that effect. Of these the celebrated declaration of Peter is most commonly appealed to: "There is none other name under heaven given among men whereby we must be saved, but that of Jesus Christ of Nazareth." This is indeed a great truth, but it is as hopeful for those beyond, as for those within, the pale of the Christian Church. The apostle had performed a miracle by the name of Jesus Christ. But it was not simply by the name, but by the power of Him whose name he used, that Peter made the lame to walk. And the simple question is, whether the same power may or may not be savingly exerted where the mere name of Christ is unknown. The name of Christ had miraculous power in those days, because in

the Sacred Scriptures there is symbolism in names, the name of Christ being the verbal sign of the power and virtue that dwell in Him. Yet even in those days no spiritual miracle could be performed by simply uttering the name of Christ. The diseased body might be healed miraculously by uttering in faith the name of Jesus Christ, but the soul could only be restored by the spiritual reception of that which the name expressed. But it may be asked, Can the saving power of the Redeemer, and the saving virtue of His Divine work in the flesh, be efficaciously exerted where His name and His work are unknown? The name of Christ comprehends in itself all that Jehovah has become, and all that He has done, for mankind by the Incarnation. And it is the glory and the blessing of God's manifestation in the flesh, that it has brought Him near to all who are in the flesh, of whatever kindred and nation they may be, and even whatever earth they may inhabit. When the Word was made flesh and dwelt among us, it was in order to provide that the Word might be with us alway, and that it might work more effectually by all the means which a wise Providence had dispensed or permitted to the various nations of the earth. In every nation he that fears God and works righteousness is accepted of Him; and wherever God is feared and righteousness is performed, under whatever name God may be known, however imperfectly men's views of righteousness may be, *there* is the religious principle into which the spirit of Christ and of Christianity may be infused even in this life, and through which they may be consciously developed in the other.

While these considerations enable us to hope for the increase of the number saved of the universal human race, and to know of a certainty that the sincere of all religions will find a place in heaven, they do not induce indifference to the conversion of the heathen, or the spread of Christianity. The same Divine work which has brought salvation nearer to the heathen will bring the heathen nearer to the more perfect means of salvation which are to be found in the Christian religion. That missionary and evangelizing spirit which has been so powerfully awakened among Christians in these last days, and which has sought and still seeks to effect the conversion of the heathen at home and abroad by the universal diffusion of the Scriptures, as well as by the instrumentality of human teachers, is but an effect and an outward co-operative means of the inward light now shining with increased brightness in all human minds, and struggling to break down the prison walls of error and superstition by which they are confined. Still, while this work of improvement is going on, we are justified in believing that the Lord is the God and Saviour of all men. We may demand in the strain of the apostle, "Is He the God of the Christians only? Nay, but of the Gentiles also." And He who desires the salvation of all, will not leave any to perish, whose state admits of introduction into the kingdom of heaven.

Such is the general view we are enabled to corroborate from the circumstances of the history before us, by the aid of the spiritual sense.

This general view contains many particulars, some of which are representatively taught in the particulars of Solomon's history, as relating to the cause and nature of the king's idolatry. "Solomon loved many strange women, (together with the daughter of Pharaoh,) women of the Moabites, Ammonites, Edomites, Zidonians, and Hittites; of the nations concerning which the Lord said unto the children of Israel, Ye shall not go in to them, neither shall they come in unto you: for surely they will turn away your heart after their gods. Solomon clave unto these in love." Of the six nations of which Solomon took his many strange women, three were descended, by a direct and a collateral line, from Eber, the ancestor of the Hebrew and Israelitish nations. Moab and Ammon were the children of Lot, the brother of Abraham, and Edom was son of Isaac, and the brother of Jacob. We have to go much farther back in the historical Scriptures for the ancestor of the Egyptians, Zidonians, and Hittites. The Scriptures speak of them as descended from Ham, the second son of Noah. In Genesis we read that the sons of Ham were Cush, and Mizraim, and Phut, and Canaan, and that Canaan begat Sidon his first-born, and Heth (x. 6, 15). Mizraim is the name of Egypt, Heth of the Hittites, Sidon of the Zidonians. We are indeed told that history, in the strict sense, does not begin in the Bible till the time of Eber; and Eber himself is not perhaps a strictly historical person. If, in the Biblical narrative, history begins with Eber, it is not unreasonable to suppose that he represents a transition state, and that in his history, with that of some of his immediate descendants, the mythical is blended with the actual. The age which he reached is rather allegorical than literal: "Eber lived four and thirty years, and begat Peleg. And Eber lived, after he begat Peleg, four hundred and thirty years, and begat sons and daughters." Our object in tracing the different nations, from which Solomon chose his wives and concubines, to their Scriptural origin, does not require that the Scripture account of their origin should be strictly literal history. The Word of God was not written by inspiration to inform us of the events of remote ages, or enable us to know who were the fathers of the families and nations of antiquity, but to supply us with the means of religious improvement. Sacred history is but the framework of a higher meaning and the vehicle of a higher instruction. And whether that framework be constructed in the form or of the facts of history, the dry bones of the literal record are equally, by Divine wisdom, brought together and united, and covered with flesh and skin, and animated with breath, and live, and form together an exceeding great army, by which the Lord of hosts wars against the evils of the world and of the human heart.

Our object in tracing the nations, to which Solomon's strange women belonged, to their Scripture origin is to point out the significance of the fact, even when the Israelitish king is regarded as a type of the Lord Jesus Christ. In Scripture these nations may be traced back to a Noetic, a Hebrew, and an Israelitish origin. Now Noah and his descendants to the time of Eber signify the Ancient Church, Eber and his descendants to the time of Abraham represent the Hebrew Church, and Abraham and his descendants to the time of our Lord constitute the Israelitish Church, or that representative dispensation which took its name from Israel. The Ancient Church was a spiritual Church, as distinguished from the Most Ancient Church, which was celestial. The cardinal grace of the celestial Church is love to the Lord, that of the spiritual Church is love to the neighbour, while that of the representative Church is simple obedience. To express it more abstractly, the celestial principle is love, the spiritual principle is charity, and the natural principle is work.

Now the Lord came into the world to save the spiritual. And all are included under this name and were of this character who lived after the end of the Most Ancient Church. For in speaking of the spiritual, we do not here mean the spiritual as distinguished from the natural, but the spiritual as distinguished from the celestial, both in regard to men and dispensations. When we come to treat of the revolt of the ten tribes under Rehoboam, Solomon's son and successor, which resulted in the permanent separation of the twelve tribes into the two kingdoms of Judah and Israel, the ground and representative meaning of this separation will be more fully explained. In this place it is only necessary to consider it so far as to see what is spiritually meant by the many strange women whom Solomon loved being taken from the particular nations mentioned in the sacred history.

The spiritual whom the Lord came into the world to save were those who lived under the dispensation which commenced with Noah, or with those who are treated of under that name. For the relation regarding the Flood, and the ark, and the one family who were saved from the wreck of the primeval world, is not to be understood as strictly literal, but as descriptive, in the language of correspondence, of spiritual states of the Church and of mankind, spiritual states being thus described by natural images, every one of which has a spiritual meaning. The Flood, which covered the whole earth, rising above the tops of the highest mountains, is the symbolical expression for a flood of false persuasions that overspread the whole Church, which the earth signifies, submerging the very highest principles of the Church, which are love to God and love to man, these being, in the language of analogy, all the high hills that were under the whole heaven. The destruction of the whole human race and of the whole

animal creation, with the exception of those preserved in the ark, is descriptive of the extinction of all spiritual and natural goodness, excepting the remnant which God, of His merciful providence, saves out of the wreck of every expiring dispensation, as the means of commencing a new one.

The Ancient Church, which commenced after the Flood, survived till the coming of the Lord. There were, indeed, besides the Noetic Church, the Hebrew and the Israelitish, but these were only prolongations of the Ancient Church. In the Writings the Hebrew Church is called the Second Ancient Church, and the Israelitish is frequently spoken of as not a Church, nor even a representative Church, but the representative of a Church. The Noetic was a spiritual Church, the Hebrew was a representative Church, and the Israelitish was the representative of a Church. These were but the successively descending degrees of the one Church which existed from the Flood to the Incarnation; and whatever vitality they possessed, they inherited from the original dispensation from which they sprung. All these, therefore, were included, in the comprehensive sense, under the name of the spiritual Church, those who belonged to them being included under the name of the spiritual whom the Lord assumed humanity to save.

The numerous wives and concubines of Solomon were taken from nations descended from all the different branches of those who constituted the Ancient Church, in order to represent that they were included under the name of the spiritual whom the Lord came to save. Those nations were indeed descendants who had corrupted themselves, and had turned from the worship of the true God, to serve false gods and worship dumb idols, and who were the enemies both of Jehovah and of His people. But the Lord declares that He came to seek and to save that which was lost; and the Apostle of the Gentiles testifies that "God commendeth His love toward us, in that, while we were yet sinners, Christ died for us." In considering the subject of Solomon's love of many strange women in relation to the Gentile nations under the Christian dispensation, we learn from it how their salvation can be effected. The nations who know not the Scriptures cannot be led to the Lord by the truth which directly reveals Him. But they can be drawn to Him by the good which they have acquired by means of the religious knowledge which exists among them. Thus they cannot be led by the understanding and its thoughts, but they can be drawn by the will and its affections. The affections of the will are represented by women, as the thoughts of the understanding are by men; for the sexes are mentally distinguished, men by greater power of thought, women by greater strength of affection. In Scripture, where the simplest things contain a deep philosophy, this ground of the distinction of the sexes is ever to

be understood as underlying all that is recorded of the men and women of Bible history, whether of the Old or of the New Testament. How well is it exemplified by the male and the female disciples of our Lord. Mary of Bethany and Mary of Magdala, how clearly and greatly are they distinguished from Peter and Thomas, and even from John, by the strength and tenderness of their affection. It is from this characteristic of the female mind that the Church is so constantly represented by a woman, and is called the bride and wife of the Lord. The objects of Solomon's love are the Churches among the Nations. Nor need we be startled at the idea of the Church having an existence among the Gentiles. Wherever there is sincere religion, there is the Church. Although all religions may not be spiritual, all religion is spiritual. The religious principle is spiritual everywhere, even although the religious system may be strictly spiritual nowhere. Wherever there is religious goodness, there is the Church. Wherever there is a mind in which the affection of goodness exists, that mind is already in consort with Him "who is the Saviour of all men," though "specially of them that believe" (1 Tim. iv. 10). The specialty which attaches to believers arises from the peculiarity of their case, and the advantage they enjoy in possessing the Scriptures, which contain the truth that forms the foundation of a true faith. There are two elements by which conjunction with God is effected—goodness and truth, or love and faith. There is no conjunction between God and man without reciprocation and co-operation. God is the Giver of all good gifts and the Operator of all good works; man is the recipient of God's gifts and the co-operator in all good works. God operates by goodness and love; man co-operates by truth and faith. The Lord draws men to Himself by love; men come to the Lord by faith. The Lord taught this in the Divine language of correspondence when He said, "No man can come to Me, expect the Father, which hath sent Me, draw him" (John vi. 44); and when He made the converse statement, "No man cometh unto the Father, but by Me" (John xiv. 6). The Father is the Divine love, the Son is the Divine truth. It is love that draws us to the truth; it is the truth that brings us to love. The Lord by love draws to Himself all men who receive His love, but only those who know and believe His truth come consciously and actually to Him. This believers do, because they have the truth which enables them to know the Object of Christian faith and the duties of the Christian life. They not only are drawn by the all-pervading love of God, but they are led by the partially diffused truth of God, partially diffused for wise purposes. For if salvation depended absolutely on the knowledge of the truth as it is in Jesus, God is sufficiently provident and powerful to have caused His truth to be carried to all the nations of the earth. But as goodness or love is the first essential of religion, and therefore the primary saving grace;

and as this can exist, though in different degrees of purity, under every form of religion; the goodness and wisdom of God are equally manifested in giving and in withholding the truth, according to the different states and conditions of the nations and peoples of the earth. He who is the Maker and Saviour of them all best knows how to deal with them, so as to secure the greatest possible measure of good to each and to all. His tender mercies are over all His works, and no soul is left without the means of salvation. However limited and imperfect the outward means may be, the invisible Divine influence and operation are always present; and if these invisible powers do not draw the well-disposed heathen to the truth in this world, it will assuredly draw them to it in the next. All sincere religious love has a desire for truth; and in the other life, if not in this, that desire, in whatever heart it exists, will be satisfied.

The strange women to whom Solomon clave in love will thus be drawn to the truth. Indeed Solomon is the Truth to which they are drawn, as well as the love which draws them. The Word made flesh is the eternal Truth which, in the Humanity glorified, can enter into all human minds and into all human religions with a power which the unclothed Divinity could not exert, because not accommodated to their infirmities and imperfections. Jehovah in Jesus, God in Christ, has come near to all men, and can enter into their different forms of faith and worship with an elevating and transforming power much greater than before the Incarnation. This is the remote sense of Solomon not only cleaving in love to many strange women, but going after their gods, and giving countenance and support to their worship. "For Solomon went after Ashtoreth the goddess of the Zidonians, and after Milcom the abomination of the Ammonites. . . . Solomon built an high place for Chemosh, the abomination of Moab, in the hill that is before Jerusalem, and for Molech, the abomination of the children of Ammon. Likewise did he for all his strange wives, which burnt incense, and sacrificed unto their gods." Ashtoreth is understood to be the moon and Chemosh the sun, and Milcom is but another name for Molech. These would seem to be singularized as the worst of the heathen deities. The worship of the sun and the moon is among the worst kinds of idolatry. They lead the mind away from the personality of God, which is recognised, however grossly, in idols having the human shape; and they represent the worship of self-love and the love of the world. And of all idols that had the human form, Molech, "horrid king, besmeared with blood of human sacrifice, and parents' tears," was the most abominable. Yet even under these and such of these salvation is possible. Living as we are in the light of Christianity, it is difficult to conceive how anything of true religious feeling can coexist with such a form of religious worship, or how the Spirit of the true and

loving God can be infused into the hearts of those who perform such sanguinary rites. Yet we read of the true and living God tempting the father of the faithful to offer up his son as a sacrifice to the Object of his worship. And we are told that if Abraham had not been inclined to such worship, he could not have been so much as tempted to offer a human victim in the person of his only son. Abraham, it is true, received a command, which he believed expressed the will of God. And this is just the saving element in all such unnatural acts of devotion. The devotees believe that God requires and approves the sacrifice, and they do violence to their own feelings because they think the act is acceptable to the god they worship.

The saving element in the religion of heathen nations and the worship of idols and false gods, is further expressed by the number of Solomon's wives and concubines. He had seven hundred wives and three hundred concubines. Wherever the number seven is mentioned in the Word it is expressive of what is holy. The seven hundred wives are the religious affections in which there is something of true holiness. A holy feeling may exist in the mind in connection with erroneous views of religion, and may enter into a degraded form of worship. But there are two kinds of worshippers, those who worship from the heart and those who worship from the mind, or those who worship from love and those who worship from faith. There is this distinction among those beyond, as well as among those within, the pale of the Church. The distinction is exemplified on a large scale by the sexes. With women religion is more of the heart, with men religion is more of the mind. There can be no real religion where the heart does not share with the mind in devotion to it. But in one class the religion of the heart is primary and in another it is secondary. With one, religion reaches the heart through the mind; with the other, religion reaches the mind through the heart. Those with whom the religion of the heart is primary are the wives of Scripture, and those with whom the religion of the mind is primary are the concubines of Scripture. Both are of those who are saved, but their conjunction with the Lord is more and less intimate. They are relatively the celestial and the spiritual, not only as they are distinguished into the two heavenly kingdoms consisting of the celestial and the spiritual heavens, but as they exist in each heaven, the lowest as well as the highest; for in each of the heavenly mansions there is the same distinction that exists in the whole. The Divine in the least and in the greatest things is the same, in the Grand Man and in the individual man, and in all the parts of which either of them consists. The distinction is an image of one that exists in the nature of God Himself; and, as it is found in His universal kingdom, is an arrangement as beneficent as it is wise. But on this subject, under another aspect, more will be said in the concluding chapter.

CHAPTER XIX.

SOLOMON'S ADVERSARIES.

1 *Kings* xi. 14-27.

ALTHOUGH Solomon's was a peaceful reign, it was not entirely free from disturbance. There were no great foreign wars, no civil conflicts, no domestic rebellions, no family feuds, as in the time of David. But there were enemies that were active though not seriously harmful, and there was a smouldering fire that was ready to burst forth when the pressure which kept it under restraint should be removed. Immediately after the record of Solomon being seduced by his heathen wives to the worship of their false gods, and of the Lord being angry with him and threatening to rend the kingdom from him, we read that "the Lord stirred up an adversary unto Solomon, Hadad the Edomite: he was of the king's seed in Edom. . . . And God stirred him up another adversary, Rezon the son of Eliadah, which fled from his lord Hadadezer king of Zobah. . . . And Jeroboam the son of Nebat, an Ephrathite of Zereda, Solomon's servant, (whose mother's name was Zeruah, a widow woman,) even he lifted up his hand against the king." We are not to suppose that all these adversaries were first "stirred up" after Solomon's apostasy. Rezon, we are told, "was an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon, beside the mischief that Hadad did: and he abhorred Israel, and reigned over Syria." But every evil that comes forth into act first exists as an inclination; and that to which Solomon yielded in his old age must have had a potential existence in his mind in his earlier life. Old age is the time when the natural impulses of early life return; and if, during the period of vigorous manhood, they have only been suppressed by the force of reason or the claims of interest, but not regenerated by the principles of religion, they are altogether likely to come forth into outward manifestation aggravated by evils peculiar to the declining vigour of the mental and physical powers. The presence of evils, either as inclinations or as acts, serve to stir up adversaries to restrain them, and give the opportunity of resisting and removing them; but if they are not removed, the adversaries become instruments of correction. When the children of Israel were commanded to drive out the inhabitants of the land of Canaan, they were warned of the consequences of failing to perform this duty: "If ye will not drive out the inhabitants of the land from before you; then it shall come to pass, that those which ye let remain of them shall be pricks in

your eyes, and thorns in your sides, and shall vex you in the land wherein ye dwell" (Num. xxxiii. 55). In the historical parts of the Word, especially in the Book of Judges, and in the Books of Kings, we read that when the people sinned, the Lord raised up adversaries to punish them; and when they learned wisdom from adversity, and cried unto the Lord, He then raised up judges to deliver them. No deliverance is recorded as having been effected in the present instance. On the contrary, one consequence of the king's sin is announced to him, and took effect in the reign of his successor. "He said unto Solomon, Forasmuch as this is done of thee, and thou hast not kept My covenant, and My statutes, which I have commanded thee, I will surely rend the kingdom from thee, and will give it to thy servant. Notwithstanding in thy days I will not do it for David thy father's sake: but I will rend it out of the hand of thy son. Howbeit I will not rend away all the kingdom; but will give one tribe to thy son for David My servant's sake, and for Jerusalem's sake, which I have chosen."

The adversaries which the Lord stirred up against Solomon, like those He stirred up against Israel in the time of the judges, had a special relation to the evil of which he had been guilty. In a good sense Edom signifies the Lord's human essence, also the strength, power, or good of the natural mind; in the opposite sense, Edom signifies the natural man originating in self-love, which despises and rejects all truth. Syria, in a good sense, signifies those who possess the knowledges of goodness and truth, and are called wise; but in the opposite sense, those who pervert those knowledges, and apply them to idolatrous purposes. Edom and Syria have therefore reference to the will and the understanding; and considered as two kingdoms, whose kings were opposed to Israel, and in particular to Solomon, they represent the will and understanding of the natural mind, as opposed to the spiritual.

An account is given of the two adversaries of Solomon. Hadad was of the seed royal of Edom; and one of those singular circumstances we have already had occasion to notice is recorded of him: "When David was in Edom, and Joab the captain of the host was gone up to bury the slain, after he had smitten every male in Edom, Hadad fled, he and certain Edomites of his father's servants with him, to go into Egypt; Hadad being yet a little child." When all were supposed to be slain a remnant escaped; and this solitary child, which was saved from David's slaughter, became an adversary to Israel all the days of Solomon. No wonder that he should. But the spiritual lesson it teaches may be considered apart from the natural considerations that arise out of the literal history; and this is, that even when an evil is rooted out, if a seed remains, the evil may spring forth again in all its former vigour, and even grow to its former extent.

When Hadad went to Egypt, Pharaoh "gave him an house, and

appointed him victuals, and gave him land. And Hadad found great favour in the sight of Pharaoh, so that he gave him to wife the sister of his own wife, the sister of Tahpenes the queen." This marriage of Hadad to the sister of the Egyptian queen is something of an opposite to the marriage of Solomon to the daughter of the Egyptian king; so that Hadad may be considered the thorn in Solomon's side on account of that unsanctioned union. Here was the natural will opposed to the spiritual, and each united to the affection of science, which can favour and support the claims of either, for in spiritual questions and conflicts science can take either side. "When Hadad heard in Egypt that David slept with his fathers, and that Joab the captain of the host was dead, Hadad said to Pharaoh, Let me depart, that I may go to mine own country. Then Pharaoh said unto him, But what hast thou lacked with me, that, behold, thou seekest to go to thine own country? And he answered, Nothing: howbeit let me go in any wise." Hadad did not inform Pharaoh of his object in returning to his own country; probably it was to attempt to regain his father's throne. David had laid his country under tribute and put garrisons in it; and he may have hoped to be able to shake off the Israelitish yoke now that the mighty king and his famous general were dead. It would appear he failed in this object. Indeed it is said he reigned over Syria; for this statement, in verse 25, relates to him. He managed, however, to do mischief to Solomon.

Solomon's other adversary, Rezon, had been connected with another of the kings whom David conquered. The account of both the events which gave rise to the enmity of Hadad and Rezon is contained in the same chapter (2 Sam. viii.). Rezon was not, like Hadad, of the seed royal. He was a servant of Hadadezer, king of Zobah, who forsook his master in his adversity, and gathered men unto him, and became captain over a band, and ultimately ruler over Damacene Syria. The Syrians of Damascus, who came to succour the king of Zobah, were defeated at the same time, and David slew of the Syrians twenty-two thousand; and he put garrisons in Syria of Damascus; and the Syrians became servants to David, and brought gifts. Those kingdoms which David had subdued and garrisoned attempted to rise, under other leaders, in the time of Solomon; but however these might abhor and harass Israel, their opposition did not seriously shake the stability of Solomon's kingdom. This was effected by another adversary, one that was stirred up against him from among the tribes of his own Israel, and from among his own servants, Jeroboam the son of Nebat. He was the provided or permitted instrument of permanently dividing the twelve tribes of Israel into two kingdoms. Of this we need not speak more particularly at present. We may only observe that this division, as it had its origin, so it had its instrument, within the kingdom of Israel

itself; as the separation which it represented had in the higher kingdom, of which the Israelitish kingdom, under David and Solomon, was the type. The distinction which the present history points out between the adversaries that rise against the kingdom of the Lord, general or individual, from within and from without, and of the different results of their operations, is very instructive. The enemies that assail us from without are far less dangerous than those that assail us from within. All temptations have indeed a ground of evil in our own minds. There must be lust before there can be temptation; for a man is tempted when he is drawn aside of his own lusts and enticed. But evil spirits that assail us from without have no power over us except through the evil within us; and if we desire to remain true to our principles, our tempters only make our integrity the stronger. But when our foes are they of our own house, the danger is far greater. When the temptation begins, not from the passive but from the active desires of our own hearts, or from the congenial falsities of our own understandings, the evil spirits, though our enemies, find us, in some respects, the willing instruments of our own destruction, and thus so far their friends. David's greatest troubles during his reign arose from the disaffection of his own people, and the enmity of his own children to him and to each other. One of the chief objects of the Forerunner of the Lord was to turn the heart of the fathers to the children, and the heart of the children to their fathers—to create inward harmony and unity, not only among the persons but among the principles of the Church, as a preparation for the coming of the Lord as the Prince of Peace. When there is internal harmony and unity, outward enemies, even when powerful and confederate, can do no serious injury, but are rather the instruments of good, as they serve to restrain, and thus indirectly to correct, the evils through which they act. Hadad and Rezon, and, so far as their power extended, Edom and Syria, were confederate against Israel all the days of Solomon, or during a great part of his reign, and yet they produced so little effect upon his kingdom that their conflicts with his men are never described, and are mentioned not more than once. The army of Solomon had, therefore, little to do with war. It represented the warlike power of the king for either offence or defence; but the warfare of the kingdom had been accomplished, and the army rested from its labours, and enjoyed the rest which its victories had acquired. It was like the heavenly host that surrounds the throne of the King of kings; which, while ready to go forth in the service and under the leadership of Him who in righteousness doth judge and make war, is still more ready to convey messages of mercy, like the multitude of the heavenly host that, at the birth of the Saviour, praised God, saying, "Glory to God in the highest, and on earth peace, good will toward men."

CHAPTER XX.

THE DEATH AND BURIAL OF SOLOMON.

1 *Kings* xi. 42, 43.

IN the Book of Ecclesiastes, long believed to be a work of Solomon, but now considered to be the production of another hand and of a later age, there are many excellent sentiments, some of which apply with strict propriety and great force to the life of that wise man and eminent king. In one of these it is said, "Dead flies cause the ointment of the apothecary to send forth a stinking savour: so doth a little folly him that is in reputation for wisdom and honour." The odour of sanctity in which Solomon may be said to have died, would have embalmed his memory with the purest and richest perfume had it not been tainted by the folly of which he was guilty in his declining years. Perhaps this is to be lamented still more as an indication of the frailty of our common humanity, than as a sin on the part of a particular man, eminent as he was for wisdom.

Folly is inseparable from our fallen nature, even in its highest earthly condition; and all mere men seem to exhibit instances of failure even in those virtues for which they are most distinguished. The Scriptures afford abundant evidence of this. Aaron, the first High Priest of the Jews, whose duty it was to preserve the worship of Jehovah in its purity, was the first to sanction idolatry, in making and setting up the golden calf; and Moses, the meekest man in all the earth, was excluded from the land of Canaan for an ebullition of anger at the waters of Meribah. In the New Testament, Peter, the strongest in the faith, openly denies his Master; and John, the gentlest and most loving of the disciples, wishes to call down fire from heaven to consume those who refused to receive his Lord. The failing of Solomon, whose distinguishing glory it was to build a house for the Lord, a settled habitation where He might dwell for ever, though inconsistent with his religious profession and eminent piety, was but too concordant with his natural corruptions. Such failings, common, in a greater or less degree, to all men, proclaim, from age to age and from day to day, the great truth, that even those who are ingrafted into the true vine, though they receive new life and bring forth new fruits, still retain their old nature, their corrupt selfhood, and are only preserved from the grossest evils and the deepest hell by the unfailing mercy and sustaining power of the Lord and Saviour. And what is the great lesson which this teaches us? It teaches us the general lesson of

profound humility, of distrust in ourselves, and constant dependence on Him who alone is pure and holy; and it teaches the particular lesson, that on those very points in which the Christian excels, and on which in consequence he is most liable to fall into spiritual pride, he is permitted to be tried, that he may have a constant practical sense of his own inherent weakness in that wherein his spiritual strength lies. However strong the Christian may be, yet if the hair of his Nazariteship is shaven off, he will become weak, and be like any other man. With the seven locks of his head—with the holy principles of his regenerate life—all his spiritual power departs, and he becomes the slave and the sport of the lusts and imaginations of his own evil heart. However highly regenerated and endued with spiritual strength and virtue the Christian disciple may be, his natural vileness and feebleness as a son of Adam remain, and his departure from the state of faithfulness and integrity to which he has attained reduces him to a lower than his original condition. It is one thing, however, to fall entirely away from a state of righteousness, and another to betray our natural weakness in the checkered scenes of the probationary life. To expect or to affect exemption from this would be to put in our claim for being more than mortal. In this respect we see the essential difference between every child of fallen Adam, who originally was made a living soul, and the second Adam, who was made a quickening spirit. The Lord inherited our frail nature, and endured more than all human trials. In these respects He was like unto His brethren according to the flesh. By taking upon Him human nature from a daughter of Eve, He placed Himself on a level with the lowest of His creatures. But with all the hereditary tendencies and inherent frailty of His maternal humanity, tempted beyond all possible or conceivable human experience, the Lord Jesus, though bowing under the weight of all hereditary evils and most direful temptations, never yielded, either by consent or commission, to the influences that bore so powerfully upon Him, and the authors of which would have triumphed over His least transgression of the law. We may not hope to reach any power of endurance or unswerving integrity like His. Yet it is through His that we are enabled in any degree to resist temptation or to fulfil the Divine law. And while our shortcomings should remind us of the immense distance between the Christian, in his best state, and the Author of Christianity; the pattern and the power which we find in Him who lived and died, and rose and ascended for us and before us, should teach us how great is our advantage, and how willing and ready we should be to use it.

The death like the life of Solomon may be considered as equally relating to the Lord and to the Christian disciple. In reference to

either the blemishes of the king's life do not represent actual evils. So far as they refer to evils, they represent temptations to commit them; and only so far include the idea of actual evil, which is sin, as is necessarily connected with every act of imperfect man: for there is no man that liveth and sinneth not.

The death of Solomon, in its highest representative sense, does not of necessity represent the Lord's death, nor even His resurrection, to which His death led, and which arose out of it, as He rose from the grave. The death of representative characters may have reference to any change by which the progressive work of glorification, and, in the secondary sense, of regeneration, is carried by successive degrees to its completion. Death, indeed, involves the idea of resurrection, since death to the body is resurrection to the soul. But the death of Solomon represents the ascension of the Lord rather than His resurrection. The Lord's ascension was the complement and the completion of His resurrection. He died that He might rise, He rose that He might ascend. The Lord was our Exemplar even in His death, and resurrection, and ascension. His glorification was the pattern of our regeneration, from our birth to our entrance into heaven. Every man has his death, his resurrection, and his ascension. When the body dies the soul rises into the world of spirits, the *Hades* of the New Testament, the common receptacle for all souls on their first entrance into the eternal world; and after the necessary preparation there, the righteous ascend into heaven, where they are ever with the Lord. Jesus, whose glorifying work required that He should pass through all states answering to those of man's regeneration and final salvation, passed through these final states and experiences also. His resurrection was into the world of spirits; and after forty days He ascended into heaven. He several times indeed appeared to His disciples who were in the natural world, and when He was about to ascend into heaven He led them out as far as Bethany, where His ascension took place. But although the disciples, to whom He appeared, were in the natural world, they did not see Him with their natural eyes, nor hear Him with their natural ears, nor cognise Him by any of their natural senses. They saw and heard and felt Him with their spiritual senses, those senses which, when the material body is laid aside once and for ever, cognise objects at least as sensibly and perfectly as the natural senses cognised objects in the natural world. And the Lord, when He ascended, led the disciples out as far as Bethany, for the sake of the correspondence in accordance with which the Lord always both spoke and acted. There He had raised Lazarus from the dead, which represented the raising up of the Church anew, the celestial and spiritual affections of which were represented by Mary and Martha, their brother representing the truth

which was restored to them from the dead. As the disciples beheld the Lord's ascension with their spiritual eyes, they were virtually and sensibly present in the spiritual world; and from that part of the spiritual world which is intermediate between earth and heaven the Lord actually ascended.

In conformity the Apostle Paul speaks of the Lord in this wise: "Now that He ascended, what is it but that He also descended first into the lower parts of the earth? He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that He might fill all things" (Eph. iv. 9, 10). The apostle speaks of the Lord as first making a descent, and into the lower parts of the earth. What does he mean by this? What are the lower parts of the earth to which He descended? Some understand them to mean the profound depths of the earth on which we dwell, and that Jesus literally descended into these material depths as well as above all heavens, that He might fill, or fulfil, all things. The apostle could not teach anything so meaningless as this. The lower parts of the earth, to which the Lord descended after His resurrection, were the lower parts of the world of spirits, called the lower earth, where certain of the souls of departed men had been preserved until the Lord should come into the world, and, after He had accomplished the work of Redemption and glorified His humanity, deliver them from what may be called a state of bondage, and take them up with Him into heaven, when He ascended through it far above all heavens into the light that no man can approach unto. This lower earth is what the Apostle Peter calls a prison, and those who are preserved in it he calls the spirits in prison, in that remarkable passage respecting the meaning of which there has been much speculation: "For Christ also hath once suffered for sins, the just for the unjust, that He might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh, but quickened by the Spirit: by which also He went and preached unto the spirits in prison; which sometime were disobedient, when once the long-suffering of God waited in the days of Noah, while the ark was a preparing, wherein few, that is, eight souls, were saved by water. The like figure whereunto even baptism doth also now save us, by the resurrection of Jesus Christ: who is gone into heaven, and is on the right hand of God; angels, and authorities, and powers, being made subject unto Him" (1 Peter iii. 18-22). This passage, which commentators acknowledge to be obscure, and which must appear dark to those who deny the existence of a middle state, affords valuable testimony to the truth of an important doctrine of the Lord's New Church.

It has already been remarked that the Lord came into the world to save the spiritual, and that all were of the spiritual character or genius who lived from the time of Noah, or from the commencement of the Ancient Church.

It is the common belief of Christians that after the Fall there was no salvation for sinners but in Jesus Christ. But how were men saved by a redemption that was not effected for ages after they had lived and died? They were saved, it is said, by faith in the coming Saviour. But how did faith save them? Their faith was counted unto them for righteousness. But how was their faith counted unto them for righteousness? Faith was the forerunner of righteousness. Faith in Christ before the Incarnation was perfected by the righteousness of Christ after the Incarnation. No man can be saved without being regenerated, and no one could be regenerated until the Lord was glorified. He was the first-fruits of them that slept, the first-born of every creature, the beginning of the creation of God. Whatever else these Scripture declarations include, they teach the all-important truth, that the Lord Jesus Christ was the Author, because the beginning, of that spiritual awakening from the sleep of spiritual death into which mankind had fallen, which prepared them to receive the life which Christ had to give them; the first of every creature in whom fallen humanity was born again, and thus the beginning of that new creation by which men would become new creatures.

We have already spoken on this subject, in explaining how the faithful who lived before the Lord's coming were able to receive from Him, and through His redemption, the forgiveness of sins that were past. They remained in the middle state, as prisoners of hope, until the Lord had risen from the dead, when, by virtue of the works of redemption and glorification He had performed in the world, He was able to complete in them the work of regeneration, which could not be completely effected before. Those who thus waited for deliverance were, as we have said, the spiritual, who had lived from the time of Noah. The judgment which took place in the world of spirits at the time of the Lord's first advent was upon the Ancient Church, or on all who had lived in the world from the commencement of that Dispensation. For although the Hebrew and the Israelitish Churches were, in a certain sense, dispensations having a distinctive character, they were but prolongations of the Ancient Church, and had nothing of spiritual vitality in them except what they had derived from it. They were only provided to prolong the existence of the spiritual Church, until the fulness of time, when the Lord should come into the world.

While the reign of Solomon represented more peculiarly that part of the process of the Lord's glorification which consisted in His making His humanity Divine Good, it included in it, representatively, the Lord's work in the spiritual world, between His resurrection and ascension. Except in the Writings of the New Church no satisfactory view has ever been presented of where the Lord was or what He did during the forty days that intervened between these two great events.

Certainly no idea has been entertained of the Redeemer being engaged in performing a great work in the spiritual world, no less a work than reaping the harvest that had been growing up since the days of Noah, of separating the wheat from the tares, binding the tares in bundles to burn them, and gathering the wheat into His garner. The good had not only to be separated from the evil, like the Israelites from the Egyptians, but they had to be brought through the Red Sea, and led through the wilderness, and introduced through the Jordan into their land of Canaan. They had to pass through that perfecting process which had been commenced but could not be completed upon earth, that in them the prophetic utterance of the Psalmist might receive its accomplishment, "Thou hast ascended on high, Thou hast led captivity captive: Thou hast received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also, that the Lord God might dwell among them" (Ps. lxviii. 18).

The death of Solomon represents, therefore, the Lord's ascension rather than His resurrection, which was represented by the death of David. This will further appear from the history itself.

Solomon, like David, reigned forty years. As types of the Lord, their forty years' reign finds each its parallel in the forty days during which the Lord was in the wilderness, and the forty days that intervened between His resurrection and ascension. The forty days during which our Lord was in the wilderness represented the duration of His temptations in the world; for a wilderness is symbolic of temptation, and forty, whether it be days or years, is expressive of their duration. The forty days which intervened between the Lord's resurrection and ascension were also symbolic of temptation; but the temptations now were not temptations of the Lord, but of the redeemed in the world of spirits.

We may now turn from this view of the subject, as relating to the Lord Himself, whom, in the highest sense, Solomon represented, to that view which shows it in relation to the Lord's disciples, who are privileged to follow Him, and to see His Divine work reflected and practically realized in their own.

Solomon, at the end of his forty years' reign, "slept with his fathers." This beautiful phrase, which occurs so often in the Old Testament Scriptures, which might convey to the Israelitish people only a carnal though tender feeling, expresses to the Christian a beautiful spiritual truth. The Christian is enabled to think of death as the gate of life, as that which introduces the soul into the company of the faithful of his spiritual as well as of his natural kindred. In the spiritual sense, death and burial do not mean resurrection into the other world merely —a resurrection which is common to the evil and to the good, for all live unto God—but they mean also resurrection into a new state of spiritual life, a state of spiritual love and faith. This resurrection is peculiar to the faithful. It is that which is called resurrection from the death

of sin unto the life of righteousness. This the wicked know not; this they never experience. And it is for this reason that burial was refused among the Jews to such as had been guilty of great crimes, or even of grave offences; and that death and the grave themselves are so frequently spoken of as if they implied an entire end of human existence. But when the phrase occurs of the dead being gathered to their fathers, a peculiar state which the regenerate have attained is implied by it. For the term father is expressive of the principle of goodness, as son is of the principle of truth; for truth proceeds from good as a son from a father. Nor is anything meant by the names Father and Son, in relation to the Divine Being Himself, but the Divine Goodness and Truth. When our Lord declared that He came forth from the Father, and that He returned to the Father, He instructed us, that He, as the Divine Truth, came forth from the Divine Goodness, or as the Divine Wisdom from the Divine Love; and that after effecting the work of regeneration and glorification, He returned to the Divine Goodness or Love—to the glory which He had with the Father before the world was; but that He returned as the Word made flesh and glorified. In the highest representative sense, the phrase thus refers to the Lord's return to His Father, in and with His glorified Humanity. And this return was the result and the expression of so intimate a union, that the Lord, after He had made His humanity Divine Truth in the world, made it Divine Good after His departure out of the world; and this making His humanity Divine Good was connected with and represented by His forty days' presence with the spirits of the just who were being made perfect. In relation to the Christian this language is expressive of a corresponding work. The regenerate are gathered to their fathers when they have passed from a state of truth into a state of goodness—from a state of wisdom into a state of love, from a state of faith into a state of charity. Such a change of state is but an image of that which is expressed by the Lord's returning to the Father, for the states of life attainable by the faithful are but the shadows as they are the effects of those which the Lord effected in Himself. Because He lives, we shall live also. Because He lifted His humanity up from its earthly state, He will draw all men who are willing to be drawn from their earthly states unto Himself. Because He has returned to His Father, we can ascend to Him as our Father. Because He has become as to His humanity the Divine Love itself, we can be raised into a state of love.

But Solomon not only slept with his fathers, but he was buried in the city of David his father. David represented the Lord as Divine Truth. But David is here spoken of as a father. And David as a father is expressive of Divine Truth derived from Divine Good. Truth with the regenerate exists in two different states; or, there are two kinds of

truth which they possess in the two general stages of their regeneration. There is a truth that leads to goodness, and there is a truth derived from goodness. In the first general stage of the regenerate life, the Christian acquires a knowledge of goodness, and by means of that knowledge he strives after goodness. His first truth, therefore, has not goodness in it, his first faith has not love in it, because he is as yet only striving after goodness and love. But when goodness and love have been attained, his truth and faith change their character. His truth becomes united to good, his faith to love. Henceforth his truth is no longer a means and an instrument by which good is sought after and attained, but a means and instrument by which good works out its own purposes by truth; faith is no longer a faith that looks and strives after love, but a faith that works by love, or by which love works out its ends. Such is the truth and such is the faith of the regenerate, as distinguished from those of men who are being regenerated. Entrance into this new state of life is spiritually meant by Solomon being buried in the city of David his father. That city was Zion. As a city it represents truth of the highest kind—truth grounded in goodness—the goodness that comes from love to the Lord. The city of David his father is the truth of the Church derived from the Divine Truth of the Divine Good itself. In reference to the regenerate, the death and burial of the great king of Israel point in the significant language of representatives to the new birth of the soul into the life of heavenly love and truth, which may be considered as completing that sublime work, which is the first and last end of all the other Divine works of the Lord, the regeneration and salvation of the human soul.

CHAPTER XXI.

THE PREDICTED REVOLT OF THE TEN TRIBES.

1 *Kings* ii. 29-35.

OUR work would have ended with the reign of Solomon, had not his death been followed by an event, the explanation of which is necessary to a complete view of the representative history of the first three kings of Israel. The Lord's great work, which the reign of these kings represented, was not completed in His resurrection, nor even in His ascension, but in the pouring out of His Spirit on the apostles on the day of Pentecost. The circle of His Divine work was then completed; and with the diffusion of the Spirit, which could now be given in fulness because that Jesus was now fully glorified, by which the apostles were endued with power from on high, the Lord's Church on

earth had its actual commencement. The reign of the three kings was not ended by the death of Solomon, but is to be followed in its immediate consequences in the division of the tribes into two kingdoms, which the Lord had announced to the king after he sinned against Him.

The division of the tribes into two kingdoms, although the remote consequence of Solomon's sin and the immediate result of Rehoboam's folly, was representative of no less an event than the separation into two kingdoms of the Lord's heaven, which had previously existed as one.

Here, again, there seems to be a discordance if not an actual conflict between the human and earthly type and the Divine and heavenly antitype. A national calamity, the consequence of Solomon's sin, represents a heavenly benefit, the result of the Lord's righteousness. Yet the disparity is only seeming. Besides the general truth, that it is the function and not the man that represents, there is the particular truth, that priests and prophets and kings represented both the Lord and the Church; and in this they were true types of the Lord Himself. When Aaron ministered at the altar he represented the Lord, when he made the golden calf he represented the people. When Hosea reproved and threatened judgments against the people for their sins he represented the Lord, when he was commanded to take to himself a wife of whoredoms it was to represent the Church. When David opposed the enemies of Israel he represented the Lord, when he numbered the people he represented the Church. The Lord differed from all priests and prophets and kings essentially in this, that He did no evil, neither was guile found in His mouth; therefore in this respect He could not represent the Church. But although He could not represent the Church in all He did, He could represent the Church in all He suffered. As the prophets were commanded to do certain sinless but symbolic acts as signs to the people of the state of the Church amongst them, so the Lord, in some things that He did and in all that He suffered, was a sign unto the people of the state of the Church as it had then become. The Lord was the Word; and all that the Jews did to Him personally, therefore all that He suffered at their hands, represented what the Jewish Church had done to the Word; His sufferings were thus signs of the state of the Church, as manifested in what the Jews did and in what He endured.

But the disparity between the type and the antitype, in the revolt of the ten tribes, and the permanent division of the Israelitish nation into two separate kingdoms, is only seeming. The division of heaven into two distinct kingdoms, though a Divine arrangement, and the result of the Lord's works of Redemption and Glorification, was yet in itself an imperfection, and a consequence of the altered condition

of the human mind, which the Fall had produced, or, rather, which had been produced by Divine goodness and wisdom for the purpose of preventing the otherwise irremediable effects of the Fall.

The human mind consists of two great faculties, which are essential to human nature, which are will and understanding. In virtue of these man is possessed of liberty and rationality, by which he is distinguished from the whole animal creation, which act from instinct and appetite. It is in virtue of these faculties that man, by creation, is an image and likeness of God. For God consists of a Divine will and a Divine understanding. But these in God are not faculties but powers. In God will is infinite Love and understanding is infinite Wisdom. In man will is the created and finite capacity for receiving from God a finite measure of His love and the faculty of loving from that love; and understanding is the capacity of receiving from God a finite measure of His wisdom and the faculty of thinking and reasoning wisely from that wisdom.

But man is not an image of God simply and solely in virtue of his possessing will and understanding, but in virtue of will and understanding being united, and forming one undivided mind. God is not God because He has a Divine will and a Divine understanding, or because He is infinite Love and infinite Wisdom, but because His will and understanding or His love and wisdom are so perfectly one that they ever act in unity. His love is of His wisdom and His wisdom is of His love; thus His love is the love of wisdom and His wisdom is the wisdom of love; so that His love can never act otherwise than wisely and His wisdom can never act otherwise than lovingly. Besides, love is the *Esse*, and wisdom is the *Existere*, of the Divine nature. Love in God is the parent of wisdom, and wisdom is the offspring of love; and Love is in wisdom and wisdom is in Love. Love is the Eternal Father, Wisdom is the Eternal Son. What the Scriptures have thus personified, an obscure and materialistic theology has converted into persons; so that in the Creed there is one person of the Father, and another person of the Son, and another of the Holy Spirit; and these three persons are one God.

Man, as a created image of God, was so constituted, that his will and his understanding acted in unity. His will being the *esse*, and his understanding the *existere*, of his nature, or, willing being the parent of thinking, and thinking the offspring of willing, he could not think otherwise than he willed, nor will otherwise than he thought. So long as man remained in a state of integrity, or in the state of order in which he was created, his mind was in harmony, and acted in unison, with the mind of God. While he continued to will what was good, he naturally and necessarily thought what was true; for good affections in the will spontaneously produced true thoughts in the understanding.

This was the normal state and condition of man. His mind was then, the Eden and garden of God; and while the love of God, as his tree of life, was in the midst, all the lower affections and appetites of his nature, which were the beasts of the field, and the fowls of the air, and the fishes of the sea, and every creeping thing that creepeth upon the earth, were under his dominion.

But beside the tree of life there grew the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. The potential existence of opposites was inseparable from the actual existence of man. A being who united in himself a spiritual and immortal soul and material and mortal body had these opposites in himself. God and self, heaven and the world, matter and spirit, sense and reason, mortality and immortality, are opposites, not indeed in themselves, or in respect to the Creator, but in respect to man, as a thinking and sentient being. These opposites are the tree of life and the tree of the knowledge of good and evil. Created man had necessarily the faculty of perceiving and the power of choosing between them. Rationality was the faculty of perceiving, liberty was the power of choosing. Man, from his first creation, and in his best state, must have seen that the love of self and the love of God, the love of the world and the love of heaven, the love of the body and the love of the soul, the love of mortality and the love of immortality, as ends, are opposites, and that he must exercise his choice between them. A wise choice gave him a wide range of satisfactions and delights; he might freely eat of every tree of the garden; but of the tree of the knowledge he must not eat nor even touch it, "for in the day thou eatest thereof thou shalt surely die."

Notwithstanding the experienced advantages and delights of goodness, and the warnings against transgressing the Divine command, the will of man prevailed over the will of God. Man took of the fruit of the forbidden tree, and that death which was threatened passed upon the transgressors and thence upon all men. The Scriptures reveal, in the expressive language of correspondence, how this took place. The sensual in man prevailed over the spiritual, the animal over the human. The poison of the serpent entered into the blood, which is the life or soul of the flesh, and no remedy could restore what sin had taken away till the woman's seed should bruise the serpent's head.

The manner in which the Fall was effected is in harmony with the view which has been presented of the condition, we may say with the constitution of human nature, as it originally came from the hand of God, and formed in His own image and likeness. We have seen that, in the state of order in which man was created, the will was the paramount faculty of the mind, and that the understanding spontaneously acted under the influence of the will. We find, therefore, that, in the

introduction of evil, the will was first seduced, and the understanding yielded to its persuasive influence. The serpent deceived Eve, Eve persuaded Adam. The tempter did not apply himself to the man but to the woman, knowing that if she were gained over, he would follow. In the Word man and woman represent and symbolize the understanding and the will, because the man is more intellectual than the woman, and the woman is more affectional than the man. Thus by the sacred symbolism of Divine Revelation we are instructed, in agreement with the original condition of human nature, how mankind were originally seduced from the path of life and light to the way of darkness and death.

And now it was that mankind entered on that course of evil in which they had no power of self-control. The understanding being subject to the will, men had no power of reflecting on the state of the will, therefore no discriminative knowledge of its character, therefore could neither judge of its state nor correct it. As, when the will was in the love of goodness, the understanding was in the light of truth ; so now, when the will was in the love of evil, the understanding was in the darkness of error. The wish was then truly father to the thought. Men thought as they felt, believed as they were inclined, and it was then impossible to convince a man against his will. The understanding was the reflection of the will, and could not be more or other than its image.

Had this condition of the human mind continued, mankind must have gone on unchecked in their downward career till the human race had perished. It did continue during the whole period of the existence of the Church or dispensation which was first established in the world. No organic change could be effected during the existence of the first or Most Ancient Church, which, from its primeval excellence, was called Adam or Man.

The change which was required to make the salvation and even the preservation of the race a possibility, was effected when the first dispensation had come to an end, and it had been followed by another, and one of an entirely different character. The end of the first dispensation is described by the Flood, and the preservation of a remnant, from which a new dispensation might be commenced, is described by the family of Noah being saved by means of the ark. It is now generally acknowledged that the account of the Flood and of the ark cannot be taken literally. No such a flood can have occurred, no such an ark can have been constructed and have floated on the waters, and no such a collection of animals can have been made as would preserve a thousandth part of the existing species. In the days of ignorance such narratives as those of Creation and the Flood could, in simplicity, be accepted and believed, and be the means of sustaining faith in the creative and preservative power of God. But what is Divinely inspired

is for all times, and may be understood in simplicity by the simple and in wisdom by the wise. Only, we must not think that scientific or worldly wisdom can open the gate to Divine knowledge. The cherubim with their flaming sword keep the way of the tree of life against those who have eaten of the tree of knowledge. But the gate is opened to those who seek admission in the spirit of humility and in the fear of the Lord. And they must, in these instances especially, seek to penetrate within the letter, since it is the spirit that quickeneth, and all the words of the Lord are spirit and are life.

In the spirit of the sacred record, which seems as if it were the narrative of a deluge which submerged the whole earth, and swept every vestige of human and animal life away, we have the history, not of a flood of waters, but of falsities, that overspread the whole Church, and destroyed everything in which was the breath of spiritual life, except the remnant which a merciful Providence in all such cases saves from the general wreck. But how was even this remnant to be restored to a better state, if the mind remained in its original condition, in which the understanding was completely under the influence of the will, and the will had become so depraved, that it entirely corrupted the understanding, and rendered it incapable of seeing or believing anything but what was agreeable to the inclinations of the will? There was only one way of providing for the reformation of the human race, and enabling them to make a new beginning under a new dispensation; and that was to give them the power of knowing the state of their own hearts, and employing that knowledge for the purpose of correcting and improving them. The Lord, therefore, miraculously separated the understanding from the will; and by emancipating that faculty from the dominion of the will, gave it the power of being instructed and enlightened, and of being able to reflect on the state of the will, and to look into it and judge of it by the light of truth. The opening of this faculty is meant by Noah opening the window of the ark, to see if the waters were abated, and sending forth his winged messengers, those emblems of human thoughts, to ascertain whether the dry land had appeared. The dove with her olive branch shows the effect and the promise of the exercise of the new intellectual power of expanding the wings of thought and surveying the state and condition of the mind. Instead of the understanding being subject to the will, the will was made as it were subject to the understanding; for the understanding could be raised above the will, like the dove soaring above the troubled waters, and could pluck the olive branch of reviving hope and returning peace to the human mind and to the human race. But this is a subject of so much interest and importance that we give a quotation from the Writings which places it in a clear light. It comes appropriately under the

merciful assurance, "I will not again curse the ground any more for man's sake" (Gen. viii. 21): "This signifies that man would not any more avert himself like the man of the posterity of the Most Ancient Church. To curse signifies in the internal sense to avert himself. . . . The man of the Most Ancient Church was of such a nature that with him will and understanding constituted one mind, or that with him love was implanted in his will and simultaneously with it faith, which filled the other or intellectual faculty of his mind. Hence their descendants were so hereditarily constituted that their will and understanding made one; wherefore when self-love and the unbridled lusts originating in it began to possess their will, which had previously been the habitation of love to the Lord and charity to the neighbour, not only did the voluntary faculty or will become altogether perverse, but at the same time the intellectual faculty or understanding, until at length the last posterity immersed truths in their lusts and became Nephilim or giants. Hence they acquired such a nature that it was impossible they could be restored, because both faculties of their mind, or their whole mind, was destroyed. But as this was foreseen by the Lord, it was provided that man might be built up again, which was effected by his being rendered capable of reformation and regeneration as to the intellectual part of his mind, whereby a new will, or conscience, might be implanted in him, by which the Lord could introduce the good of love and charity and the truth of faith. Thus by the Divine mercy of the Lord man was restored."

These two faculties may be called the two kingdoms of the human mind. Good is the governing power in the will, and truth is the governing power in the understanding. Such at least is now the condition of the human mind. Originally, when these two faculties were so united that they acted together, they formed but one kingdom. They were like the tribes of Judah and Israel when they were united under David and Solomon. The separation of these faculties was the division of the mind into two kingdoms, and this was represented by the division of Judah and Israel into two separate kingdoms under the reign of Solomon's son and successor.

The original union of the two faculties of the human mind was the producing cause of the original constitution of the angelic heaven, which, before the coming of the Lord in the flesh, consisted but of one kingdom; and the change which was effected in the condition of the human mind, by which a separation was made between the faculties of will and understanding, was the producing cause of the division of heaven into two kingdoms at the time of the Incarnation. This is the great event represented by the revolt of the ten tribes, and the permanent existence thence forward of the two separate kingdoms of Judah and Israel.

In the separation which took place between the two essential faculties of the mind the analogy with the historical event may be very clearly seen. In regard to the tribes, evil was the cause of the revolt and separation. It was not the tribe of Judah that revolted from the ten tribes, but they that revolted from Judah; and it was they that formed themselves into a new kingdom. So in the human mind: evil was the cause of their separation; it was not the will that revolted from the understanding, but the understanding from the will, and that became a new kingdom and an independent power. The analogy is as perfect in regard to heaven; but the consideration of this we reserve for another chapter.

CHAPTER XXII.

THE TWO KINGDOMS OF JUDAH AND ISRAEL.

1 *Kings* xii.

ONE of the adversaries whom God stirred up against Solomon, and who lifted up his hand against the king, was Jeroboam, the son of Nebat. As he is evidently representative of that principle which lay at the foundation of the spiritual separation which the division of the twelve tribes of Israel represented, it is necessary to turn our attention to his history during the reign of Solomon, as given in chapter ix.

The first fact we learn respecting Jeroboam is that he was an Ephrathite. The tribe of Ephraim, the descendants of the younger son of Joseph, represented, as we have had occasion to show, the intellectual part of the mind, as Manasseh represented the voluntary part. These two sons of Joseph, therefore, represent in epitome what was represented by the whole house of Israel, with the characteristic difference between Judah and the ten tribes which finally ultimated itself in their division into two kingdoms. As Ephraim represented the intellectual faculty of the mind, he represented also, as a matter of course, the spiritual principle itself, and thence the spiritual kingdom in the Church and in heaven. His paternal name answers to this; for to look or regard, which Nebat means, is expressive of intellectual sight. But Jeroboam's mother was a widow, whose name was Zeruah. A widow is one who is in goodness and desires truth. But Jeroboam's widowed mother bore the extraordinary name of Leper, which indicates that the goodness she represented was mixed with evil, and was thus to some extent profaned. Such indeed was the root of the intellect of those who constitute the Ancient or Spiritual Church, and even the spiritual heaven itself. With the spiritual the original will is corrupt, and is never

renewed, as with the celestial, into the likeness of God which it has lost. With the spiritual a new will is formed in the intellectual part of the mind. Being formed by means of truth, it is therefore the will of truth rather than of goodness. This new will, with those who are born again, holds the former will in subjection, or, becoming the active and actuating power of the mind, it supersedes the function of the original faculty. Yet the old root is never entirely destroyed. It is that corrupt will which every one feels, and the disturbing influence of which even the children of God have cause to lament. It was this leprous will which made Paul declare that when he would do good evil was present with him, and in the bitterness of his spirit exclaim, "Who shall deliver me from the body of this death?" This is the carnal mind which is not subject to the law of God, neither indeed can be. Although this carnal will can never, with the spiritual, be either restored or extinguished, it can be subdued. To both of these facts the same apostle bears experimental testimony. After speaking of the two conflicting laws, the law in his members that warred against the law of his mind, he exclaims, "O wretched man that I am! who shall deliver me from the body of this death? I thank God through Jesus Christ our Lord. So then with the mind I myself serve the law of God; but with the flesh the law of sin" (Rom. vii. 24, 25).

Jeroboam, who was a mighty man of valour, had by his industry commended himself to Solomon's favour when the king built Millo, and repaired the breaches of the city of David his father; and he made him ruler over all the charge of the house of Joseph. Millo was a fortress on Mount Zion, and was originally built by David (2 Sam. v. 9). The charge of the house of Joseph was no doubt part of "the levy which king Solomon raised; for to build the house of the Lord, and his own house, and Millo, and the wall of Jerusalem" (ix. 15). Jeroboam, who thus laboured to repair the breaches of the city of David, was himself to be instrumental in opening a breach in the kingdom of David which was never to be repaired. Yet in performing that work, Solomon, and Jeroboam, and the house of Joseph were performing a good work, and one not unnecessary, or inconsistent with that breaking up of the kingdom into two, for which both Solomon and his servants were, in a different manner, preparing the way.

The cause of Jeroboam lifting up his hand against the king was one that was likely to inspire him with motives of ambition, although it ought to have restrained him from any hostile action during Solomon's lifetime. "When Jeroboam went out of Jerusalem, the prophet Ahijah the Shilonite found him in the way; and he had clad himself with a new garment; and they two were alone in the field: and Ahijah caught the new garment that was on him, and rent it in twelve pieces: and he said to Jeroboam, Take thee ten pieces: for thus saith the Lord

the God of Israel, Behold, I will rend the kingdom out of the hand of Solomon, and will give ten tribes to thee." It is easy to see the meaning of this sign, as it refers to the kingdom of Israel, but its symbolism in reference to the division of the one kingdom in heaven is not so obvious. Garments are emblematical of truths, for these invest goodness as garments clothe the body, and perform for it corresponding uses. It was for this reason that so many and minute directions were given for the garments of Aaron. His garments also represented the spiritual kingdom of the Lord. On account of this representation, God Himself is spoken of as being clothed with light as with a garment, for the garment with which He is clothed is His Divine Truth which covers His Divine Goodness. It is truth also that is capable of being divided or rent into pieces. Goodness is one, but truth is various according to reception, and although it does not divide, it modifies, the good with which it is connected. It is from this circumstance that, however variously truth may be received by men, if all are actuated by goodness they are one. So the Church may be one in goodness and love, although it may be various as to doctrine. So the celestial and spiritual heavens are united in love although they are distinguished by truth. The Church may be divided as regards truth and doctrine and yet may be one in spirit: as Israel was divided into two kingdoms, which yet could live at peace with one another; and as heaven is divided into two kingdoms, which yet are united by charity.

The separation which was effected, at the end of the first and the beginning of the second Church, between the human faculties of will and understanding, was necessarily followed by the division of heaven into two distinct kingdoms. Heaven takes its form as well as its state from the state and form of those of whom it consists. Regenerate man is a little heaven, and heaven is the greatest regenerate man. While the faculties of will and understanding were inseparably united in the individual man, their representatives in the Grand Man could not have a separate existence. So long as the human mind was one, heaven, which consists of regenerated human minds, was one also. When the human mind came to be divided, heaven underwent a corresponding division. The division of heaven into two kingdoms could not take place until the time of the Incarnation. Not till then did the Ancient Church come to a complete end by the last judgment which the Lord performed upon it in the spiritual world. To this event our Lord referred when He said, "Now is the judgment of this world, now shall the prince of this world be cast out;" and when He said, "I beheld Satan as lightning fall from heaven." For the world spiritually means the Church; and Satan means those in the other world who were opposed to and infested the spiritual, who were preserved in the middle state, preparatory to their being elevated into heaven, when

the Lord had risen from the dead and ascended on high. The heaven from which Satan fell was the imaginary heaven, which the false and unfaithful in the Church on earth had formed for themselves in the world of spirits, into which all departed souls first enter after death. The faithful who had been preserved in the middle state from the time of the Flood and the days of Noah, or from the commencement of the Ancient Church, formed the spiritual or second heaven, which is also the spiritual kingdom.

But the second heaven, or the spiritual kingdom, was not formed of those only who had been preserved in the world of spirits. The heaven which had been formed of those who belonged to the Most Ancient Church, which was a celestial Church, constituted the one kingdom of which heaven originally consisted, which was celestial, and still constitutes the celestial kingdom, as distinct from the spiritual.

Although originally there was but one heaven, and that heaven constituted but one kingdom, yet that one heaven and kingdom had in it the essential elements of all the three heavens and of the two kingdoms of which the universal heaven now consists. The Grand Man was in this respect like the individual man. From his first creation man consisted, mentally, of will, understanding, and action. By the change which took place in the condition of the human mind at the time of the Flood nothing was added to the mind or taken from it. The same faculties remained, they were only differently circumstanced in relation to each other. They acquired, so to speak, a separate individuality—a separate but not independent existence. The mind acquired a kind of double consciousness; the power of thinking and willing separately. The Grand Man also consisted originally of will, understanding, and action. These are the elements of the three heavens and of the two kingdoms. The celestial heaven is the will of the Grand Man, the spiritual heaven is his understanding, and the ultimate heaven is his action. Originally all these were united in one, as they originally were in the individual man, and, as in him, they had no distinct consciousness, and therefore had no distinct activity. When heaven was formed into two kingdoms, it was not entirely by the formation of a second heaven out of those who belonged to the Ancient or Spiritual Church, but it was partly by a division of the celestial heaven itself, as formed from among those who had lived in the world during the time of the Adamic Church. The celestial heaven was necessarily internal and external. When God assumed man's nature, as it had become both by change of state and change of condition, and had, by glorification, made His Humanity the great Archetype of all order in heaven and on earth, He made an organic change in heaven corresponding to that which He had made in human nature

in the world. The Humanity of the Lord is Divine-celestial, Divine-spiritual, and Divine-natural; and these in Him are the Archetypes of the three heavens, the celestial, the spiritual, and the natural. But these three heavens constitute two kingdoms. The two higher heavens form these two kingdoms; for the lowest heaven does not of itself form a kingdom, but it is the ultimate and basis of the two superior heavens. It consists of two kinds of angels, celestial-natural and spiritual-natural, the celestial-natural being the ultimate of the celestial heaven, and these constituting together the celestial kingdom, and the spiritual-natural being the ultimate of the spiritual heaven, and these forming together the spiritual kingdom.

When there was but one heaven and one kingdom, that one heaven, as we have said, contained the elements of the three heavens, and that one kingdom contained the elements of both kingdoms. The celestial kingdom existed actually, the spiritual existed potentially, not only in those who were in the world of spirits, but in a part of those who were in heaven. That heaven consisted, as every heaven does, of an internal and an external; and the internal was celestial and the external was spiritual. The internal was love to the Lord and the external was love to the neighbour; and love to the Lord is the celestial principle, and love to the neighbour is the spiritual principle. In that ordination or arrangement of the heavens which took place as a result of the Lord's glorification, the external of the celestial heaven receded and became the nucleus of the spiritual heaven, to which were added and around which were gathered those who were elevated out of the world of spirits; and these together formed the second heaven and the spiritual kingdom. Those who had formed the external of the celestial heaven thus now formed the internal of the spiritual heaven. Those who had been the spiritual of the celestial heaven now became the celestial of the spiritual heaven; for love to the neighbour, which forms the external of the celestial heaven, forms the internal of the spiritual heaven. Thus, while the two heavens are distinct from each other, and form two distinct kingdoms, they are united by the love of the neighbour. There is, however, a difference in the character of neighbourly love as it exists in these two kingdoms; though one is the similitude of the other, they are in nothing exactly the same. The love of the neighbour in the celestial heaven is mutual love, and the love of the neighbour in the spiritual heaven is charity. Mutual love is like the love that exists between brothers and sisters, and charity is like that which exists between friends and connections—the difference between consanguinity and affinity. Yet these affections, while they differ, answer to each other, and are the means of joining the two heavens and kingdoms together. The distinction of the heavens into two kingdoms, and the connecting-link between them may be illustrated, as indeed they were

represented, by the division of the twelve tribes after their entrance into Canaan, which itself represented heaven. Nine entire tribes took their inheritance in the land of Canaan, and two entire tribes chose their inheritance in the land of Gilead, on the other side Jordan. But of the remaining tribe one half settled in Canaan and the other half in Gilead; and that tribe was Manasseh, which represented the very principle by which the two kingdoms in the heavens are joined together.

The separation of the one heaven into two kingdoms is described symbolically by Zechariah, in a prophecy that evidently relates to the coming of the Lord, and to His works of redemption and judgment: "Then shall the Lord go forth, and fight against those nations, as when He fought in the day of battle. And His feet shall stand in that day upon the Mount of Olives, which is before Jerusalem on the east, and the Mount of Olives shall cleave in the midst thereof toward the east and toward the west, and there shall be a very great valley; and half of the mountain shall remove toward the north, and half of it toward the south" (xiv. 3, 4). This is the day of which the prophet further says, that "the light shall not be clear, nor dark: but it shall be one day which shall be known to the Lord, not day, nor night: but it shall come to pass, that at evening time it shall be light. And it shall be in that day, that living waters shall go out from Jerusalem; half of them toward the former sea, and half of them toward the hinder sea: in summer and in winter shall it be. And the Lord shall be King over all the earth: in that day shall there be one Lord, and His name one" (verses 6-9). "In this passage the evening time is the last time of the Church when judgment takes place, for then it is evening to the evil but light to the good. This being known it may appear from the spiritual sense what the particulars involve and signify. Jehovah going forth and fighting against the nations signifies the last judgment to the evil; to go forth and fight is to execute judgment, and the nations are evils. That this was effected from Divine Love is meant by the Lord's feet standing upon the Mount of Olives; for the Mount of Olives when it relates to the Lord, signifies the Divine Love, Jerusalem signifies the Church as to truth, and the east of the Divine goodness. The Mount of Olives cleaving in the midst, part thereof going toward the east and toward the sea, leaving a great valley between, signifies the separation of those who are in good from those who are in evil; for, as has been said, the Mount of Olives signifies the Divine love, the east is where those dwell who are in the Divine good, and the sea where those are in evil. The half of the mountain removing toward the south and half toward the north, signifies the separation of those who are in falsities derived from evil from those who are in truths derived from good." In this explanation the cleaving of the mountain is said to mean the separation

of the evil from the good, which is the immediate effect of judgment. But the other separations resulting from the judgment are also included in its meaning. So we read that "the Mount of Olives represented heaven as to the good of love and charity, as the subject treated of is concerning the Lord and His coming; the Mount of Olives signifies the good of love and charity, thus the Church, for these constitute the Church; that the Church should recede from the Jewish nation and be established among the Gentiles is signified by that mountain being cleft asunder toward the east, towards the sea, toward the south, and toward the north." This being meant by the prophecy when applied to the Church, when applied to heaven it describes the separation which was effected in it, by which it was divided into two kingdoms. This division was the necessary result and ultimate effect of the division that had been miraculously effected between the two constituent faculties of the mind, when the will, which then ruled the understanding, had become so corrupt that "every imagination of the thoughts of man's heart was only evil continually."

While the one kingdom was separated into two, the one heaven was divided into three. And these three heavens are in the spiritual world what the three dispensations of the Church—the Most Ancient, the Ancient, and the Israelitish—were in the natural world, Celestial, Spiritual, and Natural. These three dispensations of the Church on earth arose out of the states of mankind, who passed successively through these three descending degrees of religious life. Yet these three heavens form but two kingdoms, for there are but two essential faculties of the mind, the will and the understanding, as there are but two fountains of life in the body, the heart and the lungs, and as there are but two principles of spiritual life, goodness and truth, or love and faith. There is indeed a third, which is action, and in religion is work, but this is the use resulting from the combined effort of other two, and is their ultimate form. This ultimate, which is action or work, is what the Israelitish dispensation was to the other two. It was a dispensation of works, which had no life but that which had descended to it from the two previous dispensations. The Israelitish was not therefore properly a Church, but the representative of a Church. It was a dispensation in which their great virtue was obedience, obedience to law and ritual, with little perception of their true purpose and meaning. So with the three heavens, the highest is love, the second is charity, the last is obedience. And as these have been produced from the three elements of human nature and degrees of spiritual life, they are the divinely provided receptacles and eternal habitations of human souls, according as, during their sojourn upon earth, they attain to any one of these states. This ordination or arrangement of heaven, which was one of the works that the Lord performed at the time of

His Incarnation, was a result of the past, and an adaptation to the future, states of mankind, and is therefore an evidence of the condescension of Divine Goodness and Wisdom to their imperfections.

When, after the revolt of the ten tribes and the establishment of a second kingdom under Jeroboam, Rehoboam "assembled all the house of Judah, with the tribe of Benjamin, an hundred and fourscore thousand chosen men, which were warriors, to fight against the house of Israel, to bring the kingdom again to Rehoboam the son of Solomon, the word of God came unto Shemaiah the man of God, saying, Speak unto Rehoboam, the son of Solomon, king of Judah, and unto all the house of Judah and Benjamin, and to the remnant of the people, saying, thus saith the Lord, Ye shall not go up, nor fight against your brethren the children of Israel: return every man to his house; for this thing is from Me."

Had the first or primeval Church remained in its integrity, there would have been no need for the Lord to come into the world; and heaven, like the Church, would have continued to be one. Its fall was foreseen, and a remedy was provided. No less an event than the manifestation of God in the flesh was the answer which Divine Love gave to man's departure from the condition in which he had been created. All the results of that marvellous act of Divine goodness and mercy were the means of providing for the salvation and happiness of mankind. The Lord had followed man on his downward course, accommodating His dispensations to his states and necessities, and ordinating heaven itself to his altered condition. Whether man's declension and the means provided for his restoration shall finally result in his elevation to a higher state than that from which he has departed, is a question which may seem more curious than profitable. Yet it admits, if not of a positive, at least of a hopeful answer. The history of the race is like that of the individual. Man, collectively as well as individually, has his infancy, his youth, and his manhood. There is, indeed, one important difference between the infancy of unfallen and that of fallen man. Both are characterized by innocence. But the innocence of primeval man was not, like that of man as he now is, the innocence of ignorance. Originally, wisdom was inscribed on innocence, and was as natural to man as instinct is to animals. Now, wisdom is not an inheritance but an acquisition. Born in ignorance, man has everything to learn. He must acquire knowledge, that by knowledge he may acquire intelligence, and by intelligence wisdom. He therefore begins where primeval man ended. But primeval wisdom differed in its character as much as in its birth from that which is now attainable. Wisdom was not, with primeval man, applied knowledge. What with us is knowledge was with him perception, and his perception did not rest on the superficial qualities

of things, but penetrated into their interior nature and spiritual meaning. His science was that which recognises the relation between the Creator and His creation, and between heavenly and earthly things. Now, we begin with the science of earthly things, and this forms the common foundation of all our possible acquirements, even the highest. The question then is, May we on this foundation build a still higher and nobler superstructure than that which man would have reared had he remained in his original integrity? We think it is possible. Had not man fallen the Incarnation would have been unnecessary. But since that great event has taken place, and humanity has been glorified, and has added a new resplendence to the Sun of heaven, we may reasonably hope, if not conclude, that man may rise higher than the height from which he has fallen; and that in this sense we may understand the Divine promise that "of the *increase* of His government and peace there shall be no end." One thing there is of which we may be assured. The Lord has done for mankind all that it was possible for infinite love and wisdom to do; and nothing is needed to secure for them the full benefits of the Redemption that has been effected for them, and the Salvation that is freely offered to them, but their own consent to be made happy. Whatever degree of perfection men may be able to attain on earth, a place for every one has been prepared by the Lord's Divine Wisdom in the many-mansioned House of His Divine Love. Although on earth as in heaven there will always be diversity of gifts, there may be the same spirit; and even that diversity will produce a unity rich in its varied fulness. And we have a promise of the time when all will bring their gifts into the one sacred treasury, and when all shall know the Lord from the least unto the greatest, when the Lord shall be King over all the earth, when there shall be one Lord and His name one.

MUIR AND PATERSON, PRINTERS, EDINBURGH.

BY THE SAME AUTHOR.

Third Edition, 8*vo*, *cloth*, 7*s*.

Commentary on the Gospel of St. Matthew.

8*vo*, *cloth*, 7*s*.

Commentary on the Gospel of St. John.

8*vo*, *cloth*, 7*s*.

Commentary on the Revelation of St. John.

Third Edition, *foolscap* 8*vo*, *cloth*, 2*s*. 6*d*.

Sermons, Expository and Practical.

Bijou Edition, 18*mo*, *cloth*, 1*s*. 6*d*.; *Presentation Edition*, *printed in gold*, *crown* 8*vo*, 4*s*. 6*d*.

Marriage: A Divine Institution and a Spiritual and Enduring Union.

Second Edition, 18*mo*, *cloth*, 1*s*. 6*d*.

The Story of Joseph and his Brethren:

ITS MORAL AND SPIRITUAL LESSONS.

Crown 8*vo*.

Wesley and Swedenborg.

A REVIEW OF THE REV. JOHN WESLEY'S "THOUGHTS ON THE WRITINGS OF BARON SWEDENBORG."

JAMES SPEIRS, 36 BLOOMSBURY STREET, LONDON.